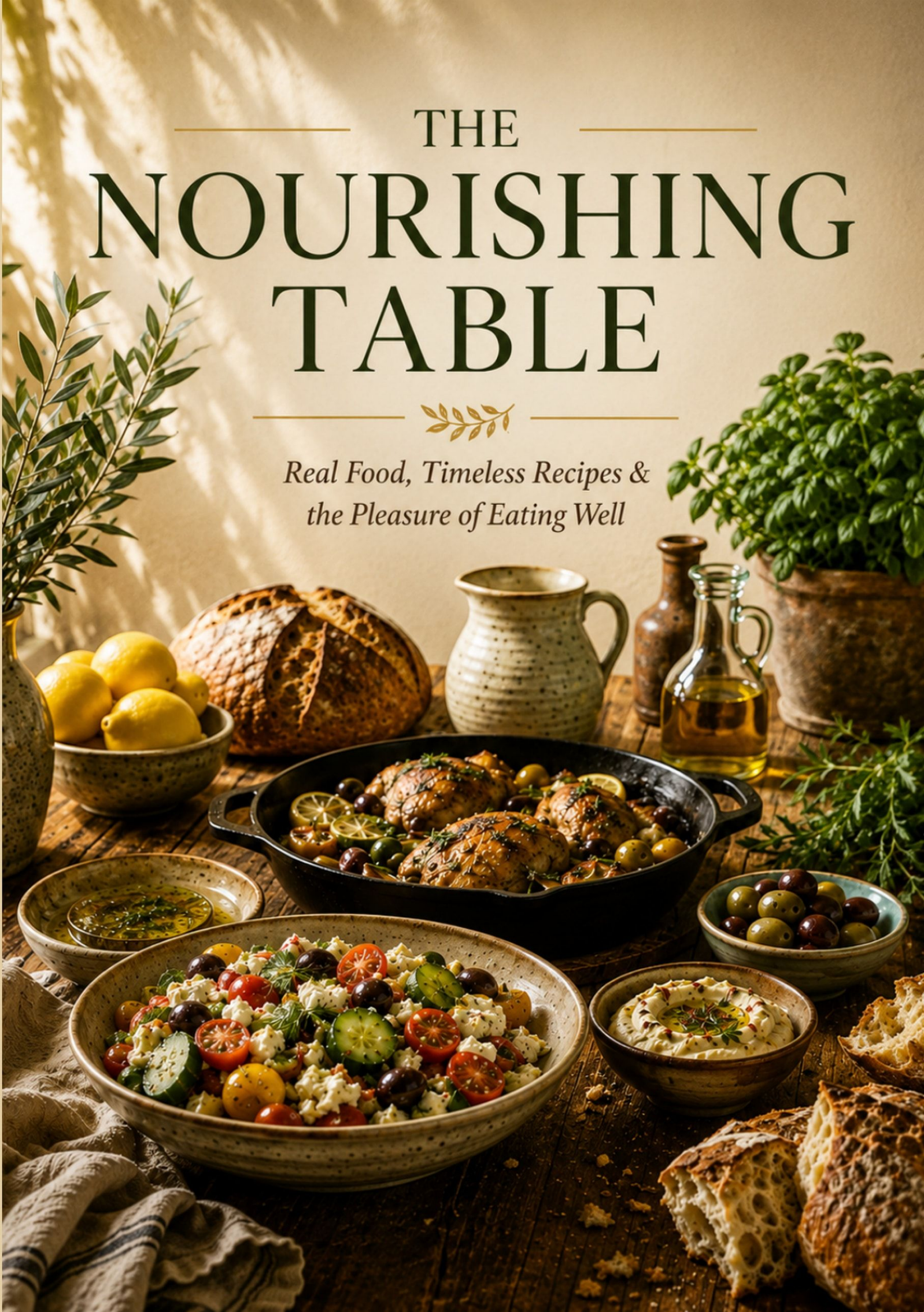
THE
NOURISHING
TABLE
Real Food, Timeless Recipes &
the Pleasure of Eating Well

# Manifesto

I know exactly what you are thinking: here we go with another healthy recipe book with recipes that I have never heard of that taste like cardboard. I get it. There is so much noise nowadays about what is healthy and what is not. What I am supposed to eat and what I am not. And everyone says, "Eat a Mediterranean diet. It is the best way to eat." I had to step back and ask why the food that my parents, grandparents and great-grandparents ate was not healthy enough to continue eating now, and why the need for a "Mediterranean" diet.

I had a conversation with a patient in the office today, and we were talking about our food habits and how they developed when we were kids. He brought up the same story that I am sure most of you can relate to: "You can't leave the table until you finish your plate." It didn't matter if we liked our food, wanted to go play with our friends or were truly full. We had to eat everything on our plate. Looking back, I don't remember a time that I was overweight when I had to clean my plate. This thought made me pause and really wonder why, when I hit my mid-20s, I struggled with keeping my weight down so much. Then I realized that is really quite easy to figure out.

When I was younger, like many of you, I found myself outside until the streetlights were on. That means I was active. I was burning as many calories as I was taking in. No matter what it was that I was eating. Which led me to: what exactly was I eating? Tomatoes out of the neighbor's garden, listening to stories about how many years they had had a garden. There were always fresh vegetables out of our garden as well to go along with the heavy meat-and-potato dinners we had.

Breakfast varied from the most delicious doughnuts from Schafemeyer's Bakery on a special Saturday to Grandma Marie's amazing biscuits and gravy my mom would make for us. Of course cereal, eggs and oatmeal were in there too. Lunches varied, and as I try to recall them, I can think of two that stand out: bologna sandwiches or the best tuna salad you could eat (thanks, Mom)! And oh yes, the infamous pigs-in-a-blanket picnics where we actually got to eat on the living room floor. The absolute coolest meal I had as a kid. My love of food came from the most amazing women in my life. My mom, both of my grandmas and my aunt. Special mention goes to all the church aunts who lent their special culinary gifts and talents to satisfying my

appetite for food, and one special church uncle who made the most delicious bread I have ever eaten.

But I digress and must get back to the point.

The food we enjoyed so much growing up, in so many ways, is where we need to go back to. To our roots. Literally and in all other ways. The black-eyed peas and greens. The ham and beans. Chili, meatloaf, stuffed peppers, and so many more favorite dishes. The ones where we can touch each and every ingredient that we put in a recipe and know where it came from.

Where food began to negatively affect our bodies (mind, body and soul) is when it became ultra-processed. In the last 75 years, food became an engineering project. How to mass-produce, keep food shelf-stable for years and make it look as delicious on day 30 as it did on day 1. For thousands of years we cooked. Now we grab a frozen meal, throw it in the microwave and voilà, dinner is served. Sure, there are some healthy bits, but what about the preservatives and additives?

We've gradually stopped cooking food and started to manufacture it.

To answer that first question of, "Why eat Mediterranean, and what's wrong with how I eat now?" More plants. More fiber. Enough protein. Better fats. More color. Less refined sugar. Fewer foods manufactured to be shelf-stable for years. Finding the sunshine again. Literally. And don't forget to move your body. All of these are key to a healthier life so that, as we reach decade after decade, we can still be active, fully functional and able to do all of the things we love.

Maybe slower but still able.

This is not a how-to-eat-perfectly book. It is not an everything-you-shouldn't-eat book. Nor is it a here-is-another-diet book. This is a reminder. To go back to our roots. Not going backwards, but bringing the best of where we came from forward. Real food. Gardens. Beans simmering on the stove. Sunday dinners. Recipes handed down from generation to generation and sitting around a table with people we love.

*To our roots, and coming back to the table,*

# THE ARC PHILOSOPHY

*Food Is Information*

## 🧬 Food Is Information

At Arc, we don't believe in diets.

We believe in giving the body the information it needs to heal, perform, and thrive. Every bite of food sends thousands of biological messages throughout the body. Some foods promote inflammation while others help calm it. Some support energy production while others leave us feeling sluggish. Some nourish the trillions of cells that make up our body, while others simply fill our stomach.

Our goal isn't perfection. Our goal is to make choices that consistently tell the body:

> ***Build. Repair. Protect. Thrive.***

Food isn't just calories. It is communication.

## 🍽️ The Arc Plate

Instead of counting calories or obsessing over every gram, build your meals using The Arc Plate. Imagine your dinner plate divided into sections, and prioritize variety over perfection.

| Plate Section | Nutritional Focus | Nourishing Examples |
| --- | --- | --- |
| 🥬 **Half of the Plate** | **Color and Fiber:** Feeds cells with antioxidants, vitamins, minerals, and plant compounds. | Leafy greens, tomatoes, peppers, broccoli, cauliflower, Brussels sprouts, mushrooms, asparagus, cucumbers, carrots, eggplant, zucchini. |
| 🍗 **One-Quarter** | **Protein:** Provides building blocks for tissues, maintains muscle, supports hormones, and strengthens immunity. | Fish, chicken, turkey, eggs, Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, lentils, beans, lean beef, tofu, tempeh. |
| 🫘 **One-Quarter** | **Smart Carbohydrates:** Arrives with fiber and nutrients to provide steady energy and nourish the gut microbiome. | Lentils, beans, sweet potatoes, winter squash, quinoa, steel-cut oats, brown rice, fruit. |
| 🫒 **Finish With...** | **Healthy Fats:** Essential for hormone production, brain function, vitamin absorption, and reducing inflammation. | Extra virgin olive oil, avocados, walnuts, almonds, pistachios, pumpkin seeds, chia seeds, flaxseed, tahini, olives. |

## ⏳ Eating for Longevity

Longevity isn't about living forever. It's about having the health to enjoy the years you've been given.

Many of the world's healthiest populations—including those living in the Blue Zones—share several common habits. They don't follow trendy diets or rely on expensive supplements. Instead, they consistently eat foods that nourish their bodies over a lifetime.

**At Arc, we encourage these same principles:**

- Eat mostly whole, minimally processed foods.
- Build meals around plants, beans, and vegetables.
- Include quality protein at every meal.
- Choose healthy fats over highly processed oils.
- Enjoy fruit regularly.
- Limit foods high in added sugars and refined carbohydrates.

- Cook at home more often than eating out.
- Eat slowly and stop when comfortably satisfied.
- Share meals with family and friends whenever possible.

> *Healthy eating isn't built on restriction. It's built on consistency.*

# 🎯 Daily Nutrient Goals

## 💪 Protein Goals

Beginning around age 30, we naturally start losing muscle mass unless we actively work to maintain it. This process gradually accelerates with age, making adequate protein intake increasingly important for strength, metabolism, recovery, balance, and independence. Protein is not just for athletes; it is for every person who wants to stay strong through the decades.

At Arc, we encourage spreading protein throughout the day—aiming for **25–35 grams per meal**—rather than consuming most of it at dinner.

| Population | Daily Goal |
|---|---|
| **Women** | 100–120 grams/day |
| **Men** | 120–150 grams/day |

*(These ranges may increase for individuals who are highly active, recovering from illness or injury, or working to build muscle.)*

## 🌾 Fiber Goals

Fiber is one of the most overlooked nutrients in modern nutrition. It supports digestion, feeds the beneficial bacteria in the gut, helps regulate blood sugar, improves cholesterol, promotes regular bowel movements, and contributes to long-term heart and metabolic health. Most adults consume far less fiber than recommended.

| Population | Daily Goal |
|---|---|
| **Women** | 25–35 grams/day |
| **Men** | 30–40 grams/day |

**Excellent sources include:** Beans, lentils, chickpeas, vegetables, berries, apples, pears, oats, chia seeds, flaxseed, and nuts.
*(Whenever possible, increase fiber gradually and drink plenty of water to help your digestive system adapt.)*

## 🥑 Healthy Fat Guide

For many years, dietary fat was misunderstood. Today we know that the type of fat matters far more than the total amount. Healthy fats help build cell membranes, support hormone production, reduce inflammation, nourish the brain and nervous system, improve heart health, and help absorb vitamins A, D, E, and K.

The goal isn't to fear fat—it's to choose fats that nourish your cells.

| ✅ Choose More Often | ❌ Limit or Avoid |
|---|---|
| Extra virgin olive oil | Highly processed seed oils used in fried and packaged foods |
| Avocados | Trans fats |
| Nuts and seeds | Highly processed snack foods |
| Fatty fish (salmon, sardines, trout, mackerel) | Deep-fried foods |
| Natural nut butters | |

# 🌍 Blue Zone Principles

The world's longest-living populations don't eat perfectly—but they do eat intentionally. Across cultures, these communities share remarkably similar habits:

- 🫘 **Beans** are a staple food, often eaten daily.
- 🌿 **Meals** emphasize vegetables, herbs, and seasonal produce.
- 🐟 **Animal protein** is eaten in moderation, with plants providing much of the daily nourishment.
- 🥜 **Nuts and seeds** are enjoyed regularly.
- 🫒 **Healthy fats**, particularly olive oil, are used generously.
- 🍓 **Fruit** is a common dessert.
- 🚶 **Meals** are paired with daily movement, meaningful work, strong relationships, and adequate rest.

Rather than searching for a miracle food, these communities have built a lifestyle where nourishing choices become the norm.

> ***At Arc, we don't ask, "What's the healthiest meal?"***
>
> *We ask, "How can we build a way of eating that supports your body for decades to come?"*

French Green Lentils
Red Lentils
Black Beans
French Green Lentils
Red Lentils
Za'atar
Sumac

# THE HERITAGE PANTRY

*Timeless Ingredients. Modern Longevity.*

The world's longest-living communities don't rely on expensive superfoods or complicated meal plans. They build meals from simple, nourishing ingredients that have been passed down through generations.

Whether your family grew vegetables in the backyard, simmered beans on the stove, baked fresh bread, canned tomatoes, or gathered around homemade soup, many of those same humble foods remain among the healthiest choices we know today.

The Arc Heritage Pantry blends the wisdom of traditional home cooking with the science of modern longevity. Stock your kitchen with these staples, and you'll always be just a few simple ingredients away from a nourishing meal.

## Beans & Legumes

*A cornerstone of longevity around the world*

- ✔ Cannellini Beans
- ✔ Navy Beans
- ✔ Lentils (Green, Brown & Red)
- ✔ Pinto Beans
- ✔ Lima Beans
- ✔ Edamame (Frozen)
- ✔ Great Northern Beans
- ✔ Chickpeas
- ✔ Black Beans
- ✔ Black-Eyed Peas
- ✔ Split Peas

> **ARC TIP**
> *Aim to enjoy beans or lentils most days of the week. They're one of the richest sources of fiber, plant protein, and nutrients that support heart and gut health.*

## Whole Grains

*Slow-burning energy that has fueled generations*

- ✔ Old-Fashioned Oats
- ✔ Brown Rice
- ✔ Farro
- ✔ Steel-Cut Oats
- ✔ Quinoa
- ✔ Barley

- ✔ Bulgur
- ✔ Whole Grain Sourdough
- ✔ Whole Grain Pasta
- ✔ Popcorn Kernels

> **ARC TIP**
> *Choose grains that are as close to their natural state as possible. Whole grains provide lasting energy, fiber, and nutrients that refined grains leave behind.*

## Healthy Fats

*Small amounts. Big benefits.*

- ✔ Extra Virgin Olive Oil
- ✔ Walnuts
- ✔ Pecans
- ✔ Pumpkin Seeds
- ✔ Chia Seeds
- ✔ Tahini
- ✔ Avocados
- ✔ Almonds
- ✔ Pistachios
- ✔ Sunflower Seeds
- ✔ Ground Flaxseed
- ✔ Natural Peanut Butter

> **ARC TIP**
> *Healthy fats support brain function, hormone production, heart health, and help your body absorb essential vitamins.*

## Seafood & Lean Proteins

*Build every meal around quality protein*

- ✔ Sardines
- ✔ Tuna
- ✔ Chicken Breast
- ✔ Eggs
- ✔ Cottage Cheese
- ✔ Tempeh
- ✔ Salmon
- ✔ Shrimp
- ✔ Turkey Breast
- ✔ Plain Greek Yogurt
- ✔ Tofu

> **ARC TIP**
> *Protein isn't just for athletes—it helps preserve muscle, strength, metabolism, and independence as we age.*

# Vegetables

*Nature's medicine cabinet*

### Fresh

- ✔ Spinach
- ✔ Mixed Greens
- ✔ Tomatoes
- ✔ Bell Peppers
- ✔ Cauliflower
- ✔ Green Beans
- ✔ Carrots
- ✔ White Potatoes
- ✔ Mushrooms
- ✔ Onions
- ✔ Celery
- ✔ Kale
- ✔ Romaine
- ✔ Cucumbers
- ✔ Broccoli
- ✔ Brussels Sprouts
- ✔ Asparagus
- ✔ Sweet Potatoes
- ✔ Zucchini
- ✔ Cabbage
- ✔ Garlic

### Frozen

- ✔ Broccoli
- ✔ Cauliflower
- ✔ Mixed Vegetables
- ✔ Peas
- ✔ Cauliflower Rice
- ✔ Green Beans
- ✔ Spinach
- ✔ Corn
- ✔ Edamame

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Frozen vegetables are harvested and frozen at peak freshness, making them just as nutritious—and often more convenient—than fresh.*

# Fruit

*Colorful nutrition from nature*

### Fresh

- ✔ Apples
- ✔ Oranges
- ✔ Bananas
- ✔ Pears
- ✔ Grapefruit
- ✔ Blueberries

- ✔ Strawberries
- ✔ Blackberries
- ✔ Peaches
- ✔ Raspberries
- ✔ Grapes
- ✔ Seasonal Fruit

### Frozen

- ✔ Mixed Berries
- ✔ Peaches
- ✔ Cherries
- ✔ Mango

> **ARC TIP**
> *Fill your fruit bowl with a variety of colors. Different fruits provide different antioxidants and protective plant compounds.*

## Dairy & Fermented Foods

*Supporting gut health and strong bones*

- ✔ Plain Greek Yogurt
- ✔ Feta
- ✔ Fresh Mozzarella
- ✔ Sauerkraut
- ✔ Pickles (Naturally Fermented)
- ✔ Cottage Cheese
- ✔ Parmesan
- ✔ Kefir
- ✔ Kimchi

> **ARC TIP**
> *Fermented foods can help diversify the gut microbiome and add bright flavors to everyday meals.*

## Pantry Flavor Builders

*Big flavor without relying on excess sugar or sodium*

- ✔ Extra Virgin Olive Oil
- ✔ Red Wine Vinegar
- ✔ Dijon Mustard
- ✔ Low-Sodium Vegetable Broth
- ✔ Diced Tomatoes
- ✔ Salsa
- ✔ Capers
- ✔ Balsamic Vinegar
- ✔ Apple Cider Vinegar
- ✔ Low-Sodium Chicken Broth
- ✔ Tomato Paste
- ✔ Fire-Roasted Tomatoes
- ✔ Kalamata Olives
- ✔ Roasted Red Peppers

- ✔ Artichoke Hearts
- ✔ Hummus
- ✔ Sun-Dried Tomatoes

> **ARC TIP**
> *Simple pantry ingredients make it easy to build flavorful meals in minutes.*

## Herbs & Spices

*The secret to meals you'll crave*

### Fresh Herbs

- ✔ Parsley
- ✔ Dill
- ✔ Mint
- ✔ Thyme
- ✔ Basil
- ✔ Cilantro
- ✔ Rosemary
- ✔ Chives

### Dried Herbs & Spices

- ✔ Oregano
- ✔ Onion Powder
- ✔ Cumin
- ✔ Cinnamon
- ✔ Crushed Red Pepper
- ✔ Za'atar
- ✔ Garlic Powder
- ✔ Smoked Paprika
- ✔ Turmeric
- ✔ Black Pepper
- ✔ Sumac

> **ARC TIP**
> *Herbs and spices are one of the easiest ways to add flavor, color, and beneficial plant compounds without adding calories.*

## Freezer Essentials

*Healthy meals start with a well-stocked freezer*

- ✔ Frozen Berries
- ✔ Frozen Spinach
- ✔ Frozen Edamame
- ✔ Shrimp
- ✔ Frozen Vegetables
- ✔ Frozen Broccoli
- ✔ Wild Salmon
- ✔ Homemade Soups

- ✔ Homemade Cooked Beans
- ✔ Homemade Bone Broth

> **ARC TIP**
> *A thoughtfully stocked freezer makes healthy choices the easiest choices on busy days.*

## Arc Pantry Essentials

*If you're just getting started, begin here. These are the ingredients you'll reach for again and again throughout this cookbook.*

- Extra Virgin Olive Oil
- Onions
- Beans & Lentils
- Whole Grain Sourdough
- Sardines
- Greek Yogurt
- Mixed Greens
- Frozen Berries
- Seasonal Fruit
- Fresh Herbs
- Garlic
- Lemons
- Old-Fashioned Oats
- Brown Rice or Quinoa
- Eggs
- Cottage Cheese
- Frozen Broccoli
- Tomatoes
- Walnuts or Almonds
- Vinegar & Dijon Mustard

## The Arc Philosophy

The healthiest kitchens aren't built in a single shopping trip—they're built over time.

Start with foods your family already knows and loves. Add ingredients inspired by the world's longest-living communities. Blend old traditions with new discoveries.

Your heritage and modern nutrition science don't compete—they complement each other.

Because longevity isn't about eating someone else's culture. It's about rediscovering the wisdom of real food, sharing it around your own table, and creating traditions that can be passed to the next generation.

# ARC KITCHEN BASICS

*The Simple Skills That Make Healthy Cooking Easy*

Great meals don't require fancy techniques—just a few dependable skills. These simple kitchen basics will appear throughout this cookbook and help you prepare nourishing meals with confidence. Once you've mastered these foundations, you'll spend less time in the kitchen and more time enjoying healthy food.

## How to Cook Lentils

Lentils are one of the world's oldest and most nutritious foods. They're naturally high in plant protein, fiber, iron, potassium, folate, and antioxidants—and unlike dried beans, they don't require soaking.

### Green & Brown Lentils

Best for salads, bowls, soups, and side dishes because they hold their shape.

**INGREDIENTS**

- 1 cup dried lentils
- 3 cups water or low-sodium broth
- Optional: 1 bay leaf, garlic cloves, fresh thyme

**DIRECTIONS**

1. Rinse lentils under cool water and remove any debris.
2. Combine lentils and liquid in a saucepan.
3. Bring to a boil.
4. Reduce to a gentle simmer.
5. Cook uncovered for 20–30 minutes, until tender but not mushy.
6. Drain any excess liquid.
7. Season after cooking.

### Red Lentils

Best for soups, curries, and creamy dishes.
Cook 12–15 minutes until soft.

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Add salt after cooking to help maintain the best texture.*

## How to Cook Quinoa

Quinoa is a naturally gluten-free seed packed with complete protein, fiber, magnesium, and iron.

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup quinoa
- 2 cups water or broth

### DIRECTIONS

1. Rinse quinoa thoroughly using a fine mesh strainer.
2. Combine quinoa and liquid.
3. Bring to a boil.
4. Reduce heat.
5. Cover and simmer for 15 minutes.
6. Remove from heat.
7. Let stand 5 minutes.
8. Fluff gently with a fork.

*Makes approximately 3 cups cooked.*

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Cooking quinoa in broth instead of water adds wonderful flavor.*

## How to Cook Farro

Farro is an ancient grain with a slightly chewy texture and rich, nutty flavor.

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup pearled farro
- 3 cups water or broth

### DIRECTIONS

1. Rinse well.
2. Bring liquid to a boil.

3. Add farro.
4. Simmer uncovered 20–30 minutes.
5. Drain excess liquid if necessary.
6. Toss with a drizzle of olive oil.

*Makes about 2½ cups cooked.*

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Cook a large batch on Sunday and enjoy it throughout the week in salads, grain bowls, and soups.*

## How to Roast Vegetables

Roasting transforms simple vegetables into naturally sweet, caramelized bites packed with flavor.

### BEST VEGETABLES

- Broccoli
- Cauliflower
- Sweet Potatoes
- Beets
- Zucchini
- Onions
- Brussels Sprouts
- Carrots
- White Potatoes
- Asparagus
- Bell Peppers

### DIRECTIONS

1. Heat oven to 425°F.
2. Cut vegetables into similar-sized pieces.
3. Toss with olive oil.
4. Season with salt and pepper.
5. Spread into a single layer.
6. Roast 20–35 minutes, turning halfway.

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Crowded pans steam vegetables. Give them space to caramelize.*

## How to Make a Simple Vinaigrette

Skip bottled dressings and make fresh vinaigrettes in minutes.

### BASIC FORMULA

- 3 parts olive oil
- 1 part acid

### CHOOSE

- Lemon Juice
- Balsamic Vinegar
- Red Wine Vinegar
- Apple Cider Vinegar

### ADD

- Dijon Mustard
- Herbs
- Garlic
- Black Pepper

**Shake well.** Store refrigerated up to one week.

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *A homemade vinaigrette contains fewer additives and lets the flavor of fresh ingredients shine.*

## How to Meal Prep Beans

Cooking beans in batches saves money and makes healthy meals quick and convenient.

### DIRECTIONS

1. Soak dried beans overnight (except lentils and split peas).
2. Drain and rinse.
3. Cover with fresh water.
4. Simmer until tender (time varies by bean type).
5. Cool completely.
6. Portion into 1½-cup freezer containers (about the amount in one standard can).
7. Refrigerate up to 5 days or freeze for up to 6 months.

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Freeze beans flat in freezer bags to save space and thaw quickly.*

## How to Cook the Perfect Grain

Use this simple guide for nearly every whole grain.

| Grain | Water | Cook Time | Makes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brown Rice | 2 : 1 | 40–45 min | 3 cups |
| Quinoa | 2 : 1 | 15 min | 3 cups |
| Farro | 3 : 1 | 25 min | 2½ cups |
| Barley | 3 : 1 | 35–40 min | 3 cups |
| Bulgur | 2 : 1 | 12 min | 2½ cups |
| Steel-Cut Oats | 3 : 1 | 25–30 min | 3 cups |

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Cook one or two grains each week and store them in the refrigerator. They become the foundation for quick breakfasts, hearty lunches, satisfying dinners, and grain bowls all week long.*

## The Arc Kitchen Philosophy

You don't need dozens of recipes to eat well.

Learn a few simple techniques, stock your Heritage Pantry, and use the Flex Guides to mix and match ingredients. Before long, healthy cooking becomes second nature—not because you're following a recipe, but because you've built the confidence to create nourishing meals your own way.

# THE ARC FLEX GUIDES

*A Flexible Approach to Balanced Nutrition*

## Why We Use Flex Guides

The Arc Cookbook is built around a simple idea: **Healthy eating should be flexible—not restrictive.**

Every recipe is designed to be mixed, matched, and personalized while maintaining balanced nutrition. The Flex Guides allow you to:

- Use what you already have at home
- Prevent recipe fatigue
- Adapt meals to your preferences
- Keep nutrition balanced
- Build lifelong habits instead of following rigid rules

## Protein Flex Guide

Choose the protein that fits your goals.

| Protein | Serving | Protein |
|---|---|---|
| Chicken Breast | 4 oz | 35 g |
| Turkey Breast | 4 oz | 34 g |
| Salmon | 4 oz | 26 g |
| Tuna | 4 oz | 30 g |
| Shrimp | 4 oz | 24 g |
| Sardines | 1 can | 22 g |
| Lean Ground Turkey | 4 oz | 28 g |
| Lean Beef | 4 oz | 28 g |

| Protein | Serving | Protein |
|---|---|---|
| Eggs | 2 large | 12 g |
| Egg Whites | 4 | 14 g |
| Cottage Cheese | 1 cup | 28 g |
| Greek Yogurt | 1 cup | 20 g |
| Tofu | 4 oz | 12 g |
| Tempeh | 4 oz | 21 g |

> **ARC TIP**
> *Aim for 25–35 grams of protein at every meal.*

## Bean & Legume Flex Guide

Beans are one of the world's greatest longevity foods. Swap freely unless a recipe specifies otherwise.

| Bean | Serving | Fiber | Protein |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cannellini Beans | ½ cup | 6 g | 8 g |
| Chickpeas | ½ cup | 6 g | 7 g |
| Black Beans | ½ cup | 8 g | 8 g |
| Pinto Beans | ½ cup | 7 g | 8 g |
| Navy Beans | ½ cup | 10 g | 8 g |
| Lentils | ½ cup | 8 g | 9 g |
| Lima Beans | ½ cup | 7 g | 7 g |
| Black-Eyed Peas | ½ cup | 5 g | 6 g |
| Edamame | ½ cup | 5 g | 9 g |

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Beans aren't just carbohydrates—they're also one of the best sources of plant protein and fiber.*

## Healthy Fat Flex Guide

Healthy fats improve satiety, hormone production, brain health, and longevity.

| Healthy Fat | Serving | Calories | Fat |
|---|---|---|---|
| Extra Virgin Olive Oil | 1 tsp | 40 | 4.5 g |
| Avocado | ¼ medium | 80 | 7 g |
| Walnuts | ¼ cup | 190 | 18 g |
| Almonds | ¼ cup | 170 | 15 g |
| Pistachios | ¼ cup | 160 | 13 g |
| Pecans | ¼ cup | 190 | 20 g |
| Pumpkin Seeds | 2 Tbsp | 90 | 7 g |
| Sunflower Seeds | 2 Tbsp | 95 | 8 g |
| Tahini | 1 Tbsp | 90 | 8 g |
| Natural Peanut Butter | 1 Tbsp | 95 | 8 g |

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Most meals only need one healthy fat source.*

## Cheese Flex Guide

Use cheese to add flavor—not as the centerpiece.

| Cheese | Serving | Calories | Protein |
|---|---|---|---|
| Feta | 1 oz | 75 | 4 g |
| Goat Cheese | 1 oz | 100 | 6 g |

| Cheese | Serving | Calories | Protein |
|---|---|---|---|
| Parmesan | 2 Tbsp | 45 | 4 g |
| Cottage Cheese | ½ cup | 90 | 14 g |
| Ricotta | ¼ cup | 85 | 5 g |
| Fresh Mozzarella | 1 oz | 70 | 6 g |
| Sharp Cheddar | 1 oz | 115 | 7 g |

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *A small amount of flavorful cheese often satisfies more than a large serving of mild cheese.*

## Fruit Flex Guide

Fruit provides antioxidants, fiber, vitamins, and natural sweetness.

| Fruit | Serving | Calories | Fiber |
|---|---|---|---|
| Blueberries | ½ cup | 40 | 2 g |
| Strawberries | 1 cup | 50 | 3 g |
| Raspberries | ½ cup | 32 | 4 g |
| Blackberries | ½ cup | 31 | 4 g |
| Apple | ½ medium | 50 | 2 g |
| Peach | 1 small | 60 | 2 g |
| Pear | ½ medium | 50 | 3 g |
| Orange | 1 small | 60 | 3 g |
| Kiwi | 2 | 80 | 4 g |
| Cherries | ½ cup | 45 | 2 g |
| Pomegranate Arils | ¼ cup | 40 | 2 g |

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Berries are nutritional superstars because they provide exceptional nutrition with relatively little sugar.*

## Smart Carb Flex Guide

Carbohydrates fuel movement, recovery, and brain function. Choose the amount that matches your activity level.

| Smart Carb | Serving | Calories | Fiber |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sweet Potato | ½ cup | 90 | 3 g |
| Roasted Potatoes | ½ cup | 80 | 2 g |
| Brown Rice | ½ cup | 110 | 2 g |
| Quinoa | ½ cup | 110 | 3 g |
| Farro | ½ cup | 100 | 4 g |
| Barley | ½ cup | 95 | 3 g |
| Whole Grain Pasta | ½ cup | 100 | 3 g |
| Whole Grain Sourdough | 1 slice | 100 | 2 g |
| Corn | ½ cup | 75 | 2 g |
| Oats (cooked) | ½ cup | 75 | 2 g |

### Activity Levels

- **Higher Activity Days:** If you lift weights, hike, bike, play sports, or have a physically demanding day, add one additional Smart Carb serving.
- **Lower Activity Days:** Build your plate around protein, vegetables, and healthy fats, then add a smaller portion of Smart Carbs.

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *You don't need to fear carbohydrates—you simply need to match them to your activity.*

## Greens Flex Guide

Mix and match throughout the week.

| Green | Serving | Calories | Fiber |
|---|---|---|---|
| Spinach | 2 cups | 14 | 2 g |
| Kale | 2 cups | 33 | 2.5 g |
| Arugula | 2 cups | 10 | 1 g |
| Swiss Chard | 2 cups | 14 | 1.5 g |
| Romaine | 2 cups | 16 | 2 g |
| Butter Lettuce | 2 cups | 10 | 1 g |
| Bok Choy | 2 cups | 18 | 2 g |
| Collard Greens | 1 cup cooked | 63 | 5 g |

> **ARC TIP**
>
> *Aim for at least two cups of leafy greens every day.*

## Vegetable Flex Guide

Color equals nutrients.

| Vegetable | Serving | Calories | Fiber |
|---|---|---|---|
| Broccoli | 1 cup | 31 | 2.5 g |
| Brussels Sprouts | 1 cup | 38 | 3 g |
| Green Beans | 1 cup | 31 | 3 g |
| Asparagus | 1 cup | 27 | 3 g |
| Zucchini | 1 cup | 20 | 1 g |
| Tomatoes | 1 cup | 32 | 2 g |
| Red Bell Pepper | 1 cup | 39 | 3 g |

| Vegetable | Serving | Calories | Fiber |
|---|---|---|---|
| Carrots | 1 cup | 52 | 4 g |
| Butternut Squash | 1 cup | 63 | 6 g |
| Beets | 1 cup | 59 | 4 g |
| Eggplant | 1 cup | 35 | 2.5 g |
| Mushrooms | 1 cup | 15 | 1 g |
| Cauliflower | 1 cup | 27 | 2 g |

> **ARC TIP**
> *Try to eat 3–5 different vegetable colors each day.*

## Herb & Flavor Flex Guide

Fresh herbs are one of the easiest ways to increase flavor and phytonutrients without adding calories.

| Herb or Spice | Best With |
|---|---|
| Parsley | Chicken, fish, beans |
| Dill | Salmon, yogurt sauces |
| Basil | Tomatoes, mozzarella, pesto |
| Cilantro | Mexican & Mediterranean dishes |
| Mint | Yogurt, salads, fruit |
| Rosemary | Potatoes, chicken |
| Thyme | Eggs, vegetables |
| Oregano | Mediterranean recipes |
| Chives | Eggs, cottage cheese |
| Sumac | Salads, chicken |
| Za'atar | Vegetables, hummus |
| Smoked Paprika | Chicken, potatoes |

| Herb or Spice | Best With |
|---|---|
| Cumin | Beans, lentils |
| Turmeric | Soups, rice, vegetables |
| Garlic | Almost everything |

> **ARC TIP**
> *Fresh herbs add antioxidants and make healthy food taste restaurant-quality.*

## Sauce & Dressing Flex Guide

Healthy sauces are one of the easiest ways to keep meals exciting while adding very little to the overall calorie load.

| Sauce or Dressing | Serving | Calories | Fat | Protein |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lemon Olive Oil Vinaigrette | 1 Tbsp | 60 | 7 g | 0 g |
| Greek Yogurt Herb Sauce | 2 Tbsp | 25 | 1 g | 3 g |
| Tzatziki | 2 Tbsp | 30 | 1.5 g | 2 g |
| Chimichurri | 1 Tbsp | 45 | 5 g | 0 g |
| Basil Pesto | 1 Tbsp | 80 | 8 g | 1 g |
| Tahini Lemon Sauce | 1 Tbsp | 90 | 8 g | 3 g |
| Hummus Dressing | 2 Tbsp | 60 | 4 g | 2 g |
| Roasted Red Pepper Sauce | 2 Tbsp | 25 | 1 g | 1 g |
| Salsa | 2 Tbsp | 10 | 0 g | 0 g |
| Balsamic Reduction | 1 Tbsp | 35 | 0 g | 0 g |

> **ARC TIP**
> *A flavorful sauce can completely transform the same protein and vegetables into an entirely new meal, making healthy eating easier to sustain.*

# FOOD TRUTHS

*A Clearer Way to Think About What We Eat*

## Carbohydrates Aren’t the Enemy

Carbs have gotten a bad rap, but carbs themselves aren't the problem. The kind of carbs you choose matters.

Your body uses carbohydrates for energy. But there's a big difference between carbohydrates from beans, lentils, fruit, vegetables, oats, and whole grains and those from sugary drinks, packaged cakes and pastries, sugary cereals, and highly processed snack foods.

Whole-food carbohydrates come with things your body needs—fiber, vitamins, minerals, and plant nutrients. That fiber also helps slow digestion, keeps you fuller longer, and gives your body a steadier source of energy.

Highly refined carbohydrates—like packaged cakes and pastries, sugary cereals, white breads made with enriched flour, and many processed snack foods—have often been stripped of much of their natural fiber and nutrition, making them easier to digest quickly and much easier to overeat.

So instead of asking, “Is this a carb?” ask:

“What comes with this carb?”

If the answer is fiber, nutrients, and real food, there's probably a place for it on your plate.

The goal isn't to eliminate carbohydrates. It's to choose better ones.

And yes, you can eat the potato. It didn't do anything wrong.

## Fun Fact: “Enriched” Doesn’t Mean Better

When you see enriched flour on an ingredient list, don't let the name fool you. Enriched sounds like something extra was added to make the flour better, but that's not really the whole story.

The grain was refined first, removing the fiber-rich bran and nutrient-rich germ along with many of the nutrients naturally found in the whole grain. Certain vitamins and minerals are then added back—but not everything that was lost is restored.

When possible, look for 100% whole grain or 100% whole wheat as the first ingredient.

You don't have to fear bread. You just need to know how to read the bread label.

## Fat Isn’t the Enemy Either

For years, we were told that eating fat would make us fat. So we removed it from everything—and often replaced it with sugar, refined carbohydrates, and a long list of ingredients to make food taste good again. Think of fat free salad dressing for an example.

But your body needs fat. Fat helps you absorb important vitamins, supports your brain and hormones, protects your cells, and helps make meals satisfying enough to actually keep you full. Just like carbohydrates, though, the source matters. Fats from foods like extra virgin olive oil, avocados, nuts, seeds, olives, and fatty fish come packaged with nutrients your body can use. These are the fats you'll see again and again throughout this book.

The bigger concern is a diet filled with fried foods, packaged baked goods, highly processed snack foods, and other foods where refined fats are combined with refined carbohydrates, added sugars, and lots of salt. That's a very different nutritional package from drizzling olive oil over vegetables or adding walnuts to your oatmeal.

And remember: fat is calorie-dense. That isn't a bad thing—it simply means a little goes a long way.

So instead of asking:

“Does this have too much fat?”

Ask:

“Where is the fat coming from?”

A handful of walnuts, half an avocado, a piece of salmon, or a beautiful drizzle of olive oil doesn't need to be feared.

The goal isn't to eat low-fat. It's to eat better fat.

## Sugar: It’s Complicated

Sugar gets talked about as if all sugar is the same. It isn't quite that simple. The sugar naturally found in an apple comes packaged with fiber, water, vitamins, minerals, and

plant nutrients. Your body has to work through that whole food as it digests it. Added sugar is different. It's concentrated sweetness added to a food without bringing much nutrition along with it. And it can show up everywhere—sodas, coffee drinks, cereals, sauces, dressings, flavored yogurts, packaged snacks, and foods you may not even think of as sweet.

That doesn't mean you can never eat added sugar. Dessert is allowed. What matters is how often you're eating it, how much you're eating, and what the rest of your diet looks like. There's also a big difference between enjoying a homemade dessert made with recognizable ingredients and routinely eating ultra-processed sweets designed around refined flour, added sugars, refined fats, flavorings, and other highly processed ingredients.

So rather than trying to eliminate every gram of sugar, start asking:

“Where did this sugar come from—and what came with it?”

Fruit? You're also getting fiber and nutrients.

A little honey or maple syrup in a homemade recipe? It's still added sugar, but you can control how much you use.

A packaged food with several forms of sugar near the top of the ingredient list? That's worth a second look.

The goal isn't a life without sugar. It's a life where sugar isn't quietly running the show. Have the birthday cake. Make the cookies with your grandkids. Order dessert at the beautiful restaurant. Then go back to eating real food.

That's balance.

## What About “Diet” Sugar?

If regular sugar isn't ideal, does that mean the answer is artificial sweeteners and everything labeled diet, zero sugar, or sugar-free?

Not necessarily.

Artificial and other non-sugar sweeteners can provide sweetness with little or no sugar and fewer calories, but that doesn't automatically make the food healthier. They can also keep your palate accustomed to foods tasting very sweet, rather than helping you gradually need less sweetness. Some sugar substitutes—particularly certain sugar alcohols—can also be difficult for some people to tolerate, causing gas, bloating, cramping, or diarrhea.

And a package that says “zero sugar” tells you exactly one thing: how much sugar is in it. It doesn't tell you whether the rest of the ingredients are nourishing. The better goal isn't simply to replace every sugary food with its artificially sweetened version. It's to gradually rely less on intensely sweet foods altogether.

When you do want something sweet, start with real food. Fruit, dates, or a thoughtfully made dessert can absolutely have a place.

The key is moderation—and giving your body a reason to use the energy from that something sweet. Take a walk, move your body, lift something heavy. Sugar is energy. Give your body somewhere to put it.

## Calories Still Count—but They’re Not the Whole Story

Calories matter. They tell us how much energy a food provides, and over time, how much energy we take in compared with how much we use plays an important role in weight.

But calories don't tell us the whole story.

Two foods can contain the same number of calories and do very different things for your body.

A 200-calorie snack of nuts brings healthy fats, protein, fiber, vitamins, and minerals—and may keep you satisfied for hours. A 200-calorie sugary snack may provide plenty of energy but very little fiber, protein, or nutrition and leave you hungry again much sooner.

That's why simply eating fewer calories isn't always the same as eating better.

The quality of those calories matters. Protein helps preserve and build muscle. Fiber supports your gut and helps keep you full. Healthy fats provide essential nutrients and satisfaction. Whole-food carbohydrates provide energy along with fiber, vitamins, minerals, and plant nutrients.

And your body needs enough food to function well. Continually eating too little can make it difficult to get enough protein, fiber, vitamins, minerals, and energy to support an active, healthy body.

So yes, calories still count—but instead of only asking:

“How many calories does this have?”

Also ask:

“What am I getting for those calories?”

Choose foods that give something back: protein, fiber, healthy fats, nutrients, energy, and satisfaction. Because 1,500 calories can create a very different day depending on what's on the plate.

Don't just count calories. Make your calories count.

## Protein Is Your Foundation

If you're wondering where to start when building a meal, start with protein.

Protein provides the building blocks your body uses to maintain and repair muscle, bone, skin, and other tissues. It also supports enzymes, hormones, immune function, and recovery—and it helps meals keep you satisfied.

And as we get older, protein becomes even more important.

We naturally become more vulnerable to losing muscle with age, especially when we're eating too little, losing weight, or not strength training. Maintaining that muscle isn't just about looking strong. Muscle supports strength, balance, mobility, metabolism, and your ability to stay independent as you age.

That's why you'll see protein at the center of meals throughout this book.

Think fish and seafood, eggs, chicken, lean meats, beans and lentils, and other quality protein sources. Plant proteins absolutely count, too—and often bring the added benefit of fiber.

You don't need to obsess over protein or turn every meal into a math problem. Simply get in the habit of asking:

“Where's my protein?”

Build the rest of your plate around that answer.

Protein is your foundation. Plants bring the color. Healthy fats and quality carbohydrates round it out.

That's a plate built to nourish you now—and help keep you strong for the years ahead.

## Fiber Feeds More Than You

Fiber is one of the hardest-working parts of your plate—and chances are, you're not getting enough of it.

It helps keep you full, supports healthy blood sugar and cholesterol levels, keeps digestion moving, and feeds the beneficial bacteria that help support a healthy gut. Think of fiber as good nutrition for your gut. And the best part? Fiber comes from some pretty delicious places: beans, lentils, vegetables, fruits, whole grains, nuts, and seeds.

But there's another piece that matters: variety.

Different plant foods provide different types of fiber and plant nutrients, which is why eating a colorful variety is even better than relying on the same few high-fiber foods every day. Add berries to breakfast. Throw beans into a salad. Snack on a handful of nuts. Try a new vegetable. Leave the skin on that potato. Small choices throughout the day add up.

So don't think of fiber as something you need to choke down because it's “good for you.”

Eat more plants. Mix them up. Keep them colorful.

Your gut will take it from there.

# SECTION 2: BREAKFAST

*Start Your Day by Nourishing Your Cells*

Turkish Eggs with White Bean Crema

Arc Mediterranean Vegetable Omelet

Jennifer’s Sardines & Eggs Power Plate

Spinach & Feta Scramble

Frenchie’s Mushroom & Herb Omelet

Smoked Salmon & Avocado Plate

Cottage Cheese Egg Bake

Mediterranean Shakshuka

Arc White Bean Shakshuka

Muffin Tin Egg Cups

Sweet Potato Hash with Eggs

Farmer's Skillet with Greens

Overnight Oats Builder

Chia Breakfast Jar Blueprint

Toast Bar

## Frenchie's Mushroom and Herb Omelet

*Earthy mushrooms, fresh herbs and creamy cheese folded into a fluffy omelet perfection.*

## Smoked Salmon and Avocado Plate

*Smoky salmon, creamy avocado and Mediterranean flavors for a fresh, vibrant and satisfying plate.*

## Spinach and Feta Scramble

*Fluffy eggs with tender spinach and tangy feta—a simple, nourishing way to start the day.*

# Muffin Tin Egg Cups

*Perfectly portioned and packed with protein, veggies and flavor—ideal for busy mornings.*

# Mediterranean Shakshuka

*A vibrant one-pan dish of eggs poached in a rich tomato sauce with Mediterranean herbs and spices.*

# Cottage Cheese Egg Bake

*Creamy, cheesy and satisfying—high in protein and perfect for meal prep or a cozy brunch.*

# Arc Toast Builder

*ndless combinations of bread, rotein, healthy fats and fresh produce—built your way.*

# Arc Breakfast Jar Builder

*Protein-packed oats or chia creations with endless flavor, fruit and topping combinations.*

# Arc Smoothie Builder

*Blend your base, protein, produ healthy fats and boosters for t perfect smoothie every time.*

# Turkish Eggs with White Bean Crema

## Ingredients

- ¼ cup plain nonfat Greek yogurt
- ¼ cup cannellini beans, drained and rinsed
- 1 clove garlic, minced
- 2 tsp fresh dill, chopped
- 2 tsp fresh parsley, chopped
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp salt
- Juice of ½ lemon
- 2 large eggs, preferably poached
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp paprika
- ½ tsp Aleppo pepper (or red pepper flakes)

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted sourdough bread
- ½ cup fresh raspberries

## Directions

1. In a blender or small food processor, combine the Greek yogurt, cannellini beans, garlic, dill, parsley, salt, pepper, and lemon juice. Blend until completely smooth and creamy.
2. Spread the mixture onto a serving plate.
3. In a small skillet, melt the butter with the olive oil. Stir in the paprika and Aleppo pepper and heat for about 30 seconds until fragrant.
4. While the butter mixture is warming, poach the eggs.
5. Place the eggs over the yogurt-bean mixture and drizzle with the warm paprika butter and olive oil.
6. Serve immediately with toasted sourdough and fresh raspberries.

## Estimated Nutrition

*(Includes sourdough and ½ cup raspberries)*

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~535 kcal | Calcium | ~310 mg |
| Protein | 28 g | Iron | ~4.5 mg |
| Fat | 29 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 41 g | Probiotics | Yes |
| Fiber | 9.5 g | Vitamin C | ~20 mg |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes 28 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes 9.5 g) | Satiety (Excellent)

# Arc Mediterranean Vegetable Omelet

## Ingredients

- 2 large eggs
- 2 large egg whites
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- ¼ cup zucchini, diced
- ¼ cup tomatoes, diced
- 2 Tbsp red onion, diced
- 2 Tbsp roasted red peppers, chopped
- ½ cup fresh spinach
- 1 oz feta cheese, crumbled
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 Tbsp fresh basil, chopped
- ½ tsp dried oregano
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- Pinch of salt

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 small garlic clove, peeled
- ½ cup fresh raspberries

## Directions

1. Heat 1 teaspoon of olive oil in a nonstick skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the zucchini and red onion. Sauté for 2–3 minutes until they begin to soften.
3. Add the tomatoes, roasted red peppers, and spinach. Cook for another 1–2 minutes, until the spinach is wilted and any excess moisture has evaporated.
4. In a small bowl, whisk together the eggs, egg whites, oregano, black pepper, and salt.
5. Pour the egg mixture evenly over the vegetables. Reduce the heat to medium-low and cook gently until the eggs are nearly set.
6. Sprinkle the feta cheese over one half of the omelet. Fold the other half over the filling and continue cooking for approximately 1 minute, until the eggs are fully set and the feta begins to soften.
7. Transfer the omelet to a plate and finish with the fresh parsley and basil.
8. Toast the sourdough bread. While it is still warm, lightly rub the surface with the peeled garlic clove and drizzle with 1 teaspoon of extra virgin olive oil.
9. Serve immediately with the garlic sourdough toast and fresh raspberries.

## Estimated Nutrition

*(Includes sourdough and ½ cup raspberries)*

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~525 kcal | Calcium | ~330 mg |
| Protein | ~31 g | Iron | ~4 mg |
| Fat | ~26 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbohydrates | ~39 g | Vitamin A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~9 g | Vitamin C | ~45 mg |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes ~31 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes ~9 g) | Satiety (Excellent)

# Jennifer’s Sardines & Eggs Power Plate

## Ingredients

- 1 can (3.75 oz) sardines in extra virgin olive oil, lightly drained
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- ½ cup baby spinach
- ¼ cup shelled edamame
- ¼ cup microgreens
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- Pinch of sea salt
- Lemon wedge

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- ½ cup fresh blueberries

> **Bean Flex:**
> Substitute edamame for any of the bean flex options. Nutrition remains approximately: Calories: 530–555 kcal, Protein: 34–37 g, Fiber: 9–11 g.

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a nonstick skillet over medium heat.
2. Lightly warm the sardines for 1–2 minutes. Remove from the skillet and set aside.
3. Cook the eggs to your preference (over easy is recommended).
4. Allow the spinach to wilt in the remaining heat for about 30 seconds.
5. Arrange the spinach on a serving plate. Top with the sardines, eggs, edamame, avocado, cherry tomatoes, and microgreens.
6. Season with fresh cracked black pepper, a pinch of sea salt, and a squeeze of fresh lemon juice.
7. Serve with toasted whole-grain sourdough and fresh blueberries.

## Estimated Nutrition

*(Includes whole-grain sourdough, blueberries, and edamame)*

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~545 kcal | Calcium | ~420 mg |
| Protein | 36 g | Iron | ~5 mg |
| Fat | 30 g | Potassium | ~1,150 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 35 g | Omega-3 EPA/DHA | Excellent |
| Fiber | 10 g | Vitamin B12 / D | Excellent |

> **Arc Nutrition Score:**
> ≥25 g Protein (Yes 36 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes 10 g) | Brain Health (Excellent) | Satiety (Excellent)

# Spinach & Feta Scramble

## Ingredients

- 2 large eggs
- 2 large egg whites
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 cup fresh baby spinach
- 2 Tbsp red onion, diced
- ¼ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¾ oz feta cheese, crumbled
- 3 Kalamata olives, halved
- 3 green olives, sliced
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- ½ tsp dried oregano
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- Pinch of sea salt

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- ½ cup fresh strawberries

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a nonstick skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the diced onion and sauté for 2–3 minutes until softened.
3. Add the spinach and cook until just wilted.
4. Whisk together the eggs, egg whites, oregano, black pepper, and a small pinch of salt.
5. Pour the eggs into the skillet and gently stir with a silicone spatula, creating soft curds as they cook.
6. During the final minute of cooking, fold in the feta cheese, cherry tomatoes, green olives, and Kalamata olives. Cook just long enough to warm the tomatoes and soften the feta while keeping the eggs tender.
7. Transfer to a serving plate and garnish with fresh parsley.
8. Toast the whole-grain sourdough. Drizzle with the extra virgin olive oil and serve alongside the scramble with fresh strawberries.

> **Bean Flex:** Looking for extra fiber? Add Cannellini Beans, Lima Beans, Black-Eyed Peas, Great Northern Beans, or Navy Beans (⅓ cup).

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~525 kcal | Calcium | ~320 mg |
| Protein | 31 g | Iron | ~4 mg |
| Fat | 27 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 35 g | Vitamin C | ~55 mg |
| Fiber | 9 g | Vitamin K | Excellent |

# Frenchie's Mushroom & Herb Omelet

## Ingredients

- 2 large eggs
- 2 large egg whites
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 cup cremini mushrooms, sliced
- 2 Tbsp shallot, finely diced
- 1 cup baby spinach
- 1 oz goat cheese, crumbled
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- ½ tsp fresh rosemary, finely minced
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- Pinch of sea salt

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- ½ cup fresh blackberries

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a nonstick skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the mushrooms and shallots. Sauté for 5–6 minutes until the mushrooms release their moisture and become golden brown.
3. Add the spinach and cook just until wilted.
4. In a small bowl, whisk together the eggs, egg whites, black pepper, and a pinch of sea salt.
5. Pour the egg mixture over the vegetables and cook gently until almost set.
6. Sprinkle the goat cheese, parsley, thyme, and rosemary over one half of the omelet. Fold the omelet in half and continue cooking for about 1 minute, just until the cheese begins to soften.
7. Transfer to a serving plate.
8. Toast the whole-grain sourdough and drizzle with the extra virgin olive oil.
9. Serve immediately with the toast and fresh blackberries.

> **Cheese Flex:** Not a fan of goat cheese? Use any of the cheese flex options to substitute.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~515 kcal | Calcium | ~300 mg |
| Protein | 31 g | Iron | ~4 mg |
| Fat | 25 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 34 g | Vitamin K | Excellent |
| Fiber | 9 g | Copper | Excellent |

# Smoked Salmon & Avocado Plate

## Ingredients

- 3 oz wild smoked salmon
- 2 hard-boiled eggs, halved
- ¼ cup hummus
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- ½ cup cucumber, sliced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes
- 2 Tbsp thinly sliced red onion
- 1 Tbsp capers
- 3 Kalamata olives
- 3 green olives
- 1 Tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- Lemon wedges

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- ½ cup fresh blueberries

**Egg Alternatives:**
Instead of 2 Eggs, try Cannellini Bean Mash (⅓ cup), Cottage Cheese (½ cup), Labneh (¼ cup), or Plain Greek Yogurt (½ cup).

## Directions

1. Arrange the smoked salmon on one side of a serving plate.
2. Place the hummus in a small mound on the plate and use the back of a spoon to create a shallow swirl.
3. Arrange the hard-boiled eggs, avocado, cucumber, cherry tomatoes, olives, capers, and red onion around the salmon and hummus.
4. Drizzle the vegetables and avocado with the extra virgin olive oil.
5. Sprinkle with fresh dill and finish with fresh cracked black pepper.
6. Serve with fresh lemon wedges for squeezing over the salmon and vegetables.
7. Enjoy alongside toasted whole-grain sourdough and fresh blueberries.

**Mezze Plate Ideas:** Build your own plate by adding white bean salad, roasted red peppers, marinated artichokes, microgreens, or extra cucumber/olives.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~585 kcal | Calcium | ~220 mg |
| Protein | 37 g | Iron | ~4 mg |
| Fat | 31 g | Potassium | ~1,150 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 39 g | Omega-3 EPA/DHA | Excellent |
| Fiber | 11 g | Vitamin D & B12 | Excellent |

# Cottage Cheese Egg Bake

## Ingredients

*Makes 4 Servings*

- 6 large eggs
- 1 cup low-fat cottage cheese
- 1 cup baby spinach, chopped
- 1 cup mushrooms, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup roasted red peppers, diced
- ¼ cup red onion, diced
- ½ cup shredded mozzarella cheese
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tsp fresh thyme
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- ½ tsp onion powder
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil (for greasing)

## Serve With (Per Serving)

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- 1 medium kiwi, peeled and sliced

## Directions

1. Preheat oven to 375°F. Lightly grease an 8×8-inch baking dish with the olive oil.
2. In a skillet over medium heat, sauté the mushrooms and onion for 4–5 minutes until softened. Add the spinach during the final minute and cook until wilted. Remove from the heat and allow the vegetables to cool slightly.
3. In a large mixing bowl, whisk together the eggs, cottage cheese, garlic powder, onion powder, salt, and pepper.
4. Fold in the cooked vegetables, roasted red peppers, cherry tomatoes, mozzarella, parsley, and thyme.
5. Pour the mixture evenly into the prepared baking dish.
6. Bake for 30–35 minutes, or until the center is fully set and lightly golden.
7. Allow the egg bake to cool for 5–10 minutes before slicing into 4 equal servings.
8. Serve one portion with toasted whole-grain sourdough and fresh kiwi.

> **Cheese Flex:** Customize your egg bake with your favorite cheese while keeping the meal balanced.

## Estimated Nutrition (Per Serving)

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~500 kcal | Calcium | ~420 mg |
| Protein | 34 g | Iron | ~3.8 mg |
| Fat | 23 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 35 g | Vitamin C & K | Excellent |
| Fiber | 9 g | Satiety | Excellent |

# Mediterranean Shakshuka

## Ingredients

- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- ¼ cup diced yellow onion
- 1 clove garlic, minced
- ½ red bell pepper, diced
- 1 cup crushed tomatoes (no sugar added)
- ⅓ cup cannellini beans, drained and rinsed
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- ½ tsp ground cumin
- ¼ tsp coriander
- ¼ tsp crushed red pepper flakes (optional)
- Sea salt and fresh cracked black pepper, to taste
- 2 large eggs
- 2 large egg whites
- 1 oz feta cheese, crumbled
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 Tbsp fresh cilantro, chopped
- Lemon wedge

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- ½ cup fresh blackberries

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a medium skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the onion and bell pepper. Cook for 4–5 minutes until softened.
3. Stir in the garlic and cook for another 30 seconds until fragrant.
4. Add the crushed tomatoes, cannellini beans, smoked paprika, cumin, coriander, crushed red pepper flakes (if using), salt, and pepper.
5. Using the back of a spoon, gently mash about half of the beans into the tomato sauce, leaving the remaining beans whole for texture.
6. Reduce the heat to low and simmer for 8–10 minutes until the sauce thickens slightly.
7. Create four small wells in the sauce and carefully crack in the eggs and egg whites.
8. Cover the skillet and cook for 5–7 minutes, or until the eggs reach your preferred doneness.
9. Sprinkle with feta cheese, parsley, and cilantro.
10. Serve immediately with toasted whole-grain sourdough, fresh blackberries, and a squeeze of fresh lemon.

> **Flex Options:** Swap the beans or cheese for any of the flex options to keep it fresh!

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~515 kcal | Calcium | ~320 mg |
| Protein | 32 g | Iron | ~4.5 mg |
| Fat | 22 g | Potassium | ~1,150 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 37 g | Vitamin K | Excellent |
| Fiber | 10 g | Lycopene | Excellent |

# Arc White Bean Shakshuka

## Ingredients

- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- ¼ cup yellow onion, diced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 cup baby spinach
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¾ cup cannellini beans, drained and rinsed
- 2 Tbsp roasted red peppers, diced
- ¼ tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ½ tsp dried oregano
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- Pinch of sea salt
- 2 large eggs
- 2 large egg whites
- 1 oz feta cheese, crumbled
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 Tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- Lemon wedges

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- ½ cup fresh raspberries

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a medium skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the onion and sauté for 3–4 minutes until softened. Stir in the garlic and cook for 30 seconds until fragrant.
3. Add the cannellini beans and gently mash about half with the back of a spoon, creating a creamy base while leaving the remaining beans whole.
4. Stir in the roasted red peppers, cherry tomatoes, spinach, cumin, paprika, oregano, salt, and pepper. Cook for 3–4 minutes until the spinach wilts and the tomatoes begin to soften.
5. Using the back of a spoon, create four shallow wells in the bean mixture. Crack the eggs and egg whites into the wells.
6. Cover and cook over low heat for 5–7 minutes, or until the eggs reach your preferred doneness.
7. Sprinkle with feta cheese, parsley, and dill. Finish with a generous squeeze of fresh lemon juice.
8. Serve immediately with toasted whole-grain sourdough and fresh raspberries.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~530 kcal | Calcium | ~340 mg |
| Protein | 33 g | Iron | ~5 mg |
| Fat | 22 g | Potassium | ~1,300 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 42 g | Vitamin C | ~40 mg |
| Fiber | 12 g | Vitamin K | Excellent |

# Muffin Tin Egg Cups

## Ingredients (Makes 12 Cups / 6 Servings)

- 10 large eggs
- 1 cup egg whites
- ½ cup low-fat cottage cheese
- 1 tsp garlic powder, ½ tsp onion powder, ½ tsp dried oregano
- ½ tsp black pepper, ½ tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil (for muffin pan)

## Flavor Variations

**Flavor 1 – Roasted Red Pepper & Feta (4 Cups):** ¼ cup roasted red peppers (diced), 2 Tbsp feta cheese, 1 Tbsp parsley.
**Flavor 2 – Spinach, Artichoke & Parmesan (4 Cups):** ½ cup chopped spinach, ¼ cup chopped artichokes, 2 Tbsp grated Parmesan.
**Flavor 3 – Mushroom, Sun-Dried Tomato & Goat Cheese (4 Cups):** ½ cup diced mushrooms, 2 Tbsp chopped sun-dried tomatoes, 2 Tbsp goat cheese, 1 tsp fresh thyme.

## Serve With (Per Serving – 2 Cups)

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- Fruit Flex (Choose your favorite fruit)

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Lightly grease a 12-cup muffin pan with olive oil.
2. Whisk together the eggs, egg whites, cottage cheese, garlic powder, onion powder, oregano, salt, and pepper until smooth.
3. Fill each muffin cup about halfway with the egg mixture.
4. Create three flavor sections in the muffin pan. For four cups, divide the roasted red peppers, feta, and parsley evenly. For four cups, divide the spinach, artichokes, and Parmesan evenly. For the remaining four cups, divide the mushrooms, sun-dried tomatoes, goat cheese, and thyme evenly.
5. Top each cup with the remaining egg mixture.
6. Bake for 20–25 minutes, or until puffed and the centers are set.
7. Allow to cool for 5 minutes before removing from the pan. Serve two egg cups with whole-grain sourdough and your favorite Fruit Flex selection.

> **Meal Prep Friendly:** Excellent | **Freezer Friendly:** Excellent

## Estimated Nutrition (Per Serving)

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~490 kcal | Calcium | ~350 mg |
| Protein | 33 g | Iron | ~3.8 mg |
| Fat | 22 g | Potassium | ~850 mg |
| Carbohydrates | ~32–36 g | Vitamin K & C | Good |
| Fiber | ~8–10 g | Folate | ~170 mcg |

# Sweet Potato Hash with Eggs

## Ingredients

- 2 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 cups sweet potatoes, peeled and ½-inch diced
- 8 oz lean ground turkey sausage (Mediterranean seasoned)
- 1 cup Brussels sprouts, shaved or thinly sliced
- 1 cup mushrooms, sliced
- ½ red bell pepper, diced
- ½ cup red onion, diced
- 2 cups baby spinach
- 4 large eggs
- 1 ripe avocado, sliced
- 2 Tbsp pumpkin seeds (pepitas)
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- ½ tsp garlic powder
- ½ tsp dried oregano
- ¼ tsp thyme
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- Sea salt, to taste
- Lemon wedges

## Serve With

- 1 small clementine or 1 medium kiwi

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F. Toss the sweet potatoes with 1 teaspoon of olive oil, smoked paprika, garlic powder, oregano, salt, and pepper. Spread onto a parchment-lined baking sheet and roast for 20–25 minutes, stirring halfway, until caramelized and tender.
2. Meanwhile, heat the remaining teaspoon of olive oil in a large cast-iron skillet over medium heat.
3. Add the turkey sausage and cook until browned, breaking it into crumbles.
4. Add the Brussels sprouts, mushrooms, onion, and bell pepper. Sauté for 6–8 minutes until the vegetables are tender and lightly caramelized.
5. Fold in the roasted sweet potatoes and spinach, cooking just until the spinach wilts.
6. Create four small wells in the hash and crack an egg into each.
7. Cover and cook over medium-low heat for 5–7 minutes, or until the eggs reach your preferred doneness.
8. Remove from the heat and top with sliced avocado, pumpkin seeds, parsley, and a generous squeeze of fresh lemon.
9. Serve immediately with your choice of kiwi or a clementine.

> **Seed Flex:** Finish your hash with Pumpkin Seeds, Hemp Hearts, Sunflower Seeds, Ground Flaxseed, or Chia Seeds.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrition Score | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~515 kcal | ≥25 g Protein | Yes (33g) |
| Protein | 33 g | ≥8 g Fiber | Yes (10g) |
| Fat | 24 g | Healthy Fats | Yes |
| Carbohydrates | 36 g | Produce | Yes (Multiple) |
| Fiber | 10 g | Satiety | Excellent |

# Farmer's Skillet with Greens

## Ingredients

**Garlic Rosemary Potatoes:**

- 2 cups baby Yukon Gold potatoes, halved or quartered
- 2 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 cloves garlic, lightly smashed
- 1 tsp fresh rosemary, chopped
- ½ tsp smoked paprika, ½ tsp sea salt, ¼ tsp fresh cracked black pepper

**Farmer's Skillet:**

- 8 oz chicken apple sausage, sliced into ½-inch rounds
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, thickly sliced
- ½ medium yellow onion, sliced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 cups Swiss chard, chopped
- 1 cup kale, stems removed and chopped
- 2 Tbsp low-sodium chicken broth
- 4 large eggs
- ¼ cup shaved Parmesan cheese
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- Fruit Flex (Choose your favorite fruit)

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F. Toss the potatoes with the olive oil, rosemary, smashed garlic, smoked paprika, salt, and pepper. Spread onto a parchment-lined baking sheet and roast for 25–30 minutes, stirring halfway through, until golden brown with crispy edges.
2. Meanwhile, heat 1 teaspoon olive oil in a large cast-iron skillet over medium heat.
3. Add the chicken apple sausage and cook for 3–4 minutes until lightly browned. Remove and set aside.
4. Add the mushrooms and onion to the skillet. Cook for 6–8 minutes until the mushrooms are browned and the onions are soft and lightly caramelized.
5. Stir in the minced garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
6. Add the Swiss chard, kale, and chicken broth. Cover for 2 minutes, then uncover and continue cooking until the greens are tender and most of the liquid has evaporated.
7. Return the roasted potatoes and chicken apple sausage to the skillet and gently stir to combine.
8. Using the back of a spoon, create four small wells in the mixture and crack one egg into each.
9. Cover and cook over medium-low heat for 5–7 minutes, or until the eggs reach your preferred doneness.
10. Sprinkle with shaved Parmesan and fresh parsley before serving warm with your favorite fruit.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~515 kcal | Calcium | ~320 mg |
| Protein | 33 g | Iron | ~5 mg |
| Fat | 23 g | Potassium | ~1,200 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 35–39 g | Vitamin A & C | Excellent |
| Fiber | 9–10 g | Vitamin K | Exceptional |

# Overnight Oats Builder

*One Base. Endless Breakfasts.*

## Step 1 • Build the Protein Base

Combine in a jar:

- ⅓ cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ¾ cup plain nonfat Greek yogurt
- ¼ cup unsweetened almond milk
- 2 tsp chia seeds
- 2 tsp ground flaxseed

Mix well and refrigerate overnight.

## Step 2 • Choose Your Flavor

- **Chocolate:** 1 tsp unsweetened cocoa powder + ½ tsp vanilla
- **Strawberry Vanilla:** ½ tsp vanilla extract
- **Blueberry Lemon:** 1 tsp fresh lemon zest
- **Peach Almond:** ¼ tsp almond extract
- **Apple Cinnamon:** ½ tsp cinnamon
- **Cherry Pistachio:** ¼ tsp vanilla extract
- **Mocha:** 1 tsp cocoa powder + ½ tsp espresso powder
- **Tropical:** 1 Tbsp unsweetened coconut
- **Pear Cardamom:** Pinch of ground cardamom
- **Ginger Peach:** Pinch of ground ginger

## Step 3 • Add Fruit

Choose one serving:
**Berries:** Blueberries, Strawberries, Raspberries, Blackberries
**Orchard:** Peach, Pear, Apple, Cherries
**Bright & Fresh:** Kiwi, Pomegranate Arils, Orange Segments

## Step 4 • Choose Your Crunch

Choose one: Walnuts (1 tsp), Pistachios (1 tsp), Almonds (1 tsp), Pumpkin Seeds (1 Tbsp), Hemp Hearts (1 Tbsp), or Sunflower Seeds (1 Tbsp).

## Step 5 • Arc Finishes

Choose one or two: Cinnamon, Lemon zest, Orange zest, Vanilla, Almond extract, Unsweetened cocoa powder, Espresso powder, Fresh mint, Unsweetened coconut flakes, Cacao nibs.

> **Favorites**
> **Chocolate Raspberry:** Chocolate base, Fresh raspberries, Walnuts, Cacao nibs
> **Strawberry Shortcake:** Vanilla base, Fresh strawberries, Sliced almonds, Lemon zest
> **Blueberry Lemon:** Lemon base, Blueberries, Pistachios, Extra lemon zest
> **Peach Cobbler:** Cinnamon base, Fresh peaches, Walnuts, Pumpkin seeds
> **Apple Pie:** Cinnamon base, Diced apples, Walnuts, Extra cinnamon
> **Cherry Pistachio:** Vanilla base, Fresh cherries, Pistachios, Orange zest
> **Mocha Morning:** Chocolate espresso base, Walnuts, Cacao nibs

## Nutrition Goals

| Goal | Target |
|---|---|
| Protein | 25–30 g |
| Fiber | 8+ g |
| Healthy Fats / Produce | Yes (At least one serving produce) |
| Added Sugar | None by default |
| Meal Prep Friendly | Excellent |

# Chia Breakfast Jar Blueprint

*One Recipe. Endless Possibilities.*

## Step 1 • Build the Protein Base

Mix together:

- ¾ cup plain nonfat Greek yogurt
- ¼ cup unsweetened almond milk
- 3 Tbsp chia seeds
- 1 tsp ground flaxseed

Stir well. Let stand for 5 minutes. Stir again. Refrigerate overnight.

## Step 2 • Choose Your Flavor

- **Chocolate:** 1 tsp cocoa powder + ½ tsp vanilla
- **Strawberry Vanilla:** ½ tsp vanilla + diced strawberries
- **Blueberry Lemon:** 1 tsp lemon zest + blueberries
- **Peach Almond:** ¼ tsp almond extract + diced peaches
- **Cherry Pistachio:** Chopped cherries + pistachios
- **Tropical:** Unsweetened coconut + diced kiwi
- **Apple Cinnamon:** Cinnamon + diced apple
- **Mocha:** 1 tsp cocoa + ½ tsp espresso powder
- **Pear Cardamom:** Ground cardamom + diced pear
- **Orange Vanilla:** Orange zest + vanilla

## Step 3 • Add Fruit

Choose one serving: Blueberries, Strawberries, Blackberries, Raspberries, Kiwi, Peach, Pear, Apple, Cherries, Pomegranate Arils.

## Step 4 • Choose a Crunch

Choose one (1 Tbsp each): Walnuts, Pistachios, Almonds, Pumpkin Seeds, Hemp Hearts, or Sunflower Seeds.

## Step 5 • Finishes

Choose one or two: Cinnamon, Lemon zest, Orange zest, Vanilla, Almond extract, Unsweetened cocoa powder, Espresso powder, Fresh mint, Toasted coconut (unsweetened), Cacao nibs.

> **Favorites**
> **Chocolate Raspberry:** Chocolate base, Fresh raspberries, Walnuts, Cacao nibs
> **Strawberry Cheesecake:** Vanilla base, Fresh strawberries, Almonds, Lemon zest
> **Blueberry Lemon:** Lemon base, Blueberries, Pistachios, Extra lemon zest
> **Peach Almond:** Almond base, Fresh peaches, Pumpkin seeds, Cinnamon
> **Mocha Morning:** Chocolate + espresso base, Walnuts, Cacao nibs

## Nutrition Goals

| Goal | Target |
|---|---|
| Protein | 25–30 g |
| Fiber | 8+ g |
| Healthy Fats / Produce | Yes (At least one serving produce) |
| Added Sugar | None by default |
| Meal Prep Friendly | Excellent |

# Toast Bar

*The Formula is simple: Whole Grain + Protein + Healthy Fat + Produce + Flavor. Build one layer at a time.*

## Step 1 • Choose Your Bread

- Whole-Grain Sourdough (Recommended, 1 slice)
- Sprouted Grain Bread (1 slice)
- Seeded Whole Wheat Bread (1 slice)
- Rye Bread (1 slice)
- Dense Multigrain Bread (1 slice)

## Step 2 • Choose Your Protein

Aim for 20–30 grams (choose 1 or combine 2):

- Cottage Cheese (½ cup)
- Plain Greek Yogurt (½ cup)
- Smoked Salmon (3 oz)
- Sardines (1 small can)
- Hard-Boiled Eggs (2)
- Sliced Turkey Breast (3 oz)
- White Bean Mash (½ cup)
- Hummus (¼ cup)
- Ricotta Cheese (¼ cup - combine with another)

## Step 3 • Add Healthy Fats

Choose one:

- Avocado (¼ medium)
- Extra Virgin Olive Oil (1 tsp drizzle)
- Chopped Walnuts (1 Tbsp)
- Pumpkin Seeds (1 Tbsp)
- Hemp Hearts (1 Tbsp)
- Tahini (1 Tbsp)

## Step 4 • Add Color

Choose at least two.
**Savory:** Tomatoes, Cucumber, Radishes, Roasted Red Peppers, Arugula, Spinach, Microgreens, Red Onion, Fresh Herbs, Avocado (if not chosen above).
**Sweet:** Blueberries, Strawberries, Blackberries, Raspberries, Peaches, Pears, Apples, Kiwi, Pomegranate Arils.

## Step 5 • Finish with Flavor

Choose one or two: Fresh Dill, Fresh Basil, Parsley, Chives, Lemon Zest, Fresh Cracked Pepper, Everything Bagel Seasoning, Smoked Paprika, Red Pepper Flakes, Cinnamon, Drizzle of EVOO, Balsamic Glaze.

> **Favorites**
> **Mediterranean Sunrise:** Whole-Grain Sourdough, Hummus, Smoked Salmon, Cucumber, Tomato, Red Onion, Fresh Dill, Cracked Pepper
> **Farmer's Garden:** Whole-Grain Sourdough, Cottage Cheese, Sliced Tomato, Microgreens, Pumpkin Seeds, Parsley, Olive Oil
> **Blue Zone Breakfast:** Whole-Grain Sourdough, White Bean Mash, Avocado, Radishes, Microgreens, Lemon Zest, Parsley
> **Berry & Walnut:** Whole-Grain Sourdough, Greek Yogurt, Blueberries, Raspberries, Walnuts, Cinnamon
> **Mediterranean Orchard:** Whole-Grain Sourdough, Ricotta, Sliced Pear, Pistachios, Honey (optional), Fresh Thyme

## Nutrition Goals

| Goal | Target |
|---|---|
| Protein / Fiber | 25–30 g / 8+ g |
| Healthy Fats / Whole Grains | Yes / Yes |
| Produce / Polyphenols | At least 2 colors / Daily |

# SECTION 3: LUNCH

*Nourishment That Carries You Through the Day*

Sardine & White Bean Mediterranean Plate

Greek Chicken Pita Bowl

Smoked Salmon & Avocado Salad

Mediterranean Tuna & Lentil Salad

Lemon Herb Chicken Grain Bowls

Mediterranean Turkey Meatball Bowls

Southwest Chicken & Black Bean Bowls

Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Bowls

Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup

Mediterranean Lentil Soup

Chicken & Vegetable Orzo Soup

Roasted Tomato & White Bean Soup

Grilled Mediterranean Shrimp Bowl

Herbed Cod with Lentil Salad

Mediterranean Stuffed Bell Peppers

Mediterranean Bean Salad

Warm Sweet Potato, Chickpea & Tahini Bowl

Falafel Bowl with Lemon Herb Tahini

## Southwest Chicken & Black Bean Bowl

*Bold flavors, lean protein and fiber-rich ingredients for a satisfying, feel-good meal.*

## Herbed Cod with Lentil Salad

*Flaky cod meets a bright, herby lentil salad for a light yet nourishing Mediterranean inspired dish.*

## Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup

*Hearty white beans, tender kale and aromatic herbs in a comforting soup you'll want all year long.*

## Falafel Bowl with Lemon Herb Tahini

*Crispy falafel, fresh veggies, hummus and quinoa drizzled with creamy lemon herb tahini for a bright, nourishing bowl.*

## Mediterranean Stuffed Bell Peppers

*Colorful bell peppers filled with a savory mix of grains, herbs, olives and feta—baked until tender and flavorful.*

## Smoked Salmon & Avocado Salad

*Delicate smoked salmon, creamy avocado and crisp greens with a lemon dill vinaigrette for a light, elegant meal.*

## Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Bowls

*Hearty lentils and roasted vegetables with greens, feta and a lemon tahini drizzle—packed with flavor and nutrients.*

## Chicken & Vegetable Orzo Soup

*A warm and comforting soup with tender chicken, veggies, orzo and herbs—nourishing, satisfying and perfect year-round.*

## Mediterranean Bean Salad

*A refreshing mix of beans, veggies, olives and feta tossed in a lemony herb dressing—perfect for lunch or meal prep.*

# Sardine & White Bean Mediterranean Plate

## Ingredients

- 1 can (3.75 oz) sardines in extra virgin olive oil, lightly drained
- ½ cup cannellini beans, rinsed and drained
- 2 cups mixed baby greens
- ¼ cup microgreens
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cucumber, sliced
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- 2 Tbsp Kalamata olives, halved
- 1 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese (optional)
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp fresh lemon juice
- ½ tsp Dijon mustard
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- Pinch of sea salt
- Fresh parsley, chopped (optional)

## Serve With

- 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough bread
- 1 fresh orange or ½ cup berries

## Directions

1. In a small bowl, whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, pepper, and a small pinch of sea salt.
2. Arrange the mixed greens on a large plate or shallow bowl.
3. Add the cannellini beans, cucumber, tomatoes, olives, avocado, feta, and microgreens.
4. Top with the warmed sardines.
5. Drizzle with the lemon vinaigrette.
6. Finish with fresh parsley and another squeeze of lemon if desired.
7. Serve with toasted sourdough and fresh fruit.

## Estimated Nutrition

**Estimated Nutrition (Includes sourdough and one small orange)**

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~555 kcal | Calcium | ~430 mg |
| Protein | ~33 g | Iron | ~5.5 mg |
| Fat | ~29 g | Potassium | ~1,250 mg |
| Carbs | ~40 g | Omega-3 | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~13 g | Vit B12/D | Excellent |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes 33 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes 13 g) | Heart Health (Excellent)

# Green Chicken Pita Bowl

## Ingredients

- **For the Chicken:**
- 5 oz grilled chicken breast, sliced
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- ½ tsp dried oregano
- ½ tsp paprika
- ¼ tsp onion powder
- Pinch of sea salt
- Fresh cracked black pepper
- **For the Bowl:**
- 2 cups chopped romaine lettuce
- ½ cup cucumber, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup diced red onion
- ¼ cup chopped parsley
- ¼ cup cannellini beans
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp tzatziki
- 1 Tbsp hummus

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex (Choose One):** ½ whole wheat pita, ½ cup cooked quinoa, ½ cup farro, or ½ cup roasted baby potatoes
- **Fruit Flex (Optional):** ½ cup grapes, 1 small clementine, or ½ cup strawberries

## Directions

1. Season the chicken with olive oil, garlic powder, oregano, paprika, onion powder, salt, and pepper.
2. Grill or pan-sear over medium-high heat for 5–6 minutes per side, or until the internal temperature reaches 165°F. Allow the chicken to rest for 5 minutes before slicing.
3. Arrange the romaine in a large bowl.
4. Top with the cucumber, tomatoes, red onion, parsley, cannellini beans, feta, sliced chicken, hummus, and tzatziki.
5. Serve with your favorite Smart Carb Flex option.

## Arc Tip

*Meal prep the chicken and chopped vegetables separately, then assemble fresh throughout the week. Add your chosen Smart Carb Flex just before serving to keep textures at their best.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Without Smart Carb Flex

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~470 kcal | Calcium | ~260 mg |
| Protein | ~45 g | Iron | ~3.5 mg |
| Fat | ~22 g | Potassium | ~1,050 mg |
| Carbs | ~18 g | Vit K & A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~7 g | Niacin | Excellent |

### With ½ Whole Wheat Pita

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~555 kcal | Protein | ~48 g |
| Fat | ~23 g | Carbs | ~35 g |
| Fiber | ~10 g | Net Carbs | ~25 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes 45 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes with Flex) | Heart Health (Excellent)

# Smoked Salmon & Avocado Salad

## Ingredients

- **For the Salad:**
- 4 oz wild-caught smoked salmon, torn
- 2 cups mixed spring greens
- ½ cup cucumber, sliced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- ¼ cup thinly sliced radishes
- 2 Tbsp pickled red onions
- 2 Tbsp capers
- ¼ cup microgreens
- 1 Tbsp chopped fresh dill
- **Lemon-Dill Vinaigrette:**
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- 1 tsp minced shallot
- ½ tsp honey (optional)
- Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** 1 slice whole-grain sourdough, ½ cup cooked farro, ½ cup cooked quinoa, or ½ cup roasted baby potatoes
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup blueberries, 1 small peach, or 1 small apple

## Directions

1. Whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, shallot, honey (if using), and black pepper until well combined.
2. Arrange the spring greens in a large bowl or on a serving platter.
3. Top with the cucumber, tomatoes, avocado, radishes, pickled onions, capers, microgreens, and smoked salmon.
4. Sprinkle with fresh dill.
5. Drizzle with the lemon-dill vinaigrette just before serving.
6. Serve with your favorite Smart Carb Flex option.

### Arc Tip

*Smoked salmon already brings plenty of flavor, so there's no need to overdress the salad. A light lemon vinaigrette lets the fresh herbs, vegetables, and salmon shine while keeping the meal bright and balanced.*

## Estimated Nutrition

**Without Smart Carb Flex**

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~390 kcal | Calcium | ~180 mg |
| Protein | ~28 g | Iron | ~3 mg |
| Fat | ~25 g | Potassium | ~1,050 mg |
| Carbs | ~13 g | Omega-3 | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~7 g | Vit B12/D | Excellent |

**With 1 Slice Whole-Grain Sourdough**

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~490 kcal | Protein | ~31 g |
| Fat | ~26 g | Carbs | ~33 g |
| Fiber | ~10 g | Net Carbs | ~23 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes 28 g) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Brain Health (Excellent)

# Mediterranean Tuna & Lentil Salad

## Ingredients

- **For the Salad:**
- 1 can (5 oz) wild-caught tuna in water or olive oil, drained
- ½ cup cooked green or French lentils
- 2 cups mixed baby greens
- ½ cup cucumber, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup diced red onion
- 2 Tbsp Kalamata olives, halved
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- 1 Tbsp chopped fresh mint (optional)
- **Lemon-Herb Vinaigrette:**
- 1 Tbsp EVOO, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, ½ tsp minced garlic, ½ tsp dried oregano, Black pepper, Sea salt

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** 1 slice whole-grain sourdough, ½ cup cooked quinoa, ½ cup cooked farro, or ½ cup roasted baby potatoes
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup strawberries, 1 small apple, or 1 small clementine

## Directions

1. Whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, garlic, oregano, pepper, and a pinch of sea salt until emulsified.
2. Arrange the mixed greens in a large bowl.
3. Top with the lentils, tuna, cucumber, tomatoes, red onion, olives, feta, parsley, and mint.
4. Drizzle with the vinaigrette and gently toss to combine.
5. Serve immediately with your favorite Smart Carb Flex option.

## Arc Tip

*Cook a batch of lentils at the beginning of the week and refrigerate them for quick lunches. Lentils hold their texture beautifully and often taste even better after absorbing the flavors of a simple vinaigrette.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Without Smart Carb Flex

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~430 kcal | Calcium | ~210 mg |
| Protein | ~39 g | Iron | ~4.5 mg |
| Fat | ~18 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbs | ~21 g | Vit B12 | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~9 g | Selenium | Excellent |

### With 1 Slice Whole-Grain Sourdough

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~530 kcal | Protein | ~42 g |
| Fat | ~19 g | Carbs | ~41 g |
| Fiber | ~12 g | Net Carbs | ~29 g |

> **Arc Nutrition Score:**
> ≥25 g Protein (Yes 39 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes 9 g) | Heart Health (Excellent)

# Lemon Herb Chicken Grain Bowl

## Ingredients

- **For the Chicken:**
- 5 oz boneless, skinless chicken breast
- 1 tsp EVOO, 1 tsp lemon zest, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp dried oregano, ½ tsp garlic powder, ½ tsp onion powder
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- **For the Bowl:**
- 2 cups baby spinach or mixed greens
- ½ cup cooked quinoa
- ¼ cup chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- ½ cup cucumber, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup roasted red peppers, sliced
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- **Lemon Herb Dressing:**
- 1 Tbsp EVOO, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 1 tsp honey (optional), 1 tsp chopped fresh parsley, Black pepper

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** ½ cup cooked farro, ½ cup roasted sweet potato, or 1 slice whole-grain sourdough
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup blueberries, 1 small peach, or 1 cup grapes

## Directions

1. Whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, lemon zest, oregano, garlic powder, onion powder, salt, and pepper. Coat the chicken and marinate.
2. Grill or pan-sear over medium-high heat for 5–6 minutes per side. Let rest for 5 minutes before slicing.
3. Prepare the dressing by whisking together the olive oil, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, honey, parsley, and pepper.
4. Arrange the greens in a large bowl.
5. Top with the quinoa, chickpeas, cucumber, tomatoes, roasted red peppers, avocado, feta, and sliced chicken.
6. Drizzle with the lemon herb dressing just before serving.

## Arc Tip

*Double the chicken and quinoa while you're cooking. Store the components separately in the refrigerator, then build fresh bowls throughout the week. Keeping the dressing separate until serving helps preserve the crisp texture.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~560 kcal | Calcium | ~240 mg |
| Protein | ~43 g | Iron | ~4 mg |
| Fat | ~28 g | Potassium | ~1,250 mg |
| Carbs | ~29 g | Vit A & K | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~10 g | Niacin | Excellent |

### With Smart Carb Flex

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~650-670 kcal | Protein | ~45 g |
| Carbs | ~48-50 g | Fiber | ~13 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes 43 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes 10 g) | Heart Health (Excellent)

# Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup

## Ingredients

- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 small yellow onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tsp dried oregano, 1 tsp dried thyme
- ¼ tsp crushed red pepper flakes (optional)
- 1 Parmesan rind (optional, but recommended)
- 4 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 1 (15 oz) can cannellini beans, drained and rinsed
- 1 cup cooked Great Northern beans or cannellini beans
- 2 cups chopped Tuscan kale, stems removed
- 1 cup diced zucchini
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** 1 slice toasted sourdough, ½ cup cooked farro (stirred in), ½ cup cooked quinoa, or ½ cup cooked white beans
- **Garnish:** Fresh grated Parmesan, EVOO drizzle, Fresh basil

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a large Dutch oven over medium heat.
2. Add the onion, carrots, and celery. Cook for 6–8 minutes until softened.
3. Add the garlic, oregano, thyme, and red pepper flakes. Cook for 30 seconds until fragrant.
4. Pour in the vegetable broth and add the Parmesan rind, if using.
5. Stir in the cannellini beans, cooked white beans, and zucchini. Bring to a gentle simmer for 15 minutes.
6. Remove about 1½ cups of the soup and blend until smooth, then stir it back into the pot. This naturally thickens the soup without adding cream.
7. Add the kale and simmer for another 5 minutes until tender.
8. Remove the Parmesan rind. Finish with lemon juice and parsley. Taste and adjust seasoning.

## Arc Tip

*This soup tastes even better the next day. The beans, herbs, and vegetables continue to develop flavor overnight, making it an excellent recipe for meal prep. Freeze individual portions for quick lunches.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~365 kcal | Calcium | ~220 mg |
| Protein | ~18 g | Iron | ~5 mg |
| Fat | ~14 g | Potassium | ~1,100 mg |
| Carbs | ~42 g | Vit A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~13 g | Vit K | Excellent |

### With ½ Cup Cooked Farro

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~465 kcal | Protein | ~22 g |
| Carbs | ~62 g | Fiber | ~17 g |

> **Arc Nutrition Score:**
> Longevity Foods (Excellent) | Gut Health (Excellent) | Heart Health (Excellent)

# Mediterranean Stuffed Bell Peppers

## Ingredients

- **For the Peppers:**
- 2 large bell peppers (any color), halved lengthwise and seeds removed
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- **Filling:**
- 8 oz lean ground turkey (93% lean)
- ½ cup cooked quinoa
- ½ cup cooked lentils
- ½ cup diced onion
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 cup baby spinach, chopped
- ½ cup diced tomatoes
- ¼ cup crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tsp dried oregano, ½ tsp smoked paprika
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- **Garnish:** 2 Tbsp plain Greek yogurt, Fresh parsley, Lemon wedges

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** ½ cup roasted baby potatoes, ½ cup cooked farro, or 1 slice whole-grain sourdough
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup grapes, 1 small peach, or ½ cup berries

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F. Brush the bell pepper halves lightly with olive oil and place them cut-side up in a baking dish. Bake for 10 minutes.
2. Heat a large skillet over medium heat. Cook the turkey until browned.
3. Add the onion and cook for 3–4 minutes until softened.
4. Stir in the garlic, oregano, paprika, tomatoes, spinach, quinoa, and lentils. Cook for another 2–3 minutes until the spinach wilts.
5. Remove from the heat and gently stir in the feta and parsley.
6. Fill each pepper generously with the turkey mixture.
7. Return the peppers to the oven and bake for 20–25 minutes.
8. Top with a dollop of Greek yogurt, fresh parsley, and a squeeze of lemon.

## Arc Tip

*These peppers freeze beautifully. Let them cool completely, wrap individually, and freeze for up to three months. Reheat in the oven or microwave for a quick, nourishing lunch or dinner.*

## Estimated Nutrition

**Per Serving (2 Halves)**

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~510 kcal | Calcium | ~230 mg |
| Protein | ~39 g | Iron | ~4.5 mg |
| Fat | ~24 g | Potassium | ~1,250 mg |
| Carbs | ~31 g | Vit A & C | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~10 g | Zinc | Excellent |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes 39 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes 10 g) | Heart Health (Excellent)

# Herbed Cod with Lentil Salad

## Ingredients

- **For the Cod:**
- 5 oz cod fillet
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp lemon zest, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp chopped fresh parsley, 1 tsp chopped fresh dill
- ½ tsp garlic powder, Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- **Mediterranean Lentil Salad:**
- ½ cup cooked green or French lentils
- ½ cup cucumber, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 2 Tbsp diced red onion
- 2 Tbsp chopped parsley, 1 Tbsp chopped fresh mint (optional)
- 1 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- **Lemon Herb Dressing:**
- 1 Tbsp EVOO, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, ½ tsp honey (optional), Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** ½ cup cooked farro, ½ cup roasted baby potatoes, or 1 slice whole-grain sourdough
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup blueberries, 1 small orange, or 1 small peach

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F.
2. Pat the cod dry and brush with olive oil. Season with the lemon zest, lemon juice, parsley, dill, garlic powder, pepper, and a small pinch of sea salt.
3. Bake for 10–12 minutes, or until the fish flakes easily with a fork.
4. While the cod bakes, combine the lentils, cucumber, tomatoes, onion, parsley, mint, and feta in a bowl.
5. Whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, honey (if using), and pepper. Toss with the lentil salad.
6. Serve the warm cod over the lentil salad with an extra squeeze of fresh lemon.

## Arc Tip

*For the best texture, remove the cod from the oven as soon as it flakes easily with a fork. Overcooked cod can become dry, while perfectly cooked cod stays tender, moist, and naturally sweet.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~455 kcal | Calcium | ~180 mg |
| Protein | ~39 g | Iron | ~3.5 mg |
| Fat | ~20 g | Potassium | ~1,100 mg |
| Carbs | ~22 g | Vit B12 | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~9 g | Selenium | Excellent |

### With Smart Carb Flex

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~550-570 kcal | Protein | ~42 g |
| Carbs | ~40-42 g | Fiber | ~12 g |

> **Arc Nutrition Score:**
> ≥25 g Protein (Yes 39 g) | ≥8 g Fiber (Yes 9 g) | Heart Health (Excellent)

# Warm Sweet Potato, Chickpea & Tahini Bowl

## Ingredients

- **For the Bowl:**
- 1 medium sweet potato (about 8 oz), peeled and cut into ¾-inch cubes
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- ½ tsp smoked paprika, ½ tsp ground cumin
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- ½ cup chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- 2 cups baby spinach
- ½ cup cucumber, diced
- ¼ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 2 Tbsp pickled red onion
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- 1 Tbsp pumpkin seeds (pepitas)
- **Creamy Lemon Tahini Dressing:**
- 1 Tbsp tahini, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp EVOO, 1–2 Tbsp water (to thin)
- ½ tsp maple syrup or honey (optional)
- ½ tsp garlic powder, Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Protein Flex:** 3 oz grilled lemon herb chicken, 4 oz grilled shrimp, ½ cup cooked lentils, or ½ cup shelled edamame
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup blueberries, 1 small orange, or 1 small apple

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F. Toss the sweet potato with olive oil, smoked paprika, cumin, pepper, and a pinch of sea salt. Spread onto a parchment-lined baking sheet.
2. Roast for 25–30 minutes, turning halfway through, until tender and lightly caramelized.
3. During the last 5 minutes of roasting, add the chickpeas to the baking sheet to warm and lightly crisp.
4. Meanwhile, whisk together the tahini, lemon juice, olive oil, water, maple syrup, garlic powder, and pepper until smooth.
5. Arrange the spinach in a bowl.
6. Top with the roasted sweet potatoes, warm chickpeas, cucumber, tomatoes, pickled onions, parsley, and pumpkin seeds.
7. Drizzle generously with the lemon tahini dressing and serve warm.

## Arc Tip

*Roast an extra tray of sweet potatoes at the beginning of the week. They reheat beautifully and can be added to salads, grain bowls, soups, or breakfast hashes for a quick boost of flavor and nutrition.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~485 kcal | Calcium | ~220 mg |
| Protein | ~15 g | Iron | ~5 mg |
| Fat | ~24 g | Potassium | ~1,250 mg |
| Carbs | ~51 g | Vit A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~13 g | Vit K | Excellent |

### With 3 oz Grilled Chicken

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~625 kcal | Protein | ~41 g |
| Carbs | ~51 g | Fiber | ~13 g |

> **Arc Nutrition Score:**
> Gut Health (Excellent) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Plant Diversity (Excellent)

# Southwest Chicken & Black Bean Bowl

## Ingredients

- **For the Chicken:**
- 5 oz boneless, skinless chicken breast
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp chili powder, ½ tsp smoked paprika, ½ tsp ground cumin, ½ tsp garlic powder, ¼ tsp onion powder
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- **For the Bowl:**
- 2 cups chopped romaine lettuce
- ½ cup black beans, rinsed and drained
- ½ cup roasted sweet potato cubes
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup corn (fresh or frozen, thawed)
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- 2 Tbsp diced red onion
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh cilantro
- 1 Tbsp pumpkin seeds (pepitas)
- **Creamy Lime Yogurt Dressing:**
- 2 Tbsp plain Greek yogurt, 1 Tbsp fresh lime juice, 1 tsp EVOO, ½ tsp ground cumin, ½ tsp garlic powder, Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** ½ cup cooked brown rice, ½ cup cooked quinoa, 1 small whole-grain tortilla, or ½ cup cooked farro
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup pineapple, 1 small orange, or ½ cup berries

## Directions

1. Whisk together the olive oil, chili powder, smoked paprika, cumin, garlic powder, onion powder, pepper, and salt. Coat the chicken evenly.
2. Grill or pan-sear over medium-high heat for 5–6 minutes per side, or until internal temp is 165°F. Let rest before slicing.
3. Whisk together the Greek yogurt, lime juice, olive oil, cumin, garlic powder, and pepper until smooth.
4. Arrange the romaine in a large bowl.
5. Top with the black beans, roasted sweet potatoes, tomatoes, corn, avocado, red onion, pepitas, and sliced chicken.
6. Drizzle with the creamy lime yogurt dressing and garnish with fresh cilantro.

## Arc Tip

*Roast a large batch of sweet potatoes and grill extra chicken during your weekly meal prep. Combined with canned black beans and fresh vegetables, you'll have the foundation for several nourishing lunches in just a few minutes.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~560 kcal | Calcium | ~180 mg |
| Protein | ~43 g | Iron | ~4 mg |
| Fat | ~24 g | Potassium | ~1,350 mg |
| Carbs | ~35 g | Vit A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~11 g | Vit C | ~40 mg |

### With Smart Carb Flex

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~650-680 kcal | Protein | ~46 g |
| Carbs | ~55-58 g | Fiber | ~14 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
≥25 g Protein (Yes 43 g) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Muscle Support (Excellent)

# Chicken & Vegetable Orzo Soup

## Ingredients

- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 medium yellow onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 celery stalks, diced
- 1 zucchini, diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tsp dried oregano, 1 tsp dried thyme
- ¼ tsp crushed red pepper flakes (optional)
- 6 cups low-sodium chicken broth
- 2 cups cooked shredded chicken breast
- ½ cup dry whole wheat orzo
- 2 cups baby spinach
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley, 2 Tbsp chopped fresh dill
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough, ½ cup cooked farro, or ½ cup white beans stirred into the soup
- **Fruit Flex:** 1 small apple, ½ cup grapes, or ½ cup berries

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a large Dutch oven or soup pot over medium heat.
2. Add the onion, carrots, celery, and zucchini. Cook for 8–10 minutes, stirring occasionally.
3. Stir in the garlic, oregano, thyme, and crushed red pepper flakes. Cook for 30 seconds until fragrant.
4. Pour in the chicken broth and bring to a gentle boil.
5. Add the whole wheat orzo and cook according to package directions, about 8–10 minutes.
6. Reduce the heat to low and stir in the shredded chicken and spinach. Simmer for 2–3 minutes until the spinach wilts and the chicken is heated through.
7. Remove from the heat and stir in the lemon juice, parsley, and dill. Season with salt and pepper.

## Arc Tip

*If you're meal prepping, cook the orzo separately and stir it into each serving just before eating. This keeps the pasta from absorbing too much broth and becoming overly soft after a day or two in the refrigerator.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~420 kcal | Calcium | ~140 mg |
| Protein | ~34 g | Iron | ~3 mg |
| Fat | ~14 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbs | ~28 g | Vit A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~5 g | Selenium | Excellent |

### With ½ Cup White Beans

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~530 kcal | Protein | ~41 g |
| Carbs | ~48 g | Fiber | ~11 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
Heart Health (Excellent) | Immune Support (Excellent)

# Mediterranean Bean Salad

## Ingredients

- **For the Salad:**
- ½ cup cannellini beans, rinsed and drained
- ½ cup chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- ½ cup lentils, cooked and cooled
- 1 cup cucumber, diced
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup diced red onion
- ¼ cup roasted red peppers, chopped
- ¼ cup Kalamata olives, halved
- ¼ cup chopped fresh parsley
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh mint (optional)
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- **Lemon Herb Vinaigrette:**
- 2 Tbsp EVOO, 2 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 1 small garlic clove (minced), 1 tsp dried oregano, Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt

## Serve With

- **Protein Flex:** 3 oz grilled lemon herb chicken, 4 oz grilled salmon, 4 oz grilled shrimp, 1 can sardines, or 2 hard-boiled eggs
- **Smart Carb Flex:** Not needed! The beans and lentils provide a complete, fiber-rich carbohydrate source.
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup berries, 1 small peach, or 1 small apple

## Directions

1. In a small bowl, whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, garlic, oregano, pepper, and a pinch of sea salt.
2. In a large bowl, combine the cannellini beans, chickpeas, lentils, cucumber, tomatoes, red onion, roasted red peppers, olives, parsley, mint, and feta.
3. Pour the vinaigrette over the salad and gently toss until everything is evenly coated.
4. Cover and refrigerate for at least 30 minutes before serving to allow the flavors to develop.
5. Serve chilled with your favorite Protein Flex option.

## Arc Tip

*This salad tastes even better after a night in the refrigerator. Make a double batch and enjoy it throughout the week as a quick lunch, a side dish with grilled fish or chicken, or a topping for leafy greens.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~420 kcal | Calcium | ~220 mg |
| Protein | ~18 g | Iron | ~5 mg |
| Fat | ~21 g | Potassium | ~1,100 mg |
| Carbs | ~39 g | Vit K | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~13 g | Copper | Excellent |

### With 3 oz Grilled Chicken

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~560 kcal | Protein | ~44 g |
| Carbs | ~39 g | Fiber | ~13 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
Gut Health (Excellent) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Plant Diversity (Excellent)

# Mediterranean Turkey Meatball Bowls

## Ingredients

- **For the Meatballs:**
- 1 lb lean ground turkey (93% lean)
- 1 small zucchini, grated and squeezed dry
- ¼ cup whole wheat breadcrumbs
- 1 large egg
- ¼ cup grated Parmesan cheese
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tsp dried oregano, ½ tsp onion powder, ½ tsp smoked paprika
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil (for baking sheet)
- **For the Bowl:**
- 2 cups baby spinach or mixed greens
- ½ cup cooked farro
- ¼ cup cucumber, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup roasted red peppers
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp tzatziki, Fresh parsley for garnish

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** ½ cup cooked quinoa, ½ cup roasted sweet potatoes, or 1 slice whole-grain sourdough
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup grapes, 1 small peach, or ½ cup berries

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F. Line a baking sheet with parchment paper and lightly brush with olive oil.
2. In a large bowl, combine the turkey, grated zucchini, breadcrumbs, egg, Parmesan, garlic, parsley, oregano, onion powder, smoked paprika, pepper, and a pinch of sea salt. Mix gently.
3. Form into 16 meatballs (about 1½ inches each) and place on the prepared baking sheet.
4. Bake for 18–20 minutes, or until the internal temperature reaches 165°F.
5. To assemble the bowls, divide the greens among serving bowls.
6. Top each bowl with 4 meatballs, farro, cucumber, tomatoes, roasted red peppers, feta, and tzatziki. Garnish with fresh parsley.

## Arc Tip

*Double the meatball recipe and freeze the extras after baking. They reheat beautifully in the microwave, oven, or air fryer and can be added to salads, grain bowls, soups, or tucked into a whole-grain pita for an easy meal.*

## Estimated Nutrition

**Per Bowl (4 Meatballs)**

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~545 kcal | Calcium | ~260 mg |
| Protein | ~40 g | Iron | ~3.8 mg |
| Fat | ~28 g | Potassium | ~1,000 mg |
| Carbs | ~30 g | Vit A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~7 g | Selenium | Excellent |

> **Arc Nutrition Score:**
> ≥25 g Protein (Yes 40 g) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Muscle Support (Excellent)

# Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Bowl

## Ingredients

- **For the Roasted Vegetables:**
- 1 cup sweet potato, diced
- 1 cup Brussels sprouts, halved
- 1 zucchini, sliced into half-moons
- 1 red bell pepper, chopped
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp smoked paprika, ½ tsp garlic powder, ½ tsp dried thyme
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- **For the Bowl:**
- ¾ cup cooked green or French lentils
- 2 cups baby spinach
- ¼ cup roasted red onion
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp toasted pumpkin seeds (pepitas)
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- **Lemon Tahini Dressing:**
- 1 Tbsp tahini, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp EVOO, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 1–2 Tbsp water (to thin), Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Protein Flex:** 3 oz grilled lemon herb chicken, 4 oz grilled salmon, 4 oz grilled shrimp, or ½ cup shelled edamame
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup blueberries, 1 small apple, or 1 small pear

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F. Toss the sweet potatoes and Brussels sprouts with half of the olive oil and seasonings. Spread onto one side of a parchment-lined baking sheet.
2. Toss the zucchini, bell pepper, and red onion with the remaining olive oil and seasonings. Spread onto the other side of the baking sheet.
3. Roast for 25–30 minutes, stirring halfway through.
4. While the vegetables roast, whisk together the tahini, lemon juice, olive oil, Dijon mustard, water, and pepper until smooth and creamy.
5. Arrange the spinach in a large bowl. Top with the warm lentils, roasted vegetables, feta, pumpkin seeds, and parsley.
6. Drizzle with the lemon tahini dressing and serve immediately.

## Arc Tip

*Roast two sheet pans of vegetables while the oven is on. Use the extras throughout the week in omelets, wraps, soups, salads, or grain bowls. One hour of meal prep can provide the foundation for several days of nourishing meals.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~510 kcal | Calcium | ~240 mg |
| Protein | ~21 g | Iron | ~6 mg |
| Fat | ~25 g | Potassium | ~1,500 mg |
| Carbs | ~53 g | Vit A & C | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~17 g | Manganese | Excellent |

### With 3 oz Grilled Chicken

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~650 kcal | Protein | ~47 g |
| Carbs | ~53 g | Fiber | ~17 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
Gut Health (Excellent) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Plant Diversity (Excellent)

# Roasted Tomato & White Bean Soup

## Ingredients

- **For the Roasted Vegetables:**
- 2 lbs Roma tomatoes, halved
- 1 medium yellow onion, cut into wedges
- 1 whole head garlic, top trimmed
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp dried oregano, ½ tsp dried thyme
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- **For the Soup:**
- 1 (15 oz) can cannellini beans, rinsed and drained
- 2 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- ¼ cup fresh basil leaves, plus more for garnish
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp balsamic vinegar (optional)
- **Garnish:** Fresh basil, Fresh grated Parmesan (optional), EVOO drizzle, Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Protein Flex:** 3 oz grilled lemon herb chicken, 1 can sardines, ½ cup cooked lentils stirred into the soup, or ½ cup shelled edamame on the side
- **Smart Carb Flex:** 1 slice toasted whole-grain sourdough, ½ cup cooked farro stirred into the soup, or ½ cup cooked quinoa

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F. Arrange the tomatoes, onion, and garlic on a parchment-lined baking sheet.
2. Drizzle with olive oil and season with oregano, thyme, pepper, and a small pinch of sea salt.
3. Roast for 35–40 minutes, until the tomatoes are deeply caramelized and beginning to collapse.
4. Allow the garlic to cool slightly, then squeeze the roasted cloves from their skins.
5. Transfer the roasted tomatoes, onion, garlic, cannellini beans, vegetable broth, basil, lemon juice, and balsamic vinegar (if using) to a blender.
6. Blend until smooth and creamy.
7. Pour into a soup pot and warm gently over medium-low heat for 5–10 minutes.
8. Taste and adjust seasoning. Garnish with fresh basil, Parmesan if desired, a drizzle of olive oil, and freshly cracked pepper.

## Arc Tip

*Roasting tomatoes dramatically enhances their natural sweetness and concentrates lycopene, a powerful antioxidant associated with heart health and healthy aging. Pairing the tomatoes with olive oil also helps your body absorb more of their beneficial compounds.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~315 kcal | Calcium | ~180 mg |
| Protein | ~11 g | Iron | ~3 mg |
| Fat | ~14 g | Potassium | ~1,300 mg |
| Carbs | ~36 g | Vit A & C | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~10 g | Lycopene | Excellent |

### With 3 oz Grilled Chicken

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~455 kcal | Protein | ~37 g |
| Carbs | ~36 g | Fiber | ~10 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
Gut Health (Excellent) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Antioxidant Power (Excellent)

# Falafel Bowl with Lemon Herb Tahini

## Ingredients

- **For the Falafel:**
- 1 cup dried chickpeas, soaked overnight and drained (do not use canned chickpeas)
- ½ small yellow onion, roughly chopped
- 3 cloves garlic
- 1 cup fresh parsley, ½ cup fresh cilantro
- 1 tsp ground cumin, 1 tsp ground coriander, ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ½ tsp baking powder, 2 Tbsp oat flour or chickpea flour
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- Fresh cracked black pepper, ½ tsp sea salt
- **For the Bowl:**
- 2 cups chopped romaine lettuce
- ½ cup cucumber, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup roasted red peppers
- ¼ cup pickled red onions
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- **Lemon Herb Tahini Sauce:**
- 2 Tbsp tahini, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp EVOO, 1 tsp chopped fresh parsley, ½ tsp garlic powder, 1–2 Tbsp water (to thin), Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** ½ cup cooked quinoa, ½ cup cooked farro, 1 small whole wheat pita, or ½ cup tabbouleh
- **Protein Flex:** 3 oz grilled chicken, 4 oz grilled shrimp, ½ cup shelled edamame, or ½ cup plain Greek yogurt on the side

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F or preheat an air fryer to 375°F.
2. Add the soaked chickpeas, onion, garlic, parsley, cilantro, cumin, coriander, paprika, baking powder, oat flour, olive oil, salt, and pepper to a food processor.
3. Pulse until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs. Refrigerate for 20–30 minutes to help the mixture firm up.
4. Form into 12 falafel balls or patties.
5. Bake for 22–25 minutes, flipping halfway through, or air fry for 12–15 minutes, until golden brown and crisp.
6. Whisk together the tahini, lemon juice, olive oil, parsley, garlic powder, water, and pepper until smooth.
7. Arrange the romaine in a bowl. Top with the cucumber, tomatoes, roasted peppers, pickled onions, avocado, feta, and 3 falafel.
8. Drizzle generously with the lemon herb tahini sauce and serve with your Smart Carb Flex choice.

## Arc Tip

*Traditional falafel is made with soaked dried chickpeas, not canned chickpeas. Soaking allows the chickpeas to soften while keeping enough structure to create a light, fluffy interior and a crisp exterior. For best results, soak them for 12–24 hours, drain well, and pat dry before processing.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe (3 Falafel)

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~510 kcal | Calcium | ~230 mg |
| Protein | ~18 g | Iron | ~5 mg |
| Fat | ~28 g | Potassium | ~1,150 mg |
| Carbs | ~42 g | Vit K | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~13 g | Manganese | Excellent |

### With ½ Cup Quinoa

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~620 kcal | Protein | ~22 g |
| Carbs | ~62 g | Fiber | ~16 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
Gut Health (Excellent) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Plant Diversity (Excellent)

# Mediterranean Lentil Soup

## Ingredients

- **For the Soup:**
- 2 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 medium yellow onion, diced
- 2 carrots, chopped
- 1 medium Yukon Gold potato, peeled and diced (traditional for creaminess)
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1½ cups dried red lentils, rinsed
- 1 Tbsp tomato paste
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp Aleppo pepper (or ½ tsp paprika + pinch of cayenne)
- ½ tsp ground turmeric, ¼ tsp black pepper
- 6 cups low-sodium vegetable broth
- 1 tsp sea salt (or to taste)
- **Lemon-Olive Oil Finish:**
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp Aleppo pepper, 1 tsp dried mint
- 2 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- Fresh parsley, chopped, Lemon wedges

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** 1 slice whole-grain sourdough, 1 small whole wheat pita, or Whole-grain lavash
- **Protein Flex:** 3 oz grilled chicken, 2 hard-boiled eggs, ½ cup plain Greek yogurt, or 4 oz grilled shrimp

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a Dutch oven over medium heat.
2. Add the onion and carrots and cook for 6–8 minutes until softened.
3. Add the garlic and tomato paste. Cook for 1 minute, stirring constantly.
4. Stir in the cumin, Aleppo pepper, turmeric, and black pepper until fragrant.
5. Add the potato, red lentils, and vegetable broth. Bring to a boil.
6. Reduce to a gentle simmer and cook 25–30 minutes, until the vegetables and lentils are completely tender.
7. Using an immersion blender (or carefully transferring to a blender), puree until completely smooth and velvety.
8. In a small skillet, gently warm the olive oil with the Aleppo pepper and dried mint for about 30 seconds.
9. Stir the lemon juice into the soup just before serving.
10. Ladle into bowls and drizzle with the warm mint-Aleppo oil. Finish with fresh parsley and an extra lemon wedge.

## Arc Tip

*For the silkiest texture, blend the soup while it's still hot, then pass it through a fine-mesh sieve if you want a truly restaurant-quality finish. Just before serving, drizzle the warm mint and Aleppo pepper olive oil over each bowl. This traditional finishing touch adds incredible aroma, gentle warmth, and a beautiful pop of color.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~340 kcal | Calcium | ~90 mg |
| Protein | ~17 g | Iron | ~6 mg |
| Fat | ~9 g | Potassium | ~950 mg |
| Carbs | ~49 g | Vit A | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~15 g | Manganese | Excellent |

### With Whole Wheat Pita

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~500 kcal | Protein | ~23 g |
| Carbs | ~76 g | Fiber | ~20 g |

**Arc Nutrition Score:**
Gut Health (Excellent) | Heart Health (Excellent) | Heritage Recipe (Excellent)

# Grilled Mediterranean Shrimp Bowl

## Ingredients

- **For the Shrimp:**
- 5 oz large shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp lemon zest
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tsp dried oregano, ½ tsp smoked paprika
- Fresh cracked black pepper, Pinch of sea salt
- **For the Bowl:**
- 2 cups baby spinach or mixed greens
- ½ cup cooked farro
- ¼ cup cucumber, diced
- ½ cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup roasted red peppers, sliced
- ¼ cup chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- ¼ avocado, sliced
- 2 Tbsp crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- **Lemon Herb Vinaigrette:**
- 1 Tbsp EVOO, 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 1 tsp honey (optional), 1 tsp chopped fresh dill, Fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

- **Smart Carb Flex:** ½ cup cooked quinoa, ½ cup roasted baby potatoes, or 1 slice whole-grain sourdough
- **Fruit Flex:** ½ cup blueberries, 1 small peach, or 1 small orange

## Directions

1. In a medium bowl, whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, lemon zest, garlic, oregano, smoked paprika, pepper, and a pinch of sea salt.
2. Add the shrimp and toss to coat. Marinate for 15–20 minutes.
3. Preheat a grill or grill pan over medium-high heat.
4. Grill the shrimp for 2–3 minutes per side, or until they turn pink and opaque. Avoid overcooking.
5. While the shrimp cooks, whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, Dijon mustard, honey (if using), dill, and pepper for the vinaigrette.
6. Arrange the spinach in a large serving bowl.
7. Top with the farro, cucumber, tomatoes, roasted red peppers, chickpeas, avocado, and feta.
8. Add the warm grilled shrimp.
9. Drizzle with the lemon herb vinaigrette and garnish with fresh parsley. Serve immediately.

## Arc Tip

*Shrimp cooks incredibly quickly. Remove it from the heat as soon as it turns pink and opaque—usually just 2–3 minutes per side. Perfectly cooked shrimp stays tender and sweet, while overcooked shrimp can become rubbery.*

## Estimated Nutrition

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~525 kcal | Calcium | ~220 mg |
| Protein | ~38 g | Iron | ~3.5 mg |
| Fat | ~26 g | Potassium | ~1,150 mg |
| Carbs | ~30 g | Vit B12 | Excellent |
| Fiber | ~9 g | Iodine | Excellent |

### With Smart Carb Flex

| Nutrient | Amount | Micronutrients/Score | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | ~620-640 kcal | Protein | ~41 g |
| Carbs | ~48-50 g | Fiber | ~12 g |

> **Arc Nutrition Score:**
> Heart Health (Excellent) | Brain Health (Excellent)

# SECTION 4: DINNER

*End Your Day with Purpose*

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Herbed Roast Chicken & Vegetables

Italian Pot Roast

Rustic Beef & Vegetable Stew

Salisbury Steak with Mushroom Onion Gravy

Shepherd's Pie

Stuffed Cabbage Rolls

Creamy Tuscan Chicken

Rustic Chicken & Mushroom Bake

Chicken Parmesan (Arc Style)

Chicken Pesto Pasta

Lemon Chicken Orzo Skillet

Harissa Chicken & Cauliflower

Sausage, Peppers & Potatoes

Garlic Shrimp & Asparagus

Lemon & Dill Salmon

Persian Herb Chicken

Moroccan Chickpea Tagine

Stuffed Eggplant

Mediterranean Vegetable Gratin

Beef Stroganoff

# Salisbury Steak with Mushroom Onion Gravy

*Juicy and comforting beef patties in a rich mushroom and onion gravy—served over creamy mashed potatoes for the ultimate*

# Shepherd's Pie

*A hearty, savory filling of seasoned beef and vegetables topped with a creamy blend of mashed potatoes and cauliflower—baked*

# Stuffed Cabbage Rolls

*Tender cabbage leaves wrapped around a savory rice and meat filling, simmered in a fragrant paprika and onion gravy*

## Creamy Tuscan Chicken

*Tender chicken simmered in a creamy garlic sauce with sun-dried tomatoes and spinach—rich, comforting and full of Tuscan flavor.*

## Harissa Chicken & Cauliflower

*Bold and spicy harissa chicken with roasted cauliflower and peppers—packed with warmth, flavor and a touch of heat.*

## Sausage, Peppers & Potatoes

*Savory sausage with roasted potatoes and bell peppers—hearty, satisfying and perfect for any night of the week.*

## Garlic Shrimp & Asparagus

*Juicy shrimp sautéed with garlic and olive oil, paired with tender asparagus and a squeeze of lemon for a light and flavorful Mediterranean classic.*

## Moroccan Chickpea Tagine

*Aromatic chickpeas simmered with warm spices, tomatoes, and vegetables with hints of apricot and lemon—hearty, nourishing, and full*

## Mediterranean Vegetable Gratin

*Layers of roasted vegetables baked in a creamy, herbed sauce and finished with a golden, cheesy top—a comforting and elegant Mediterranean side*

# Herbed Roast Chicken & Vegetables

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 20 minutesCook Time: 55–60 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken thighs (or breasts if preferred)
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard

**Juice of ½ lemon**

- 1 tsp lemon zest
- 1 Tbsp fresh rosemary, chopped
- 1 Tbsp fresh thyme leaves
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp fresh cracked black pepper

**Vegetables**

- 1 lb baby Yukon Gold potatoes, halved
- 3 carrots, peeled and cut into 2-inch pieces
- 1 red onion, cut into wedges
- 2 cups Brussels sprouts, halved
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- ½ tsp sea salt
- ¼ tsp fresh cracked black pepper

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Need a little more energy? Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Want even more color, fiber, and variety? Add one or two vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together the olive oil, garlic, Dijon mustard, lemon juice, lemon zest, rosemary, thyme, parsley, smoked paprika, salt, and pepper.
3. Add the chicken and toss until evenly coated. If time allows, marinate for 15–30 minutes.
4. In a separate bowl, toss the potatoes, carrots, onion, and Brussels sprouts with olive oil, salt, and pepper.
5. Spread the vegetables evenly onto a large sheet pan and nestle the chicken between the vegetables.
6. Roast for 55–60 minutes, stirring the vegetables halfway through cooking, until the chicken reaches an internal temperature of 165°F and the vegetables are tender and caramelized.
7. If desired, broil for the final 2–3 minutes for additional color.
8. Garnish with fresh parsley and serve with lemon wedges.

### Arc Tip

*For the best flavor, don't overcrowd the pan. Giving the vegetables a little space allows them to caramelize instead of steam, creating those delicious golden edges that make roasted vegetables irresistible.*

# Nutrition & Score: Herbed Roast Chicken & Vegetables

### Base Recipe (Per Serving)

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~520 kcal |
| Protein | ~40 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~25 g |
| Fiber | ~5 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~20 g |
| Fat | ~28 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~6 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~15 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~250 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~120 mg |
| Iron | ~3 mg |
| Magnesium | ~90 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,100 mg |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B6 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 40 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Achieved with Smart Carb Flex or additional vegetables

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Extra virgin olive oil

**Produce**: Yes Carrots, Brussels sprouts, onion, lemon, herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Garlic, rosemary, thyme, parsley, olive oil

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein + fiber + healthy fats

**Gut Health**: Yes Vegetables + optional whole grains

**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean protein, olive oil, vegetables

**Brain Health**: Excellent Healthy fats, herbs, colorful vegetables

# Italian Pot Roast

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 25 minutesCook Time: 3½–4 hours*

## Ingredients

**Roast**

- 3 lb beef chuck roast, trimmed of excess fat
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Vegetables**

- 1 large yellow onion, cut into wedges
- 1 medium fennel bulb, cored and cut into wedges
- 4 carrots, peeled and cut into large pieces
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, halved
- 6 cloves fresh garlic, smashed

**Fresh Tomato Braising Sauce**

- 2 lbs Roma tomatoes, roughly chopped
- 2 Tbsp tomato paste
- 1 cup unsweetened pomegranate juice
- 1 cup homemade beef stock (or low-sodium beef broth)
- 1 Tbsp balsamic vinegar
- 1 Parmesan rind
- 2 sprigs fresh rosemary
- 4 sprigs fresh oregano
- 2 bay leaves

**Finish**

- ¼ cup fresh basil leaves, torn
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

**Freshly grated Parmesan (optional)**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide for additional energy and staying power.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Round out the meal with one or two vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide for even more color, fiber, and phytonutrients.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 325°F.
2. Pat the chuck roast dry with paper towels and season all sides generously with the sea salt and black pepper.
3. Heat the olive oil in a large Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Sear the roast for 4–5 minutes per side until a deep golden-brown crust develops. This step is worth the time—it creates rich, caramelized flavors that become the foundation of the braising sauce.
4. Transfer the roast to a plate.
5. Reduce the heat to medium. Add the onion, fennel, carrots, mushrooms, and garlic to the Dutch oven. Cook for 6–8 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables begin to soften and lightly caramelize.
6. Stir in the tomato paste and cook for 1 minute to deepen its flavor.
7. Add the chopped Roma tomatoes, pomegranate juice, beef stock, balsamic vinegar, Parmesan rind, rosemary, oregano, and bay leaves. Stir to combine.
8. Return the roast to the Dutch oven, nestling it into the vegetables and sauce.
9. Cover with the lid and transfer to the oven. Braise for 3½–4 hours, or until the beef is fork-tender and easily pulls apart.
10. Remove the Parmesan rind, rosemary stems, oregano stems, and bay leaves.
11. Gently shred or slice the roast and spoon the vegetables and rich tomato sauce over the top.
12. Finish with fresh basil, parsley, and a light sprinkle of freshly grated Parmesan, if desired.

### Arc Tip

*Don't skip the sear. Developing a rich, golden-brown crust before braising isn't just about color—it's where deep, savory flavor begins. Those caramelized bits left in the Dutch oven dissolve into the sauce as the roast slowly cooks, creating a rich, restaurant-quality braising liquid that's worth every extra minute.*

# Nutrition & Score: Italian Pot Roast

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~475 kcal |
| Protein | ~41 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~17 g |
| Fiber | ~4 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~13 g |
| Fat | ~26 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~8 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~12 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~180 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~95 mg |
| Iron | ~5.1 mg |
| Magnesium | ~72 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,050 mg |
| Zinc | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Lycopene | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 41 g
**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex
**Healthy Fats**: Yes Extra virgin olive oil
**Produce**: Yes Tomatoes, onion, fennel, carrots, mushrooms, garlic, fresh herbs
**Polyphenols**: Yes Tomatoes, pomegranate, herbs, garlic, olive oil
**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein paired with fiber-rich vegetables
**Gut Health**: Yes Colorful vegetables, garlic, fresh herbs
**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean beef, olive oil, antioxidant-rich vegetables
**Brain Health**: Excellent Iron, B12, zinc, lycopene, fresh herbs

# Rustic Beef & Vegetable Stew

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 30 minutesCook Time: 2½–3 hours*

## Ingredients

**Beef**

- 2½ lbs beef chuck roast, cut into 1½-inch cubes
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Vegetables**

- 1 large yellow onion, diced
- 4 carrots, peeled and sliced into thick rounds
- 2 parsnips, peeled and sliced
- 1 large turnip, peeled and cubed
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, halved
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced

**Broth**

- 2 lbs Roma tomatoes, roughly chopped
- 4 cups homemade beef stock (or low-sodium beef broth)
- 2 Tbsp tomato paste
- 2 tsp balsamic vinegar
- 2 sprigs fresh rosemary
- 4 sprigs fresh thyme
- 2 bay leaves

**Finish**

- 1 cup fresh peas
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this stew with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide for additional energy and staying power.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add another seasonal vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide to make this hearty stew even more nourishing.**

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a large Dutch oven over medium-high heat.
2. Pat the beef dry and season with the sea salt and black pepper.
3. Working in batches, sear the beef until deeply browned on all sides. Avoid overcrowding the pot so the meat develops a rich crust instead of steaming. Transfer the browned beef to a plate.
4. Reduce the heat to medium. Add the onion, carrots, parsnips, turnip, mushrooms, and garlic. Cook for 8–10 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables begin to soften.
5. Stir in the tomato paste and cook for 1 minute.
6. Add the chopped Roma tomatoes, beef stock, balsamic vinegar, rosemary, thyme, and bay leaves. Stir well, scraping up any browned bits from the bottom of the pot.
7. Return the beef and any accumulated juices to the Dutch oven.
8. Bring to a gentle simmer, cover, and transfer to a 325°F oven.
9. Cook for 2½–3 hours, or until the beef is fork tender.
10. During the final 10 minutes of cooking, stir in the peas.
11. Remove the rosemary stems and bay leaves. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed.
12. Garnish generously with fresh parsley before serving.

### Arc Tip

*Traditional beef stew is often built around potatoes, but this version features parsnips and turnips instead. These hearty root vegetables add natural sweetness, earthy flavor, and a wider variety of nutrients while keeping the stew just as comforting and satisfying. Small ingredient swaps like this are part of the Arc philosophy—expanding the variety of plants you eat is one simple way to support long-term health without sacrificing the meals you love.*

# Nutrition & Score: Rustic Beef & Vegetable Stew

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~445 kcal |
| Protein | ~38 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~19 g |
| Fiber | ~5 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~14 g |
| Fat | ~23 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~7 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~10 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~170 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~85 mg |
| Iron | ~5.3 mg |
| Magnesium | ~78 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,200 mg |
| Zinc | Excellent source |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Good source |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 38 g
**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex
**Healthy Fats**: Yes Extra virgin olive oil
**Produce**: Yes Tomatoes, onion, carrots, parsnips, turnip, mushrooms, peas, garlic, herbs
**Polyphenols**: Yes Tomatoes, garlic, herbs, olive oil
**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with fiber-rich vegetables
**Gut Health**: Yes Diverse root vegetables, garlic, herbs
**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean beef, olive oil, colorful vegetables
**Brain Health**: Excellent Iron, B12, zinc, antioxidant-rich vegetables

# Salisbury Steak with Mushroom Onion Gravy

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 25 minutesCook Time: 35 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Salisbury Steaks**

- 1½ lbs lean ground beef (90/10)
- ½ cup finely grated yellow onion, liquid drained
- 2 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- ½ cup fresh whole wheat breadcrumbs
- 1 large egg
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley
- 1 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- 1 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil

**Mushroom Onion Gravy**

- 1 medium yellow onion, thinly sliced
- 12 oz cremini mushrooms, sliced
- 3 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 2 Tbsp whole wheat flour
- 2 cups homemade beef stock (or low-sodium beef broth)
- 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- 1 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add one or two vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide for even more color, fiber, and variety.**

## Directions

1. In a large bowl, combine the ground beef, grated onion, garlic, breadcrumbs, egg, parsley, Worcestershire sauce, Dijon mustard, thyme, salt, and pepper. Mix gently until just combined.
2. Form into four equal oval patties, about ¾-inch thick.
3. Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Sear the patties for 3–4 minutes per side until nicely browned. Transfer to a plate. (They will finish cooking in the gravy.)
4. Reduce the heat to medium. Add the olive oil and butter for the gravy.
5. Add the sliced onion and cook for about 8 minutes until soft and lightly caramelized.
6. Stir in the mushrooms and cook another 6–8 minutes until they release their moisture and become deeply browned.
7. Add the garlic and thyme and cook for 30 seconds.
8. Sprinkle the flour over the vegetables and stir continuously for 1 minute.
9. Slowly whisk in the beef stock, followed by the Worcestershire sauce. Simmer until the gravy thickens.
10. Return the Salisbury steaks to the skillet. Cover and simmer for 10–12 minutes, or until cooked through and the gravy has thickened.
11. Garnish with fresh parsley and serve immediately.

### Arc Tip

*Take your time browning the mushrooms. They may seem crowded at first, but resist the urge to stir constantly. Allowing them to sit against the hot pan helps them caramelize instead of steam, creating a rich, savory flavor that gives this homemade gravy incredible depth.*

# Nutrition & Score: Salisbury Steak with Mushroom Onion Gravy

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~430 kcal |
| Protein | ~35 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~14 g |
| Fiber | ~3 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~11 g |
| Fat | ~25 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~8 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~11 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~160 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~85 mg |
| Iron | ~4.6 mg |
| Magnesium | ~60 mg |
| Potassium | ~920 mg |
| Zinc | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |
| Vitamin D | Good source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 35 g
**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex
**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil
**Produce**: Yes Onion, mushrooms, garlic, parsley, thyme
**Polyphenols**: Yes Mushrooms, onions, garlic, herbs
**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with moderate carbohydrates
**Gut Health**: Yes Fresh vegetables and herbs
**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean beef and scratch-made gravy
**Brain Health**: Excellent Iron, B12, zinc, mushrooms

# Shepherd's Pie

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 30 minutesCook Time: 40 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Potato Topping**

- 1½ lbs Yukon Gold potatoes, peeled and cubed
- 1 medium head cauliflower, cut into florets
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup whole milk
- ¼ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh chives
- 1 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Filling**

- 1½ lbs lean ground beef (or ground lamb for a more traditional Shepherd's Pie)
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 large yellow onion, diced
- 3 carrots, diced
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, finely chopped
- 1 cup fresh peas
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 2 Tbsp tomato paste
- 2 Tbsp whole wheat flour
- 2 cups homemade beef stock (or low-sodium beef broth)
- 1 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 2 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- 1 Tbsp chopped fresh rosemary
- 2 bay leaves
- 2 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide if you'd like additional energy.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**A crisp salad or roasted seasonal vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide make an excellent addition.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F.
2. Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil. Add the potatoes and cauliflower and cook for 15–18 minutes, or until fork tender.
3. Drain well and return them to the warm pot. Add the butter, milk, Parmesan, chives, salt, and pepper. Mash until smooth and set aside.
4. While the potatoes cook, heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
5. Add the onion, carrots, and mushrooms. Cook for 8–10 minutes until softened and lightly browned.
6. Add the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
7. Add the ground beef and cook until browned, breaking it into small pieces as it cooks. Drain excess fat if necessary.
8. Stir in the tomato paste and cook for 1 minute.
9. Sprinkle the flour over the mixture and stir well.
10. Gradually pour in the beef stock while stirring. Add the Worcestershire sauce, thyme, rosemary, bay leaves, salt, and pepper.
11. Simmer for 8–10 minutes until the filling thickens.
12. Stir in the fresh peas and remove the bay leaves.
13. Transfer the filling to a 9 x 13-inch baking dish.
14. Spread the mashed potato-cauliflower mixture evenly over the top. Use the back of a spoon or a fork to create peaks that will brown beautifully in the oven.
15. Bake for 20–25 minutes, until bubbly around the edges and lightly golden on top.
16. Broil for 2–3 minutes, if desired, for extra color.
17. Allow the Shepherd's Pie to rest for 10 minutes before serving.

### Arc Tip

*Traditional Shepherd's Pie is often topped with all potatoes. Blending cauliflower into the mash creates a creamy, fluffy topping while adding another serving of vegetables. It's one of those simple upgrades that increases nutrition without changing the comforting flavor everyone expects.*

# Nutrition & Score: Shepherd's Pie

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~445 kcal |
| Protein | ~34 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~23 g |
| Fiber | ~5 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~18 g |
| Fat | ~24 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~8 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~10 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~170 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~165 mg |
| Iron | ~4.3 mg |
| Magnesium | ~70 mg |
| Potassium | ~980 mg |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Zinc | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 34 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil

**Produce**: Yes Onion, carrots, mushrooms, peas, cauliflower, potatoes, garlic, herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Garlic, herbs, mushrooms, olive oil

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes Balanced with protein, vegetables, and healthy fats

**Gut Health**: Yes Diverse vegetables and fresh herbs

**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean protein and plenty of vegetables

**Brain Health**: Excellent Iron, B12, choline, antioxidant-rich vegetables

# Hungarian Stuffed Cabbage Rolls with Paprika Rántás

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 35 minutesCook Time: 1 hour 30 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Cabbage**

- 1 large green cabbage

**Water for boiling**

**Filling**

- 1 lb lean ground beef (90/10)
- ½ lb lean ground turkey
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, finely minced
- 1 small yellow onion, finely diced
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- ½ cup cooked brown rice
- 1 large egg
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 Tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- 2 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Hungarian Paprika Rántás (Gravy)**

- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1 large sweet onion, thinly sliced
- 2 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 3 Tbsp white whole wheat flour
- 2 Tbsp authentic Hungarian sweet paprika
- ½ tsp smoked paprika (optional)
- 3 cups homemade beef stock (or low-sodium beef broth)
- 1 tsp apple cider vinegar
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- Sea salt and freshly cracked black pepper, to taste

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide if you'd like a heartier meal.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Round out the plate with one or two vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide for even more color, fiber, and variety.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F.
2. Bring a large pot of water to a gentle boil. Carefully remove the core from the cabbage and place the entire head into the boiling water. As the leaves soften, remove them one at a time until you have 12–14 large leaves. Set aside to cool.
3. In a large bowl, combine the ground beef, ground turkey, mushrooms, onion, garlic, cooked brown rice, egg, parsley, dill, thyme, salt, and pepper. Mix gently until just combined.
4. Place about ⅓ cup of filling near the stem end of each cabbage leaf. Fold in the sides and roll tightly.
5. Arrange the cabbage rolls seam-side down in a lightly greased Dutch oven or 9 × 13-inch baking dish.

**Prepare the Paprika Rántás**

1. Heat the olive oil and butter in a large skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the sliced onion and cook slowly for 12–15 minutes until soft, sweet, and lightly golden.
3. Stir in the garlic and cook for another 30 seconds.
4. Sprinkle the flour over the onions and stir constantly for about 1 minute to cook away the raw flour taste.
5. Remove the pan from the heat and stir in the Hungarian paprika (and smoked paprika if using). This prevents the paprika from scorching and becoming bitter.
6. Slowly whisk in the warm beef stock until smooth.
7. Return the pan to medium heat and simmer for 5–7 minutes until the gravy thickens.
8. Stir in the apple cider vinegar and fresh parsley. Season to taste with salt and pepper.
9. Pour the gravy evenly over the cabbage rolls.
10. Cover tightly and bake for 60–70 minutes, or until the cabbage is tender and the filling reaches an internal temperature of 160°F.
11. Let rest for 10 minutes before serving.

## Arc Tip

*This recipe is inspired by the Hungarian tradition of rántás, a simple roux made with flour, fat, and paprika that has been passed down through generations. Rather than replacing cherished family recipes, the Arc philosophy is to honor them—using fresh ingredients, quality fats, and thoughtful updates that support long-term health while preserving the flavors that bring us home.*

# Nutrition & Score: Hungarian Stuffed Cabbage Rolls with Paprika Rántás

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~395 kcal |
| Protein | ~34 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~17 g |
| Fiber | ~4 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~13 g |
| Fat | ~20 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~5 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~9 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~180 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~95 mg |
| Iron | ~4.8 mg |
| Magnesium | ~78 mg |
| Potassium | ~900 mg |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 34 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil and lean proteins

**Produce**: Yes Cabbage, mushrooms, onions, garlic, fresh herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Paprika, garlic, onions, herbs

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with moderate carbohydrates

**Gut Health**: Yes Cabbage, mushrooms, herbs, whole grain rice

**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean proteins and olive oil

**Brain Health**: Excellent B vitamins, iron, mushrooms, fresh herbs

# Creamy Tuscan Chicken

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 20 minutesCook Time: 30 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken breasts, halved horizontally into cutlets
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 2 Tbsp whole wheat flour (for lightly dusting)

**Tuscan Cream Sauce**

- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1 small yellow onion, finely diced
- 5 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 2 cups cherry tomatoes, halved
- ¼ cup chopped sun-dried tomatoes
- 1 1/c cups cooked cannellini beans
- ½ cup homemade chicken stock
- ½ cup half-and-half
- ½ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- 3 cups fresh baby spinach
- 2 Tbsp fresh basil, chopped
- 1 Tbsp fresh oregano, chopped
- 1 tsp fresh thyme leaves

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add another vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide for even more color, fiber, and variety.**

## Directions

1. Pat the chicken dry and season both sides with the salt, pepper, and garlic powder. Lightly dust with the whole wheat flour.
2. Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
3. Sear the chicken for 4–5 minutes per side until golden brown. Transfer to a plate.
4. Reduce the heat to medium. Add the butter and onion. Cook for 5 minutes until softened.
5. Stir in the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
6. Add the cherry tomatoes and cook until they begin to burst, about 5–6 minutes.
7. Add the sun-dried tomatoes.
8. In a blender, combine the cannellini beans, chicken stock, and half-and-half until completely smooth.
9. Pour the bean mixture into the skillet and stir well.
10. Stir in the Parmesan cheese until melted.
11. Add the spinach and cook just until wilted.
12. Stir in the basil, oregano, and thyme.
13. Return the chicken and any accumulated juices to the pan.
14. Simmer gently for 5–8 minutes until the chicken reaches 165°F and the sauce has thickened.
15. Serve immediately with extra basil and freshly grated Parmesan.

### Arc Tip

*The secret to this creamy sauce isn't heavy cream—it's blended cannellini beans. They create a silky, luxurious texture while adding protein, fiber, and nutrients that traditional cream sauces simply don't provide. It's one of those small kitchen upgrades that makes a recipe both more satisfying and more nourishing without sacrificing flavor.*

# Nutrition & Score: Creamy Tuscan Chicken

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~485 kcal |
| Protein | ~49 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~18 g |
| Fiber | ~5 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~13 g |
| Fat | ~23 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~7 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~11 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~220 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~260 mg |
| Iron | ~3.5 mg |
| Magnesium | ~95 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,050 mg |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 49 g
**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex
**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil
**Produce**: Yes Tomatoes, spinach, onion, garlic, fresh herbs
**Polyphenols**: Yes Tomatoes, garlic, herbs, olive oil
**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with fiber-rich white beans
**Gut Health**: Yes White beans, spinach, garlic, herbs
**Heart Health**: Excellent Olive oil, beans, leafy greens
**Brain Health**: Excellent Leafy greens, garlic, herbs, healthy fats

# Rustic Chicken & Mushroom Bake

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 25 minutesCook Time: 45–50 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken thighs
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 2 Tbsp whole wheat flour (for lightly dusting)

**Rustic Mushroom Herb Sauce**

- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1 large yellow onion, thinly sliced
- 16 oz cremini mushrooms, thickly sliced
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 2 Tbsp whole wheat flour
- 2 cups homemade chicken stock (or low-sodium chicken broth)
- ½ cup half-and-half
- 2 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- 1 Tbsp fresh rosemary, finely chopped
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- ¼ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese

**Finish**

- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley

**Fresh thyme leaves**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Complete the meal with one or two vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F.
2. Pat the chicken dry and season both sides with the sea salt, pepper, and garlic powder. Lightly dust with the whole wheat flour.
3. Heat the olive oil in a large oven-safe skillet or Dutch oven over medium-high heat.
4. Sear the chicken for 4–5 minutes per side until beautifully golden. Transfer to a plate. The chicken will finish cooking in the oven.
5. Reduce the heat to medium. Melt the butter and add the onion. Cook for 6–8 minutes until softened.
6. Add the mushrooms. Cook for 10–12 minutes, allowing them to release their moisture and become deeply browned.
7. Stir in the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
8. Sprinkle the flour over the vegetables and cook for 1 minute.
9. Slowly whisk in the chicken stock, followed by the half-and-half.
10. Stir in the Dijon mustard, Parmesan, thyme, rosemary, and parsley. Simmer until the sauce begins to thicken.
11. Return the chicken and any accumulated juices to the skillet, nestling it into the mushroom sauce.
12. Transfer to the oven and bake for 20–25 minutes, or until the chicken reaches 165°F.
13. Garnish with fresh parsley and thyme before serving.

### Arc Tip

*Give the mushrooms time. As they cook, they'll release their moisture before they begin to brown. Be patient and let that liquid evaporate—it's the deep caramelization that gives this dish its rich, savory flavor and creates the foundation of the sauce.*

# Nutrition & Score: Rustic Chicken & Mushroom Bake

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~445 kcal |
| Protein | ~40 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~11 g |
| Fiber | ~2 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~9 g |
| Fat | ~27 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~7 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~12 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~200 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~145 mg |
| Iron | ~2.9 mg |
| Magnesium | ~58 mg |
| Potassium | ~820 mg |
| Vitamin D | Good source |
| Niacin (B3) | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |
| Phosphorus | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 40 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil

**Produce**: Yes Mushrooms, onion, garlic, fresh herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Mushrooms, garlic, herbs, olive oil

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with low carbohydrate load

**Gut Health**: Yes Mushrooms, onions, garlic

**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean protein and olive oil

**Brain Health**: Excellent Mushrooms provide ergothioneine, along with selenium and B vitamins

# Chicken Parmesan (Arc Style)

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 30 minutesCook Time: 35 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken breasts
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- ½ cup whole wheat flour
- 2 large eggs, beaten
- 1 cup whole wheat panko breadcrumbs
- ½ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp dried Italian seasoning
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil

**Fresh Marinara**

- 2 lbs Roma tomatoes, diced
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 small yellow onion, finely diced
- 5 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 2 Tbsp tomato paste
- ¼ cup fresh basil, chopped
- 2 tsp fresh oregano
- Sea salt and freshly cracked black pepper

**Topping**

- 8 oz fresh mozzarella, sliced
- ¼ cup freshly grated Parmesan

**Fresh basil leaves**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add one or two vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide to complete the meal.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F. Line a baking sheet with parchment paper and lightly brush it with olive oil.
2. If needed, pound the chicken breasts to an even ½-inch thickness for even cooking.
3. Season both sides of the chicken with the sea salt and pepper.

**Set up a breading station:**

**Bowl 1: Whole wheat flour**

**Bowl 2: Beaten eggs**

1. Bowl 3: Whole wheat panko, Parmesan, garlic powder, and Italian seasoning
2. Coat each chicken breast in flour, then egg, then the breadcrumb mixture, pressing gently so it adheres.
3. Arrange the chicken on the prepared baking sheet. Lightly brush or drizzle the tops with olive oil.
4. Bake for 20–25 minutes, flipping once halfway through, until the coating is golden and the chicken reaches 165°F.

**Fresh Marinara**

1. While the chicken bakes, heat the olive oil in a saucepan over medium heat.
2. Add the onion and cook until softened, about 5 minutes.
3. Stir in the garlic and tomato paste. Cook for 1 minute.
4. Add the Roma tomatoes and simmer for 20–25 minutes until they break down into a rich sauce.
5. Stir in the basil and oregano. Season with salt and pepper to taste.

**Finish**

1. Spoon the marinara over each chicken breast.
2. Top with fresh mozzarella and Parmesan.
3. Return to the oven for 5–7 minutes until the cheese is melted and lightly golden.
4. Garnish with fresh basil and serve immediately.

### Arc Tip

*Fresh mozzarella contains more moisture than shredded cheese. Before placing it on the chicken, gently pat the slices dry with a paper towel. This simple step helps the cheese melt beautifully while keeping the crispy coating underneath from becoming soggy.*

# Nutrition & Score: Chicken Parmesan (Arc Style)

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~495 kcal |
| Protein | ~50 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~22 g |
| Fiber | ~4 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~18 g |
| Fat | ~22 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~7 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~10 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~170 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~330 mg |
| Iron | ~3.8 mg |
| Magnesium | ~68 mg |
| Potassium | ~980 mg |
| Vitamin A | Good source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Lycopene | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 50 g
**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex
**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil
**Produce**: Yes Tomatoes, onion, garlic, basil
**Polyphenols**: Yes Tomatoes, garlic, herbs, olive oil
**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with moderate carbohydrates
**Gut Health**: Yes Fresh tomatoes, garlic, herbs
**Heart Health**: Excellent Baked instead of fried with olive oil
**Brain Health**: Excellent Lycopene, fresh herbs, healthy fats

# Chicken Pesto Pasta

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 25 minutesCook Time: 20 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken breasts
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- 2 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 Tbsp fresh oregano, chopped

**Homemade Pesto**

- 2 cups packed fresh basil leaves
- ½ cup fresh parsley
- ⅓ cup toasted pine nuts (or walnuts)
- 2 cloves fresh garlic
- ½ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- ½ cup extra virgin olive oil

**Juice of ½ lemon**

- ½ tsp sea salt
- ¼ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Pasta & Vegetables**

- 8 oz whole wheat or protein pasta of choice
- 2 cups cherry tomatoes
- 2 medium zucchini, shaved into ribbons with a vegetable peeler
- 1 bunch asparagus, trimmed and cut into 2-inch pieces
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 Tbsp toasted pine nuts (for garnish)

**Fresh basil leaves**

**Freshly grated Parmesan cheese**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**This recipe is a complete meal as written. If you're fueling a higher activity day or feeding hungry teenagers, pair it with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add another colorful vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide to make the meal even more vibrant and nutrient-dense.**

## Directions

1. Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil. Cook the pasta according to package directions until al dente. Reserve ½ cup of the pasta water before draining.
2. Prepare the pesto. Add the basil, parsley, toasted pine nuts, garlic, Parmesan cheese, lemon juice, sea salt, and black pepper to the bowl of a food processor. Pulse several times until finely chopped. With the processor running, slowly drizzle in the olive oil until the pesto is smooth but still has a little texture. Scrape down the sides as needed and pulse again. Taste and adjust with an extra squeeze of lemon or pinch of sea salt if desired. Set aside.
3. In a small bowl, whisk together the olive oil, garlic, lemon zest, lemon juice, oregano, sea salt, and black pepper.
4. Add the chicken and toss to coat evenly. Let marinate for 15–20 minutes while preparing the vegetables.
5. Heat a grill pan or outdoor grill over medium-high heat. Grill the chicken for 5–6 minutes per side, or until the internal temperature reaches 165°F. Transfer to a cutting board and allow the chicken to rest for 5 minutes before slicing.
6. Meanwhile, heat 1 tablespoon of olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
7. Add the asparagus and cook for about 4 minutes, until crisp-tender.
8. Add the cherry tomatoes and cook for another 2–3 minutes, just until they begin to blister and release their juices.
9. Gently stir in the zucchini ribbons and cook for 1 minute, just until slightly softened but still vibrant.
10. Add the drained pasta to the skillet with the vegetables. Remove the skillet from the heat and stir in the pesto, adding a splash of the reserved pasta water as needed until the pasta is evenly coated with a light, silky sauce.
11. Divide the pasta among four bowls and top with the sliced grilled chicken.
12. Garnish with toasted pine nuts, fresh basil, freshly grated Parmesan cheese, and an extra squeeze of fresh lemon, if desired.

### Arc Tip

*Pesto should taste fresh and vibrant—not cooked. Toss it with the warm pasta after removing the skillet from the heat. The residual warmth gently coats the pasta while preserving the bright flavor and beautiful green color of the fresh basil.*

# Nutrition & Score: Chicken Pesto Pasta

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~565 kcal |
| Protein | ~47 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~28 g |
| Fiber | ~6 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~22 g |
| Fat | ~29 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~6 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~16 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~230 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~280 mg |
| Iron | ~3.6 mg |
| Magnesium | ~110 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,050 mg |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 47 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Extra virgin olive oil and pine nuts

**Produce**: Yes Basil, parsley, tomatoes, zucchini, asparagus, garlic, lemon

**Polyphenols**: Yes Fresh herbs, garlic, olive oil, tomatoes

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes Balanced with lean protein, vegetables, and whole grain or protein pasta

**Gut Health**: Yes Diverse vegetables, fresh herbs, healthy fats

**Heart Health**: Excellent Olive oil, nuts, herbs, colorful vegetables

**Brain Health**: Excellent Healthy fats, leafy herbs, antioxidant-rich vegetables

# Lemon Herb Chicken Orzo Skillet

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 20 minutesCook Time: 35 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken breasts, halved horizontally into cutlets
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- 2 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp fresh oregano, chopped

**Orzo Skillet**

- 1 cup dry whole wheat orzo
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 medium leek, cleaned well and thinly sliced
- 3 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 1 bunch asparagus, trimmed and cut into 2-inch pieces
- 1 cup fresh peas
- 3 cups homemade chicken stock (or low-sodium chicken broth)
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 2 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup crumbled feta cheese
- 2 Tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**This meal is well balanced as written. For higher energy needs, pair it with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add another seasonal vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide to increase color, fiber, and variety.**

## Directions

1. In a small bowl, whisk together the olive oil, garlic, lemon zest, lemon juice, oregano, sea salt, and black pepper.
2. Coat the chicken evenly with the marinade and let rest for 15–20 minutes while preparing the remaining ingredients.
3. Heat a large, deep skillet over medium-high heat. Add the olive oil.
4. Sear the chicken for 4–5 minutes per side until golden brown. Transfer to a plate. The chicken will finish cooking later.
5. Reduce the heat to medium. Add the sliced leek and cook for about 4 minutes until softened.
6. Stir in the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
7. Add the dry orzo and toast it for 2–3 minutes, stirring frequently until lightly golden and fragrant.
8. Pour in the chicken stock and stir well, scraping any browned bits from the bottom of the skillet.
9. Bring to a gentle simmer. Cover and cook for 8 minutes, stirring occasionally.
10. Add the asparagus and peas. Continue cooking uncovered for another 4–5 minutes, until the orzo is tender and most of the liquid has been absorbed.
11. Stir in the butter, lemon zest, lemon juice, fresh dill, and parsley.
12. Nestle the chicken back into the skillet along with any accumulated juices. Cover and cook for 3–5 minutes, or until the chicken reaches an internal temperature of 165°F.
13. Sprinkle with crumbled feta and garnish with additional fresh dill and parsley before serving.

### Arc Tip

*Don't skip toasting the dry orzo before adding the broth. Just a few minutes in the warm skillet develops a lightly nutty flavor and helps the orzo maintain its texture as it cooks, creating a beautifully silky skillet without needing heavy cream.*

# Nutrition & Score: Lemon Herb Chicken Orzo Skillet

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~515 kcal |
| Protein | ~46 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~28 g |
| Fiber | ~5 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~23 g |
| Fat | ~22 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~6 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~11 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~220 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~210 mg |
| Iron | ~3.4 mg |
| Magnesium | ~82 mg |
| Potassium | ~980 mg |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B6 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 46 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil and feta

**Produce**: Yes Leeks, asparagus, peas, garlic, lemon, fresh herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Lemon, garlic, herbs, olive oil

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with whole grain orzo and fiber-rich vegetables

**Gut Health**: Yes Leeks provide prebiotic fiber alongside vegetables and herbs

**Heart Health**: Excellent Olive oil, vegetables, fresh herbs

**Brain Health**: Excellent Fresh herbs, healthy fats, vitamin-rich vegetables

# Harissa Chicken & Cauliflower

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 20 minutes (plus 30 minutes marinating, if time allows)Cook Time: 35–40 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken thighs
- 2 Tbsp harissa paste
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 3 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 2 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp ground coriander
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 2 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Vegetables**

- 1 large head cauliflower, cut into florets
- 2 large carrots, peeled and sliced on the diagonal
- 1 large red onion, cut into wedges
- 1½ cups cooked chickpeas
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- ½ tsp sea salt
- ¼ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Finish**

- ¼ cup chopped fresh parsley
- 2 Tbsp chopped fresh mint
- ¼ cup toasted pistachios, roughly chopped

**Lemon wedges**

**Optional Lemon Yogurt Drizzle**

- ½ cup plain Greek yogurt
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1 tsp lemon zest
- 1 Tbsp chopped fresh parsley

**Pinch of sea salt**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together the harissa paste, olive oil, garlic, lemon zest, lemon juice, cumin, coriander, smoked paprika, sea salt, and black pepper.
3. Add the chicken and toss until evenly coated. Marinate for at least 30 minutes, or up to overnight for deeper flavor.
4. In a separate bowl, toss the cauliflower, carrots, red onion, and chickpeas with the olive oil, sea salt, and pepper.
5. Spread the vegetables onto a large sheet pan.
6. Nestle the chicken between the vegetables, allowing space around each piece for even roasting.
7. Roast for 35–40 minutes, stirring the vegetables halfway through, until the chicken reaches 165°F and the vegetables are caramelized.
8. While the chicken roasts, whisk together the Greek yogurt, lemon juice, lemon zest, parsley, and a pinch of sea salt if making the yogurt drizzle.
9. Transfer everything to a serving platter.
10. Sprinkle with the parsley, mint, and toasted pistachios.
11. Serve with lemon wedges and drizzle with the lemon yogurt sauce, if desired.

### Arc Tip

*Harissa pastes can vary quite a bit in heat. Start with the amount listed in the recipe, then taste your harissa before adding more. The goal isn't overwhelming spice—it's a warm, smoky depth that lets the chicken, vegetables, and fresh herbs all shine together.*

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**This meal is satisfying as written, but for higher energy needs, pair it with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**
**Add another colorful vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide to make the meal your own.**

# Nutrition & Score: Harissa Chicken & Cauliflower

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~510 kcal |
| Protein | ~41 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~24 g |
| Fiber | ~8 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~16 g |
| Fat | ~28 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~5 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~14 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~240 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~170 mg (with yogurt drizzle) |
| Iron | ~4.2 mg |
| Magnesium | ~105 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,150 mg |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B6 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 41 g
**≥8 g Fiber**: Yes 8 g
**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil and pistachios
**Produce**: Yes Cauliflower, carrots, onion, chickpeas, lemon, herbs
**Polyphenols**: Yes Harissa spices, herbs, olive oil, garlic
**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein, fiber, and healthy fats
**Gut Health**: Yes Chickpeas, cauliflower, onions, herbs
**Heart Health**: Excellent Olive oil, legumes, vegetables
**Brain Health**: Excellent Healthy fats, herbs, colorful vegetables

# Sausage, Peppers & Potatoes

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 20 minutesCook Time: 40–45 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Main Ingredients**

- 2 lbs Italian chicken sausage links (or turkey Italian sausage)
- 1½ lbs baby Yukon Gold potatoes, halved
- 2 red bell peppers, cut into large strips
- 1 yellow bell pepper, cut into large strips
- 1 large red onion, cut into wedges
- 5 cloves fresh garlic, smashed
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- 2 tsp fresh rosemary, chopped
- 2 Tbsp fresh oregano, chopped
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

**Zest of ½ lemon**

**Juice of ½ lemon**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**This meal is complete as written. For higher energy needs, pair it with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add another seasonal vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide to increase color, fiber, and variety.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F.
2. In a large bowl, toss the potatoes with the olive oil, sea salt, black pepper, rosemary, and oregano.
3. Spread the potatoes onto a large sheet pan and roast for 20 minutes.
4. While the potatoes roast, slice each sausage link into 2-inch pieces.
5. Remove the sheet pan from the oven.
6. Add the sausage, bell peppers, onion, and smashed garlic to the pan. Toss everything together gently.
7. Return to the oven and roast for another 20–25 minutes, stirring once halfway through, until the potatoes are tender and the sausage is browned.
8. Remove from the oven and immediately toss with the lemon zest, lemon juice, and fresh parsley.
9. Serve hot.

### Arc Tip

*Roasting the potatoes first gives them a head start so they become perfectly crisp on the outside and tender on the inside. Adding the sausage and peppers later keeps the vegetables vibrant and prevents the sausage from overcooking or drying out.*

# Nutrition & Score: Sausage, Peppers & Potatoes

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~495 kcal |
| Protein | ~34 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~28 g |
| Fiber | ~5 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~23 g |
| Fat | ~28 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~6 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~14 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~210 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~90 mg |
| Iron | ~2.8 mg |
| Magnesium | ~78 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,180 mg |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B6 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 34 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil

**Produce**: Yes Potatoes, peppers, onion, garlic, fresh herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Garlic, peppers, herbs, olive oil

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes Protein balanced with fiber-rich vegetables

**Gut Health**: Yes Onions, garlic, peppers, herbs

**Heart Health**: Excellent Lean sausage, olive oil, colorful vegetables

**Brain Health**: Excellent Vitamin C-rich peppers and fresh herbs

# Garlic Shrimp & Asparagus

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 15 minutesCook Time: 15 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Shrimp**

- 2 lbs large shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 2 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 2 tsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tsp fresh tarragon, chopped
- 2 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Vegetables**

- 2 bunches fresh asparagus, trimmed and cut into 2-inch pieces
- 1 large shallot, thinly sliced
- 1 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil

**Finish**

- ¼ cup toasted sliced almonds
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

**Lemon wedges**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide if you'd like additional energy.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add another seasonal vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide for even more color, fiber, and variety.**

## Directions

1. In a medium bowl, whisk together the olive oil, garlic, lemon zest, lemon juice, parsley, oregano, sea salt, and black pepper.
2. Add the shrimp and toss to coat. Let marinate for 15–20 minutes.
3. Heat 1 tablespoon of olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
4. Add the shallot and cook for 2–3 minutes until softened.
5. Add the asparagus and sauté for 4–5 minutes, until crisp-tender.
6. Transfer the vegetables to a plate and keep warm.
7. Using the same skillet, add the marinated shrimp in a single layer.
8. Cook for 2–3 minutes per side, just until the shrimp turn pink and opaque.
9. Return the asparagus and shallots to the skillet and gently toss everything together for about 1 minute.
10. Remove from the heat and sprinkle with the toasted almonds and fresh parsley.
11. Serve immediately with fresh lemon wedges.

### Arc Tip

*Shrimp cooks incredibly fast. The moment it turns pink and opaque, it's done. Leaving shrimp on the heat even one or two minutes too long can make it tough, while perfectly cooked shrimp stays tender, juicy, and naturally sweet.*

# Nutrition & Score: Garlic Shrimp & Asparagus

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~360 kcal |
| Protein | ~42 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~10 g |
| Fiber | ~4 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~6 g |
| Fat | ~17 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~2.5 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~10 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~420 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~145 mg |
| Iron | ~3.8 mg |
| Magnesium | ~95 mg |
| Potassium | ~860 mg |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Good source |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |
| Iodine | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 42 g
**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex
**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil and almonds
**Produce**: Yes Asparagus, shallot, garlic, lemon, fresh herbs
**Polyphenols**: Yes Garlic, herbs, olive oil
**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with low carbohydrate load
**Gut Health**: Yes Asparagus, shallots, garlic
**Heart Health**: Excellent Shrimp, olive oil, almonds
**Brain Health**: Excellent Selenium, iodine, healthy fats

# Persian Herb Chicken

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 25 minutes (plus 30 minutes marinating, if time allows)Cook Time: 40–45 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Chicken**

- 2 lbs boneless, skinless chicken thighs
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 medium sweet onion, finely grated
- 5 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- ½ cup fresh parsley, chopped
- ¼ cup fresh cilantro, chopped
- 2 Tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- 2 Tbsp fresh mint, chopped
- 2 tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 2 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 2 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper
- Pinch of saffron threads, steeped in 2 Tbsp warm water (optional but recommended)

**Finish**

- ¼ cup toasted walnuts, roughly chopped
- ¼ cup fresh pomegranate arils
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

**Lemon wedges**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair this meal with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide for additional energy.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Complete the meal with one or two vegetables from the Vegetable Flex Guide.**

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F.
2. If using saffron, steep the threads in 2 tablespoons of warm water for about 10 minutes.
3. In a large bowl, combine the olive oil, grated onion, garlic, parsley, cilantro, dill, mint, turmeric, cumin, lemon zest, lemon juice, sea salt, black pepper, and the saffron water.
4. Add the chicken and toss until evenly coated. Cover and marinate for at least 30 minutes, or refrigerate overnight for even deeper flavor.
5. Arrange the chicken in a lightly oiled baking dish or parchment-lined sheet pan, leaving a little space between each piece.
6. Roast for 35–40 minutes, or until the chicken reaches an internal temperature of 165°F and the edges begin to caramelize.
7. For a beautifully golden finish, broil for the final 2–3 minutes, watching carefully.
8. Transfer the chicken to a serving platter.
9. Sprinkle with the toasted walnuts, pomegranate arils, and fresh parsley.
10. Serve immediately with fresh lemon wedges.

### Arc Tip

*Persian cooking celebrates fresh herbs as more than a garnish—they're a main ingredient. Using generous handfuls of parsley, cilantro, dill, and mint creates layers of fresh, vibrant flavor that simply can't be replicated with dried herbs. If you're new to cooking with fresh herbs, this recipe is the perfect place to discover the difference.*

# Nutrition & Score: Persian Herb Chicken

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~470 kcal |
| Protein | ~39 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~11 g |
| Fiber | ~3 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~8 g |
| Fat | ~30 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~6 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~15 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~240 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~95 mg |
| Iron | ~3.8 mg |
| Magnesium | ~88 mg |
| Potassium | ~790 mg |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Good source |
| Vitamin B6 | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 39 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Extra virgin olive oil and walnuts

**Produce**: Yes Onion, garlic, fresh herbs, lemon, pomegranate

**Polyphenols**: Yes Fresh herbs, pomegranate, garlic, olive oil

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with healthy fats and minimal refined carbohydrates

**Gut Health**: Yes Aromatics, fresh herbs, and antioxidant-rich produce

**Heart Health**: Excellent Olive oil, walnuts, herbs, and lean protein

**Brain Health**: Excellent Walnuts, herbs, turmeric, and colorful phytonutrients

# Moroccan Chickpea Tagine

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 25 minutesCook Time: 50–60 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Vegetables**

- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 large yellow onion, diced
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 3 carrots, peeled and sliced
- 2 zucchini, cut into thick half-moons
- 1 medium eggplant, cubed
- 1 red bell pepper, chopped
- 2 lbs Roma tomatoes, roughly chopped
- 2 cups cooked chickpeas
- ½ cup dried apricots, chopped
- 2 cups homemade vegetable stock

**Moroccan Spice Blend**

- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 2 tsp ground coriander
- 1 tsp ground cinnamon
- 1 tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- ½ tsp ground ginger
- ¼ tsp cayenne pepper (optional)
- 2 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Finish**

- ¼ cup chopped fresh cilantro
- ¼ cup chopped fresh parsley
- ¼ cup toasted sliced almonds
- Zest of 1 lemon

**Juice of ½ lemon**

## Serve With

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide if you'd like additional energy.**

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Add another seasonal vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide to make this meal even more colorful.**

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a large Dutch oven or tagine over medium heat.
2. Add the onion and cook for 5–6 minutes until softened.
3. Stir in the garlic and cook for 30 seconds.
4. Add the carrots and cook for another 4 minutes.
5. Stir in the cumin, coriander, cinnamon, turmeric, smoked paprika, ginger, cayenne (if using), sea salt, and black pepper. Cook for about 1 minute until fragrant.
6. Add the chopped Roma tomatoes and cook for 8–10 minutes, stirring occasionally, until they begin to break down.
7. Stir in the vegetable stock, chickpeas, apricots, zucchini, eggplant, and bell pepper.
8. Bring to a gentle simmer.
9. Cover and cook over low heat for 35–40 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the vegetables are tender and the sauce has naturally thickened.
10. Stir in the lemon zest and lemon juice.
11. Sprinkle with the fresh cilantro, parsley, and toasted almonds before serving.

### Arc Tip

*Don't rush the spices. Cooking them in olive oil for about a minute before adding the tomatoes wakes up their natural oils and creates the deep, aromatic flavor that gives a tagine its signature warmth.*

# Nutrition & Score: Moroccan Chickpea Tagine

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~365 kcal |
| Protein | ~12 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~42 g |
| Fiber | ~11 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~31 g |
| Fat | ~17 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~2 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~10 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~180 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~125 mg |
| Iron | ~4.8 mg |
| Magnesium | ~110 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,050 mg |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Manganese | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Note: Pair with a Protein Flex option

**≥8 g Fiber**: Yes 11 g

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil and almonds

**Produce**: Yes Onion, garlic, carrots, zucchini, eggplant, peppers, tomatoes, lemon, herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Herbs, spices, olive oil, colorful vegetables

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High fiber with healthy fats

**Gut Health**: Yes Chickpeas, vegetables, aromatics, herbs

**Heart Health**: Excellent Legumes, olive oil, vegetables

**Brain Health**: Excellent Colorful vegetables, spices, healthy fats

# Mediterranean Stuffed Eggplant

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 30 minutesCook Time: 45 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Eggplant**

- 2 medium eggplants
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Filling**

- Reserved roasted eggplant flesh, roughly chopped
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 medium yellow onion, diced
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 1 roasted red bell pepper, diced
- ¼ cup Kalamata olives, roughly chopped
- 2 tsp fresh oregano, chopped
- ¼ cup fresh parsley, chopped
- ¼ cup fresh basil, chopped
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 Tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 2 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Warm Tomatoes**

- 1½ lbs Roma tomatoes, diced
- 1 tsp extra virgin olive oil

**Pinch of sea salt**

**Topping**

- 4 oz fresh mozzarella, torn into bite-sized pieces
- ¼ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese

**Finish**

- ¼ cup toasted pine nuts

**Fresh basil leaves**

**Fresh parsley**

**Lemon wedges**

- Optional: A light drizzle of aged balsamic glaze

## Directions

**Roast the Eggplant**

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F.
2. Slice each eggplant in half lengthwise.
3. Score the flesh in a crisscross pattern without cutting through the skin.
4. Brush the cut sides with olive oil and season with the sea salt and pepper.
5. Place the eggplants cut-side down on a parchment-lined baking sheet and roast for 25–30 minutes, or until completely tender.
6. Allow the eggplants to cool slightly. Carefully scoop out most of the flesh, leaving about ½ inch around the edges so the shells hold their shape. Roughly chop the reserved eggplant.

**Prepare the Filling**

1. Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the onion and cook for 5–6 minutes, until softened.
3. Stir in the garlic and cook for about 30 seconds, until fragrant.
4. Add the chopped roasted eggplant and cook for 3–4 minutes, allowing excess moisture to evaporate and the flavors to concentrate.
5. Stir in the roasted red pepper, Kalamata olives, oregano, sea salt, and black pepper. Cook for another 2 minutes, just until warmed through.
6. Remove the skillet from the heat and gently fold in the fresh parsley, basil, lemon zest, and lemon juice. Set aside.

**Warm the Tomatoes**

1. Heat 1 teaspoon of olive oil in a separate skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the diced Roma tomatoes with a pinch of sea salt.
3. Cook for only 2–3 minutes, just until the tomatoes are warmed and begin to soften while still holding their shape.

**Assemble**

1. Spoon the Mediterranean filling evenly into each roasted eggplant shell.
2. Top each with a generous spoonful of the warm tomatoes.
3. Scatter the torn fresh mozzarella over the tomatoes and finish with the freshly grated Parmesan.
4. Place under the broiler for 2–4 minutes, just until the cheese is melted and lightly golden.
5. If using, top with your Protein Flex of choice.
6. Finish with the toasted pine nuts, fresh basil, fresh parsley, and a squeeze of fresh lemon.
7. Optional: Drizzle lightly with aged balsamic glaze just before serving.

## Serve With

**Protein Flex (Optional)**
**Top with your favorite protein from the Protein Flex Guide.**

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**
**Pair with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide for additional energy.**

# Nutrition & Score: Mediterranean Stuffed Eggplant

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~385 kcal |
| Protein | ~14 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~20 g |
| Fiber | ~7 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~13 g |
| Fat | ~26 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~6 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~13 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~220 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~240 mg |
| Iron | ~3.3 mg |
| Magnesium | ~80 mg |
| Potassium | ~1,050 mg |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B6 | Excellent source |
| Manganese | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Note: Achieve with Protein Flex

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: 7 g (Easily increased with Vegetable Flex.)

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Olive oil, pine nuts, olives

**Produce**: Yes Eggplant, tomatoes, peppers, onion, garlic, fresh herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Eggplant, olives, herbs, garlic, olive oil

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High fiber with healthy fats and customizable protein

**Gut Health**: Yes Eggplant, tomatoes, garlic, herbs

**Heart Health**: Excellent Olive oil, vegetables, nuts

**Brain Health**: Excellent Colorful vegetables, herbs, healthy fats

# Mediterranean Vegetable Gratin

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 35 minutes (plus 20 minutes for salting the eggplant)Cook Time: 50–55 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Vegetables**

- 1 medium eggplant, sliced into ¼-inch rounds
- 2 medium zucchini, sliced into ¼-inch rounds
- 2 medium yellow summer squash, sliced into ¼-inch rounds
- 4–5 Roma tomatoes, sliced into ¼-inch rounds (or use a combination of Roma and heirloom tomatoes when in season)
- 2 medium leeks, cleaned well and sliced into thin half-moons
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced

**Herb Olive Oil**

- ¼ cup extra virgin olive oil
- 2 Tbsp fresh oregano, chopped
- 2 Tbsp fresh thyme leaves
- 1 tsp finely minced fresh rosemary
- ¼ cup fresh parsley, chopped
- 1 tsp sea salt
- ½ tsp freshly cracked black pepper

**Topping**

- 6 oz fresh mozzarella, torn into small pieces
- ⅓ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese

**Finish**

**Fresh basil leaves**

**Fresh parsley**

**Fresh thyme leaves**

- Optional: Light drizzle of aged balsamic glaze

## Serve With

**Protein Flex (Optional)**

**Top or serve alongside your favorite protein from the Protein Flex Guide.**

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**Pair with your favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide for additional energy.**

## Directions

**Prepare the Eggplant**

1. Arrange the eggplant slices on paper towels or a wire rack and lightly sprinkle both sides with sea salt.
2. Let stand for 20 minutes to draw out excess moisture.
3. Pat the slices dry with paper towels.
4. Preheat the oven to 375°F.

**Prepare the Herb Oil**

1. In a small bowl, whisk together the olive oil, garlic, oregano, thyme, rosemary, parsley, sea salt, and black pepper.

**Assemble the Gratin**

1. Lightly brush the bottom and sides of a 10–12-inch round ceramic baking dish or cast-iron skillet with a little of the herb oil.
2. Beginning around the outer edge of the dish, arrange the vegetables in an overlapping pattern:

**Eggplant**

**Roma tomato**

**Zucchini**

**Yellow squash**

**Leek**

1. Continue repeating the pattern while working toward the center until the dish is completely filled.
2. As you build the layers, lightly brush every third or fourth row with the herb olive oil, allowing some to drip down between the vegetables. This seasons every bite without making the dish oily.
3. Once assembled, brush the remaining herb oil lightly over the top.
4. Cover loosely with foil.
5. Bake for 35 minutes.
6. Remove the foil.
7. Nestle the torn fresh mozzarella throughout the vegetables, allowing the colorful vegetables to remain visible.
8. Sprinkle evenly with the Parmesan cheese.
9. Return to the oven for 10–15 minutes, or until the vegetables are tender.
10. Broil for 2–3 minutes, just until the cheese begins to brown in spots.

**Finish**

1. Allow the gratin to rest for 10 minutes before serving.
2. Scatter the fresh basil, parsley, and thyme over the top.
3. Optional: Finish with a light drizzle of aged balsamic glaze just before serving.

# Nutrition & Score: Mediterranean Vegetable Gratin

### Base Recipe

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~275 kcal |
| Protein | ~10 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~15 g |
| Fiber | ~5 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~10 g |
| Fat | ~20 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~5 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~11 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~180 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~260 mg |
| Iron | ~2.3 mg |
| Magnesium | ~55 mg |
| Potassium | ~720 mg |
| Vitamin A | Excellent source |
| Vitamin C | Excellent source |
| Vitamin K | Excellent source |
| Folate | Excellent source |
| Manganese | Excellent source |

### Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Note: Achieve with Protein Flex

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex or Protein Flex pairing

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Extra virgin olive oil

**Produce**: Yes Eggplant, tomatoes, zucchini, yellow squash, leeks, garlic, fresh herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Olive oil, herbs, garlic, colorful vegetables

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes Healthy fats with fiber-rich vegetables

**Gut Health**: Yes Diverse vegetables, leeks, garlic, fresh herbs

**Heart Health**: Excellent Olive oil, vegetables, herbs

**Brain Health**: Excellent Colorful vegetables, olive oil, fresh herbs

# Beef Stroganoff (Arc Style)

*Serves: 6Prep Time: 25 minutesCook Time: 35 minutes*

## Ingredients

### Beef

- 2 lbs top sirloin steak, thinly sliced against the grain
- 2 Tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tsp sea salt
- 1 tsp freshly cracked black pepper

### Stroganoff

- 1 lb cremini mushrooms, sliced
- 1 large yellow onion, thinly sliced
- 4 cloves fresh garlic, minced
- 2 tsp fresh thyme leaves
- 2 Tbsp tomato paste
- 1 Tbsp Dijon mustard
- 1 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 2½ cups homemade beef stock
- 1 tsp cornstarch or arrowroot starch
- 1 Tbsp cold water
- ¾ cup light sour cream
- 2 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

### Noodles

- 8 oz whole wheat egg noodles
- 1 tsp butter
- 1 Tbsp fresh parsley, chopped

## Serve With

**Vegetable Flex (Optional)**

**Pair with your favorite vegetable from the Vegetable Flex Guide to add color, fiber, and freshness.**

**Smart Carb Flex (Optional)**

**This recipe includes whole wheat egg noodles. For higher energy needs, add another favorite option from the Smart Carb Flex Guide.**

## Directions

### Cook the Noodles

1. Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil.
2. Cook the whole wheat egg noodles until al dente according to package directions.
3. Drain and toss immediately with the butter and chopped parsley. Cover to keep warm.

### Sear the Beef

1. Pat the beef dry with paper towels and season with the sea salt and pepper.
2. Heat the olive oil in a large Dutch oven or deep skillet over medium-high heat.
3. Working in batches, quickly sear the beef for 1–2 minutes, just until browned. Avoid overcrowding the pan.
4. Transfer the beef to a plate.

### Build the Sauce

1. Reduce the heat to medium.
2. Add the onions and cook for 5–6 minutes, until softened and lightly caramelized.
3. Add the mushrooms and continue cooking for 8–10 minutes, allowing them to release their moisture and develop a deep golden color.
4. Stir in the garlic and thyme and cook for about 30 seconds until fragrant.
5. Add the tomato paste and cook for 1 minute.
6. Stir in the Dijon mustard and Worcestershire sauce.
7. Pour in the beef stock, scraping up any browned bits from the bottom of the pan.
8. Simmer uncovered for 8–10 minutes, allowing the sauce to reduce naturally.
9. Whisk together the corn or arrowroot starch (whichever you are using) and 1-2 tablespoons of the hot broth from the pan. Stir into the sauce and cook for 1–2 minutes, until lightly thickened.

### Finish the Stroganoff

1. Reduce the heat to low.
2. Stir the sour cream into the sauce until smooth.
3. Return the beef and any accumulated juices to the skillet.
4. Warm gently for 2–3 minutes, just until the beef is heated through.
5. Do not allow the sauce to boil after adding the sour cream.
6. Stir in the fresh parsley.
7. Serve the stroganoff over the warm parsleyed egg noodles.

# Nutrition & Score: Beef Stroganoff (Arc Style)

### Per Serving

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calories | ~510 kcal |
| Protein | ~42 g |
| Carbohydrates | ~24 g |
| Fiber | ~4 g |
| Net Carbohydrates | ~20 g |
| Fat | ~27 g |
| Saturated Fat | ~8 g |
| Monounsaturated Fat | ~13 g |
| Omega-3 Fatty Acids | ~220 mg |

### Micronutrients

| Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|
| Calcium | ~120 mg |
| Iron | ~4.8 mg |
| Magnesium | ~70 mg |
| Potassium | ~980 mg |
| Vitamin B12 | Excellent source |
| Zinc | Excellent source |
| Selenium | Excellent source |
| Vitamin B6 | Excellent source |

## Arc Nutrition Score

**≥25 g Protein**: Yes 42 g

**≥8 g Fiber**: Note: Increase with Vegetable Flex

**Healthy Fats**: Yes Extra virgin olive oil

**Produce**: Yes Mushrooms, onions, garlic, fresh herbs

**Polyphenols**: Yes Mushrooms, garlic, herbs

**Blood Sugar Friendly**: Yes High protein with balanced portions of whole wheat noodles

**Gut Health**: Yes Mushrooms, onions, garlic

**Heart Health**: Good Lean beef, olive oil, fresh ingredients

**Brain Health**: Excellent Iron, B12, zinc, selenium

# SECTION 5: SIDES

*Sides That Steal The Show*

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Garlic Rosemary Baby Potatoes

Lemon Herb Green Beans with Toasted Almonds

Mediterranean Roasted Vegetables

Herbed White Beans with Olive Oil

Roasted Carrots with Whipped Feta & Pistachios

Charred Broccolini with Lemon & Parmesan

Warm Farro with Herbs & Lemon

Mediterranean Cucumber Tomato Salad

Garlic Sautéed Greens

Crispy Cauliflower with Lemon Tahini

## Warm Farro *with* Herbs & Lemon

*Hearty farro tossed with fresh herbs, lemon zest, and olive oil—nutty, bright, and satisfying. A wholesome side for any meal.*

## Mediterranean Cucumber Tomato Salad

*Cool, crisp, and refreshing with cucumbers, tomatoes, fresh parsley, and cilantro tossed in lemon and olive oil. Simple, vibrant, and perfect for any table.*

## Crispy Cauliflower *with Lemon Tahini*

*Golden, roasted cauliflower tossed in olive oil and spices, then drizzled with creamy lemon tahini and fresh herbs. Crispy, tangy, and totally addictive.*

## Lemon Herb Green Beans
*with Toasted Almonds*

*Bright, fresh, and perfectly balanced—tender green beans tossed with lemon, herbs, and toasted almonds for a crisp, flavorful side.*

## Roasted Carrots
*with Whipped Feta & Pistachios*

*Sweet, caramelized carrots on a bed of creamy whipped feta, finished with crunchy pistachios and a drizzle of olive oil.*

## Charred Broccolini
*with Lemon & Parmesan*

*Charred to perfection for a slightly smoky bite, brightened with lemon and finished with nutty Parmesan.*

# Garlic Rosemary Baby Potatoes

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 15 minutesCook Time: 40 minutes*

## Ingredients

- 1½ pounds baby Yukon Gold potatoes, halved (or quartered if large)
- 4 cups low-sodium vegetable or chicken stock
- 2 whole garlic cloves, smashed
- 1 sprig fresh rosemary
- 1 bay leaf
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tablespoon fresh rosemary, finely chopped
- 1 teaspoon kosher salt (adjust depending on the stock used)
- ½ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- Zest of ½ lemon
- 1 tablespoon fresh parsley, chopped
- Flaky sea salt, for finishing (optional)

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Place the potatoes in a saucepan and cover with the vegetable or chicken stock. Add the smashed garlic cloves, rosemary sprig, and bay leaf.
3. Bring to a gentle simmer and cook for 8–10 minutes, or until the potatoes are just fork tender. They should still hold their shape.
4. Drain well and discard the garlic, rosemary, and bay leaf. Allow the potatoes to steam dry for 3–5 minutes.
5. Return the potatoes to the warm pot and gently shake or toss until the edges become slightly rough and fluffy. Those tiny ridges are what create the crisp, golden crust during roasting.
6. Transfer the potatoes to a large bowl. Add the olive oil, minced garlic, chopped rosemary, kosher salt, and pepper. Toss gently to coat.
7. Spread onto the prepared baking sheet in a single layer with the cut sides facing down whenever possible.
8. Roast for 20 minutes. Flip and continue roasting 15–20 minutes, until deeply golden and crisp.
9. Transfer to a serving bowl and toss with the lemon zest and fresh parsley. Finish with flaky sea salt, if desired.

### Chef's Tip

*The secret to restaurant-quality roasted potatoes isn't extra oil—it's technique. Simmering the potatoes in flavorful stock creates a creamy interior, while allowing them to steam dry and gently roughing their surface produces irresistibly crisp, golden edges during roasting.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 193 | Monounsaturated Fat | 5.2 g | Calcium | 24 mg |
| Protein | 3.4 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.8 g | Iron | 1.2 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 28.6 g | Omega-3 | 0.05 g | Magnesium | 36 mg |
| Fiber | 3.4 g | Omega-6 | 0.7 g | Phosphorus | 88 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 25.2 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 18 mg |
| Total Fat | 7.2 g | Sodium* | ~300 mg | Vitamin B6 | 0.5 mg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.0 g | Potassium | ~730 mg | Folate | 26 mcg |

## Why You'll Love This Side

- Rich in potassium to support healthy muscles, nerves, and blood pressure.
- Fresh garlic and rosemary add natural antioxidants and incredible flavor.
- Extra virgin olive oil provides heart-healthy monounsaturated fats and beneficial polyphenols.
- The combination of simmering and roasting creates a creamy interior with beautifully crisp edges—without deep frying.

# Lemon Herb Green Beans with Toasted Almonds

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 10 minutesCook Time: 12 minutes*

## Ingredients

- 1 pound fresh French green beans (haricots verts), trimmed
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 2 cloves garlic, minced

**⅓ cup sliced almonds**

- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh parsley
- 1 teaspoon chopped fresh thyme

**½ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

## Directions

1. Bring a large pot of salted water to a boil. Prepare a bowl of ice water nearby.
2. Add the green beans and cook for 3–4 minutes, just until bright green and crisp-tender.
3. Immediately transfer the beans to the ice bath to stop the cooking. Drain well and pat dry.
4. Meanwhile, heat a large skillet over medium heat. Add the sliced almonds and toast for 3–4 minutes, stirring frequently, until fragrant and lightly golden. Transfer to a small bowl.
5. Return the skillet to medium heat and add the olive oil. Stir in the garlic and cook for 30–60 seconds, just until fragrant.
6. Add the green beans and sauté for 2–3 minutes, tossing frequently until heated through.
7. Stir in the lemon zest, lemon juice, parsley, thyme, kosher salt, and black pepper.
8. Remove from the heat and fold in the toasted almonds just before serving to keep them crisp.
9. Serve immediately.

### Chef's Tip

*Blanching the green beans before sautéing preserves their vibrant green color while keeping them perfectly crisp-tender. Adding the toasted almonds just before serving keeps their crunch and prevents them from softening.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 146 | Monounsaturated Fat | 6.6 g | Calcium | 72 mg |
| Protein | 4.3 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.3 g | Iron | 1.5 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 10.4 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Magnesium | 42 mg |
| Fiber | 4.5 g | Omega-6 | 2.2 g | Phosphorus | 88 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 5.9 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 19 mg |
| Total Fat | 10.8 g | Sodium | 310 mg | Vitamin K | 48 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.3 g | Potassium | 340 mg | Folate | 38 mcg |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- Green beans are packed with fiber, vitamin C, and vitamin K, helping support immune health, bone strength, and healthy digestion.
- Toasted almonds provide satisfying crunch along with heart-healthy fats, vitamin E, and magnesium.
- Fresh lemon and herbs brighten every bite without relying on heavy sauces or butter.
- This elegant side pairs beautifully with seafood, chicken, beef, or vegetarian entrées, making it one you'll reach for all year long.

# Mediterranean Roasted Vegetables

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 15 minutesCook Time: 35–40 minutes*

## Ingredients

- 1 medium zucchini, sliced into thick half moons
- 1 yellow squash, sliced into thick half moons
- 1 red bell pepper, cut into 1-inch pieces
- 1 orange bell pepper, cut into 1-inch pieces
- 1 small red onion, cut into wedges
- 8 ounces baby bella mushrooms, halved
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes
- 4 cloves garlic, smashed
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 teaspoon dried thyme
- ½ teaspoon smoked paprika

**¾ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ½ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- Zest of ½ lemon
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh basil

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Place the zucchini, squash, peppers, onion, mushrooms, cherry tomatoes, and smashed garlic on the baking sheet.
3. Drizzle with the olive oil and sprinkle with the oregano, thyme, smoked paprika, salt, and pepper. Toss until evenly coated.
4. Spread the vegetables into a single layer, leaving a little space between them to encourage caramelization rather than steaming.
5. Roast for 20 minutes.
6. Remove the pan and gently turn the vegetables. Continue roasting for another 15–20 minutes, or until the vegetables are tender and deeply caramelized around the edges.
7. Transfer to a serving bowl. Remove the garlic skins and gently mash the roasted garlic into the vegetables.
8. Add the lemon zest, lemon juice, parsley, and basil. Toss gently to combine.
9. Serve warm.

### Chef's Tip

*Resist the urge to overcrowd the pan. Giving the vegetables room allows moisture to evaporate, creating beautifully caramelized edges and concentrated natural sweetness.*

**Optional Finish:** Sprinkle with crumbled feta cheese and toasted pine nuts just before serving for an extra layer of Mediterranean flavor and texture.

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 138 | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.9 g | Magnesium | 32 mg |
| Protein | 3.5 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Phosphorus | 78 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 14.2 g | Omega-6 | 0.8 g | Vitamin A | 165% DV |
| Fiber | 4.6 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 155 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 9.6 g | Sodium | 440 mg | Vitamin K | 38 mcg |
| Total Fat | 8.2 g | Potassium | 590 mg | Folate | 62 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.2 g | Calcium | 54 mg | | |
| Monounsaturated Fat | 5.6 g | Iron | 1.5 mg | | |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- A colorful mix of vegetables provides a wide variety of vitamins, minerals, fiber, and antioxidant plant compounds.
- Roasting brings out each vegetable's natural sweetness while creating rich, caramelized flavor without heavy sauces.
- Fresh herbs, garlic, and lemon add bright Mediterranean flavor that's both satisfying and heart healthy.
- This versatile side pairs beautifully with chicken, seafood, beef, lamb, or your favorite grain bowls.

# Herbed White Beans with Olive Oil

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 10 minutesCook Time: 10 minutes*

## Ingredients

- 2 (15-ounce) cans cannellini beans, drained and rinsed
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil, plus more for finishing
- 3 cloves garlic, thinly sliced
- 1 small shallot, finely diced
- 1 teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh rosemary
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- Zest of ½ lemon
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice

**½ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- Pinch of red pepper flakes (optional)

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the shallot and cook for 3–4 minutes, stirring occasionally, until softened.
3. Stir in the sliced garlic and cook for 30–60 seconds, just until fragrant.
4. Add the cannellini beans, thyme, rosemary, salt, pepper, and red pepper flakes, if using. Cook gently for 4–5 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the beans are warmed through.
5. Using the back of a wooden spoon, lightly mash a small portion of the beans directly in the skillet. This creates a naturally creamy texture while leaving plenty of whole beans for contrast.
6. Remove from the heat and stir in the parsley, lemon zest, and lemon juice.
7. Transfer to a serving bowl and finish with a generous drizzle of your best extra virgin olive oil and an extra sprinkle of fresh parsley.
8. Serve warm.

### Chef's Tip

*Lightly mashing a few of the beans creates a naturally creamy consistency without adding butter or cream. The finishing drizzle of extra virgin olive oil isn't just for flavor—it brings freshness and richness that make the dish taste complete.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 220 | Monounsaturated Fat | 6.0 g | Calcium | 90 mg |
| Protein | 9.0 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.8 g | Iron | 3.2 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 27.5 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Magnesium | 56 mg |
| Fiber | 8.0 g | Omega-6 | 0.7 g | Phosphorus | 170 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 19.5 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 8 mg |
| Total Fat | 8.8 g | Sodium | 340 mg* | Folate | 150 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.2 g | Potassium | 620 mg | | |

## Why You'll Love This Side

- Cannellini beans are an excellent source of plant protein and fiber, helping promote fullness, digestive health, and steady energy.
- Extra virgin olive oil provides heart-healthy monounsaturated fats and beneficial polyphenols, hallmarks of the Mediterranean lifestyle.
- Fresh herbs, garlic, and lemon create bright, satisfying flavor with very few ingredients.
- This rustic side pairs beautifully with grilled chicken, seafood, roasted vegetables, lamb, or spooned over toasted whole-grain bread for a simple Mediterranean meal.

# Roasted Carrots with Whipped Feta & Pistachios

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 15 minutesCook Time: 30–35 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Roasted Carrots**

- 2 pounds rainbow carrots (or regular carrots), peeled and halved lengthwise if large
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon ground cumin
- ½ teaspoon smoked paprika

**½ teaspoon garlic powder**

**½ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

**Whipped Feta**

- 4 ounces block feta cheese

**¼ cup plain Greek yogurt**

- 1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- 1 teaspoon lemon zest
- 1 small garlic clove
- 1 tablespoon water (if needed for blending)

**Finish**

- ¼ cup shelled pistachios, roughly chopped
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- 1 teaspoon fresh thyme leaves
- Freshly cracked black pepper
- Light drizzle of extra virgin olive oil
- Optional: pinch of flaky sea salt

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Toss the carrots with the olive oil, cumin, smoked paprika, garlic powder, salt, and pepper until evenly coated.
3. Arrange in a single layer and roast for 20 minutes.
4. Turn the carrots and continue roasting for 10–15 minutes, until tender with caramelized edges.
5. While the carrots roast, prepare the whipped feta. In a food processor, combine the feta, Greek yogurt, olive oil, lemon juice, lemon zest, and garlic. Blend until smooth and creamy, adding a tablespoon of water if needed for a silky consistency.
6. Spread the whipped feta across the bottom of a serving platter.
7. Arrange the warm roasted carrots over the whipped feta.
8. Sprinkle with the chopped pistachios, parsley, thyme, and a few cracks of black pepper. Finish with a light drizzle of extra virgin olive oil.
9. Serve warm.

### Chef's Tip

*Roast the carrots until you see deep caramelization around the edges—not just until they're tender. Those golden brown spots concentrate the carrots' natural sweetness and create the perfect contrast to the tangy whipped feta.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 224 | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.4 g | Magnesium | 45 mg |
| Protein | 7.2 g | Omega-3 | 0.2 g | Phosphorus | 165 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 18.5 g | Omega-6 | 2.2 g | Vitamin A | 380% DV |
| Fiber | 5.8 g | Cholesterol | 18 mg | Vitamin C | 9 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 12.7 g | Sodium | 360 mg | Vitamin K | 18 mcg |
| Total Fat | 14.3 g | Potassium | 650 mg | Folate | 42 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 3.6 g | Calcium | 165 mg | | |
| Monounsaturated Fat | 7.0 g | Iron | 1.4 mg | | |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- Carrots are exceptionally rich in beta-carotene, which your body converts to vitamin A to support healthy vision, immune function, and skin.
- Pistachios add satisfying crunch along with plant protein, healthy fats, and minerals like magnesium and potassium.
- Whipped feta brings a creamy, tangy contrast that perfectly balances the carrots' natural sweetness.
- The combination of warm spices, fresh herbs, and Mediterranean ingredients transforms simple carrots into a side that's elegant enough for entertaining yet easy enough for a weeknight meal.

# Charred Broccolini with Lemon & Parmesan

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 10 minutesCook Time: 18–20 minutes*

## Ingredients

- 1½ pounds broccolini, trimmed
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 3 cloves garlic, thinly sliced

**½ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- ⅓ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese, divided
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh parsley
- Freshly cracked black pepper, for serving

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Toss the broccolini with the olive oil, garlic, kosher salt, and black pepper until evenly coated.
3. Arrange in a single layer on the baking sheet, allowing a little space between the stalks for even caramelization.
4. Roast for 12 minutes.
5. Remove the pan and turn the broccolini. Sprinkle with half of the Parmesan cheese and return to the oven for another 5–7 minutes, until the stems are tender and the florets develop lightly charred edges.
6. Transfer to a serving platter and immediately add the lemon zest, lemon juice, remaining Parmesan, parsley, and a few cracks of fresh black pepper.
7. Serve immediately.

### Chef's Tip

*High heat is the secret. Broccolini should develop dark, caramelized edges while remaining tender-crisp. Don't worry if a few florets become deeply browned—that's where the best flavor lives.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 132 | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.8 g | Magnesium | 36 mg |
| Protein | 6.1 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Phosphorus | 145 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 8.2 g | Omega-6 | 0.7 g | Vitamin A | 28% DV |
| Fiber | 4.0 g | Cholesterol | 6 mg | Vitamin C | 118 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 4.2 g | Sodium | 315 mg | Vitamin K | 180 mcg |
| Total Fat | 9.3 g | Potassium | 420 mg | Folate | 82 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 2.2 g | Calcium | 175 mg | | |
| Monounsaturated Fat | 5.5 g | Iron | 1.2 mg | | |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- Broccolini is packed with fiber, vitamin C, and vitamin K, supporting immune health, bone strength, and healthy digestion.
- Roasting concentrates its natural sweetness, while the charred edges add rich, smoky flavor.
- Parmesan adds savory umami and calcium without needing heavy sauces or extra butter.
- Bright lemon ties everything together, making this a versatile side for seafood, chicken, steak, pork, or pasta.

# Warm Farro with Herbs & Lemon

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 10 minutesCook Time: 25–30 minutes*

## Ingredients

- 1 cup pearled farro, rinsed
- 2½ cups low-sodium vegetable or chicken stock
- 2 cloves garlic, smashed
- 1 bay leaf
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 1 small shallot, finely diced
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh dill
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh chives
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- ½ teaspoon kosher salt (adjust depending on the stock)
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

## Directions

1. In a medium saucepan, combine the farro, stock, smashed garlic, and bay leaf. Bring to a boil.
2. Reduce the heat to a gentle simmer, cover, and cook for 25–30 minutes, or until the farro is tender but pleasantly chewy.
3. Drain any excess liquid, if needed, and discard the garlic cloves and bay leaf.
4. Meanwhile, heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Add the shallot and cook for 3–4 minutes, until softened.
5. Add the cooked farro to the skillet and cook for 2–3 minutes, allowing some of the grains to lightly toast in the olive oil.
6. Remove from the heat and stir in the parsley, dill, chives, lemon zest, lemon juice, salt, and pepper.
7. Taste and adjust seasoning before serving.
8. Serve warm.

### Chef's Tip

*Cooking farro in stock instead of water builds flavor from the inside out. Letting the cooked grains toast briefly in olive oil adds a subtle nuttiness and keeps the farro from tasting flat.*

**Optional Finish:** For an extra layer of Mediterranean flavor, top with crumbled feta, toasted walnuts, or fresh mint just before serving.

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 214 | Monounsaturated Fat | 5.3 g | Calcium | 32 mg |
| Protein | 6.7 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.7 g | Iron | 1.8 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 31.8 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Magnesium | 55 mg |
| Fiber | 5.4 g | Omega-6 | 0.6 g | Phosphorus | 155 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 26.4 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 8 mg |
| Total Fat | 7.2 g | Sodium | 270 mg* | Folate | 28 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.0 g | Potassium | 230 mg | | |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- Farro is a wholesome ancient grain rich in fiber and plant protein to help support steady energy and satisfying meals.
- Fresh herbs and lemon brighten the naturally nutty flavor without overpowering it.
- Cooking the farro in stock creates rich, savory flavor in every bite.
- This versatile side pairs beautifully with grilled chicken, roasted vegetables, seafood, lamb, or hearty salads.

# Mediterranean Cucumber Tomato Salad

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 15 minutesCook Time: None*

## Ingredients

**Salad**

- 2 English cucumbers, sliced into half-moons
- 1 pint cherry tomatoes, halved
- 2 large ripe tomatoes, cut into bite-sized wedges
- ½ small red onion, very thinly sliced
- 1 cup fresh flat-leaf parsley, roughly chopped
- 2 tablespoons fresh mint, chopped (optional)
- 2 tablespoons fresh cilantro, chopped (optional)

**Lemon-Herb Dressing**

- 3 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice
- 1 teaspoon red wine vinegar
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano

**½ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

**Optional Finish**

**Crumbled feta cheese**

**Sliced avocado**

## Directions

1. Place the cucumbers, cherry tomatoes, tomatoes, and red onion in a large serving bowl.
2. Add the parsley and, if desired, the fresh mint and cilantro.
3. In a small bowl, whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, red wine vinegar, garlic, oregano, kosher salt, and black pepper until well combined.
4. Pour the dressing over the vegetables and herbs. Toss gently until everything is evenly coated.
5. Let the salad rest for 10–15 minutes before serving. As the tomatoes release their natural juices, they combine with the dressing to create even more flavor.
6. If desired, top individual servings with crumbled feta cheese or sliced avocado.
7. Serve chilled or at cool room temperature.

### Chef's Tip

*For the best flavor, use ripe, in-season tomatoes and let the salad rest before serving. The tomatoes create a naturally delicious dressing as they mingle with the lemon juice and olive oil. If preparing ahead, wait to add the herbs until just before serving to keep them vibrant and fresh.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 126 | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.9 g | Magnesium | 30 mg |
| Protein | 2.3 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Phosphorus | 55 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 10.2 g | Omega-6 | 0.8 g | Vitamin A | 24% DV |
| Fiber | 3.4 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 34 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 6.8 g | Sodium | 305 mg | Vitamin K | 245 mcg |
| Total Fat | 8.9 g | Potassium | 495 mg | Folate | 60 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.2 g | Calcium | 50 mg | | |
| Monounsaturated Fat | 6.3 g | Iron | 1.4 mg | | |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- Fresh vegetables and herbs take center stage, delivering vibrant flavor with minimal ingredients.
- Parsley is one of the most nutrient-dense herbs you can eat, providing vitamin K, vitamin C, folate, and antioxidant plant compounds in every serving.
- Extra virgin olive oil and lemon juice create a light, refreshing dressing that lets the natural sweetness of ripe tomatoes shine.
- This versatile salad pairs beautifully with grilled seafood, chicken, lamb, beef, beans, or whole grains and tastes just as delicious at a backyard barbecue as it does on a holiday table.

# Garlic Sautéed Greens

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 10 minutesCook Time: 10–12 minutes*

## Ingredients

- 4 cups baby spinach
- 4 cups chopped Lacinato (Tuscan) kale, stems removed
- 2 cups Swiss chard, chopped
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 4 cloves garlic, thinly sliced
- ¼ teaspoon crushed red pepper flakes (optional)

**½ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

**Lemon Dijon Finish**

- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- 1 teaspoon extra virgin olive oil

**¼ teaspoon Dijon mustard**

- Zest of ½ lemon

**Optional Finish**

- Freshly grated Parmesan cheese

**Toasted pine nuts**

## Directions

1. Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat.
2. Add the sliced garlic and cook for 30–60 seconds, stirring frequently, until fragrant but not browned.
3. Stir in the crushed red pepper flakes, if using.
4. Add the kale and Swiss chard. Cook for 3–4 minutes, stirring occasionally, until they begin to soften.
5. Add the spinach and continue cooking for 2–3 minutes, tossing gently until all of the greens are wilted but still vibrant.
6. Season with the kosher salt and black pepper.
7. While the greens finish cooking, whisk together the lemon juice, olive oil, Dijon mustard, and lemon zest in a small bowl until smooth and emulsified.
8. Transfer the greens to a serving platter and drizzle the Lemon Dijon Finish evenly over the top. Gently toss just before serving.
9. If desired, finish with freshly grated Parmesan cheese or a sprinkle of toasted pine nuts.
10. Serve immediately.

### Chef's Tip

*Greens continue cooking from their own residual heat after they're removed from the pan. Transfer them to a serving dish while they're still bright green and just tender to preserve both their texture and nutrients. The fresh Lemon Dijon Finish added after cooking keeps the flavors bright and vibrant.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 105 | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.8 g | Magnesium | 95 mg |
| Protein | 3.8 g | Omega-3 | 0.2 g | Phosphorus | 78 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 6.5 g | Omega-6 | 0.7 g | Vitamin A | 165% DV |
| Fiber | 3.5 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 44 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 3.0 g | Sodium | 310 mg | Vitamin K | 485 mcg |
| Total Fat | 7.8 g | Potassium | 595 mg | Folate | 185 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.1 g | Calcium | 145 mg | | |
| Monounsaturated Fat | 5.6 g | Iron | 3.4 mg | | |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- Dark leafy greens are among nature's most nutrient-dense foods, providing fiber, folate, magnesium, potassium, and vitamins A, C, and K.
- Garlic and extra virgin olive oil add rich Mediterranean flavor while contributing heart-healthy fats and beneficial plant compounds.
- The Lemon Dijon Finish brightens every bite with fresh citrus and a silky, lightly emulsified dressing that clings beautifully to the greens.
- This quick, versatile side complements everything from grilled salmon and roasted chicken to beans, lentils, and hearty grain bowls.

# Crispy Roasted Cauliflower with Lemon Tahini

*Serves: 4Prep Time: 15 minutesCook Time: 30–35 minutes*

## Ingredients

**Roasted Cauliflower**

- 1 large head cauliflower, cut into bite-sized florets
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon smoked paprika
- 1 teaspoon ground cumin

**½ teaspoon garlic powder**

**½ teaspoon kosher salt**

- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

**Lemon Tahini Sauce**

**¼ cup tahini**

- 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice
- 1 teaspoon lemon zest
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- 2–3 tablespoons warm water
- 1 teaspoon extra virgin olive oil

**¼ teaspoon kosher salt**

**Finish**

- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh cilantro (optional)
- 2 tablespoons toasted sesame seeds
- Freshly cracked black pepper
- Lemon wedges, for serving

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 425°F (220°C). Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Toss the cauliflower with the olive oil, smoked paprika, cumin, garlic powder, salt, and pepper until evenly coated.
3. Arrange in a single layer, leaving space between the florets so they roast instead of steam.
4. Roast for 20 minutes.
5. Turn the cauliflower and continue roasting for another 10–15 minutes, until deeply golden with crispy caramelized edges.
6. Meanwhile, whisk together the tahini, lemon juice, lemon zest, garlic, olive oil, salt, and enough warm water to create a smooth, pourable sauce.
7. Spread the Lemon Tahini Sauce across the bottom of a serving platter.
8. Arrange the roasted cauliflower over the sauce.
9. Sprinkle with parsley, cilantro (if using), toasted sesame seeds, and freshly cracked black pepper. Serve with fresh lemon wedges.

### Chef's Tip

*The secret to crispy cauliflower is giving it plenty of space on the baking sheet. If the florets are crowded, they'll steam instead of caramelize. Deep golden edges are where the sweetest, richest flavor develops.*

## Nutrition & Spotlight

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 182 | Monounsaturated Fat | 6.7 g | Calcium | 78 mg |
| Protein | 5.8 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 3.4 g | Iron | 2.2 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 13.4 g | Omega-3 | 0.2 g | Magnesium | 56 mg |
| Fiber | 5.4 g | Omega-6 | 3.0 g | Phosphorus | 128 mg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 8.0 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Vitamin C | 78 mg |
| Total Fat | 13.2 g | Sodium | 310 mg | Vitamin K | 22 mcg |
| Saturated Fat | 1.8 g | Potassium | 520 mg | Folate | 72 mcg |

### Why You'll Love This Side

- Cauliflower is naturally rich in fiber and vitamin C, supporting digestive health, immune function, and overall wellness.
- Tahini, made from ground sesame seeds, provides heart-healthy unsaturated fats, calcium, magnesium, and a creamy richness without dairy.
- Roasting transforms cauliflower into sweet, caramelized bites with crisp edges and incredible depth of flavor.
- The bright lemon tahini sauce adds creamy Mediterranean character while allowing the cauliflower to remain beautifully crisp.

# SECTION 6: SWEET ENDINGS

*Because healthy eating should still leave room for dessert.*

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Double Chocolate Date Brownies

Dark Chocolate Pistachio Bark

Grandma's Apple Crisp

Rustic Peach Crisp

Blueberry Lemon Crumble

Lemon Ricotta with Warm Blueberries

Chocolate Ricotta Mousse

Peanut Butter Breakfast Cookies

Almond Butter Chocolate Chip Cookies

Oatmeal Date Cookies

Persian Love Cake

Flourless Chocolate Cake

Healthy Pumpkin Pie

Pecan Pie Bars

Cinnamon Coffee Cake

Banana Bread

Carrot Cake

Pumpkin Bread

Cherry Crisp

Peach Cobbler

## Rustic Peach Crisp

*Juicy peaches baked under a buttery, oat crisp topping with hints of cinnamon and vanilla—perfect warm with a scoop of vanilla ice cream.*

## Lemon Ricotta with Warm Blueberries

*Creamy, lightly sweetened ricotta brightened with lemon zest and juice, topped with warm, juicy blueberries for a refreshing and elegant*

## Persian Love Cake

*A fragrant, tender cake infused with cardamom and rose water, topped with a pistachio and rose petal crust—an elegant taste of tradition and love in*

## Flourless Chocolate Cake

*Deeply rich, fudgy, and naturally gluten-free—made with just a few simple ingredients for the ultimate chocolate experience.*

## Healthy Pumpkin Pie

*A creamy, spiced pumpkin pie sweetened with maple and baked in a wholesome crust—a lighter take on a classic favorite.*

## Pecan Pie Bars

*All the gooey, nutty goodness of pecan pie in an easy-to-make bar—perfect for gatherings, gifting, or a sweet treat anytime.*

## Double Chocolate Date Brownies

*Rich, fudgy, and naturally sweetened with dates, these brownies are packed with deep chocolate flavor and wholesome indulgence.*

## Cinnamon Coffee Cake

*Moist, tender, and layered with cinnamon and a buttery streusel topping, this coffee cake is the perfect balance of cozy and comforting.*

## Cherry Crisp

*Juicy cherries baked under a crisp, buttery oat topping—simple ingredients, big flavor, and the perfect touch of sweetness.*

# Double Chocolate Date Brownies

## Ingredients

- 1½ cups pitted Medjool dates (about 12 large dates)
- 2 large eggs
- ¼ cup extra virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ½ cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- ¾ cup finely blanched almond flour
- ¼ cup oat flour
- ½ teaspoon baking powder
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ½ teaspoon espresso powder (optional)
- ½ cup dark chocolate chips (70% cacao or higher), divided
- 2 tablespoons cocoa nibs (optional)
- Flaky sea salt, for garnish (optional)

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line an 8 x 8-inch baking pan with parchment paper, leaving an overhang on two sides for easy removal.
2. If the dates are firm, place them in warm water for 10 minutes to soften. Drain well.
3. Add the dates, eggs, olive oil, and vanilla to a food processor or high-speed blender. Blend until completely smooth and creamy, scraping down the sides as needed.
4. Add the cocoa powder, almond flour, oat flour, baking powder, kosher salt, and espresso powder (if using). Blend just until a thick, smooth batter forms.
5. Fold in ¼ cup of the dark chocolate chips.
6. Spread the batter evenly into the prepared pan and smooth the top with a spatula.
7. Sprinkle the remaining chocolate chips and cocoa nibs over the batter.
8. Bake for 22–26 minutes, or until the edges are set and a toothpick inserted near the center comes out with a few moist crumbs.
9. Allow the brownies to cool completely in the pan before lifting them out and cutting into 16 squares.
10. If desired, finish with a light sprinkle of flaky sea salt just before serving.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 165 | Saturated Fat | 2.2 g | Sodium | 70 mg | Vitamin A | 2% DV |
| Protein | 3.2 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 5.3 g | Potassium | 225 mg | Vitamin C | <1 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 18.4 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 1.5 g | Calcium | 42 mg | Vitamin K | 2 mcg |
| Fiber | 4.1 g | Omega-3 | 0.05 g | Iron | 1.6 mg | Folate | 18 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 14.3 g | Omega-6 | 1.3 g | Magnesium | 42 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 9.8 g | Cholesterol | 23 mg | Phosphorus | 70 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the richest, fudgiest texture, blend the dates until they become completely smooth before adding the dry ingredients. They act as both the sweetener and the structure of the brownies, creating an incredibly moist crumb without refined sugar. For even cleaner slices, refrigerate the brownies for an hour before cutting.

# Dark Chocolate Pistachio Bark

## Ingredients

- 10 ounces high-quality dark chocolate (70–72% cacao), finely chopped and divided
- ⅓ cup shelled pistachios, roughly chopped
- 2 tablespoons roasted pumpkin seeds (pepitas)
- 2 tablespoons unsweetened coconut flakes
- 1 tablespoon cacao nibs
- 1 tablespoon freeze-dried raspberries, lightly crushed
- ½ teaspoon flaky sea salt
- ½ teaspoon finely grated orange zest (optional)

## Directions

1. Line a small baking sheet, cutting board, or plate with parchment paper.
2. Finely chop the chocolate and divide it into 8 ounces and 2 ounces.
3. Place the 8 ounces of chocolate in a completely dry, heatproof bowl set over a saucepan of barely simmering water (double boiler). Make sure the bottom of the bowl does not touch the water.
4. Stir gently until the chocolate reaches 115–120°F, then immediately remove it from the heat.
5. Gradually add the remaining 2 ounces of chopped chocolate, stirring constantly until completely melted and the chocolate cools to 88–90°F. The chocolate should be smooth, glossy, and fluid.
6. Stir in half of the chopped pistachios and half of the pumpkin seeds.
7. Pour the tempered chocolate onto the prepared parchment and spread into an even layer about ¼ inch thick using an offset spatula or the back of a spoon.
8. Sprinkle with the remaining pistachios, pumpkin seeds, coconut flakes, cacao nibs, freeze-dried raspberries, orange zest (if using), and flaky sea salt. Gently press the toppings into the chocolate.
9. Allow the bark to set at cool room temperature until firm, about 30–60 minutes. If your kitchen is warm, refrigerate for 10–15 minutes, just until set.
10. Break into 12 rustic pieces and store in an airtight container. Tempered bark can be stored at cool room temperature for several days or refrigerated for longer storage.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 118 | Saturated Fat | 4.2 g | Sodium | 42 mg | Vitamin A | 0% DV |
| Protein | 2.4 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 2.3 g | Potassium | 168 mg | Vitamin C | 1 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 8.2 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 1.2 g | Calcium | 18 mg | Vitamin K | 2 mcg |
| Fiber | 2.6 g | Omega-3 | 0.04 g | Iron | 1.5 mg | Folate | 8 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 5.6 g | Omega-6 | 0.8 g | Magnesium | 45 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 8.9 g | Cholesterol | 0 mg | Phosphorus | 68 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** Tempering the chocolate is optional, but it's well worth the extra few minutes. Properly tempered chocolate develops a beautiful glossy finish, a satisfying crisp snap, and stays firmer at room temperature. Without tempering, the bark will still be delicious, but it will have a lower melting point, soften more quickly when left out of the refrigerator, and may develop a dull appearance or white streaks (known as chocolate bloom) over time.

# Grandma's Apple Crisp

## Ingredients

### Apple Filling

- 6 medium Honeycrisp apples, peeled, cored, and sliced (about 6 cups)
- 2 medium Granny Smith apples, peeled, cored, and sliced
- 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 1 tablespoon arrowroot starch
- 2 teaspoons ground cinnamon
- ½ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- ¼ teaspoon ground ginger
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

### Crisp Topping

- 1 cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ¾ cup almond flour
- ⅓ cup chopped pecans
- ¼ cup chopped walnuts
- 2 tablespoons ground flaxseed
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- 5 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cut into small cubes
- 1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Lightly grease a 9 x 13-inch baking dish.
2. In a large bowl, combine the sliced apples, lemon juice, maple syrup, arrowroot starch, cinnamon, nutmeg, ginger, salt, and vanilla. Toss until the apples are evenly coated.
3. Transfer the apple mixture to the prepared baking dish and spread into an even layer.
4. In a separate bowl, combine the oats, almond flour, pecans, walnuts, flaxseed, coconut sugar, cinnamon, and salt.
5. Add the cold butter and use a pastry cutter or your fingertips to work it into the dry ingredients until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs.
6. Drizzle in the olive oil and vanilla, stirring gently until the topping begins to clump together.
7. Evenly sprinkle the topping over the apples without pressing it down.
8. Bake for 40–50 minutes, or until the topping is golden brown and the apples are bubbling around the edges.
9. Allow the crisp to rest for 10–15 minutes before serving so the juices can thicken slightly.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 285 | Saturated Fat | 4.6 g | Sodium | 125 mg | Vitamin A | 5% DV |
| Protein | 5.2 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 6.8 g | Potassium | 285 mg | Vitamin C | 10 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 31.5 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 3.8 g | Calcium | 72 mg | Vitamin K | 4 mcg |
| Fiber | 6.4 g | Omega-3 | 0.6 g | Iron | 1.5 mg | Folate | 18 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 25.1 g | Omega-6 | 2.8 g | Magnesium | 58 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 17.2 g | Cholesterol | 13 mg | Phosphorus | 118 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the best texture, use a combination of sweet and tart apples. Honeycrisp adds natural sweetness and holds its shape beautifully, while Granny Smith provides a bright tartness that balances the crisp topping. Let the apple crisp rest for at least 10 minutes before serving—the filling will thicken naturally, making each spoonful easier to serve and even more delicious.

# Rustic Peach Crisp

## Ingredients

### Peach Filling

- 8 cups fresh peaches, sliced (about 8 medium peaches)
- 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 1 tablespoon arrowroot starch
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon almond extract
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ⅛ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- Pinch of kosher salt

### Crisp Topping

- 1 cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ¾ cup almond flour
- ⅓ cup chopped pecans
- 2 tablespoons ground flaxseed
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- 5 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cut into small cubes
- 1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Lightly grease a 9 x 13-inch baking dish.
2. In a large bowl, combine the sliced peaches, lemon juice, maple syrup, arrowroot starch, vanilla, almond extract, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt. Toss gently until the peaches are evenly coated.
3. Transfer the peach mixture to the prepared baking dish.
4. In a separate bowl, combine the oats, almond flour, pecans, flaxseed, coconut sugar, cinnamon, and salt.
5. Add the cold butter and work it into the dry ingredients with a pastry cutter or your fingertips until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs.
6. Stir in the olive oil and vanilla until the topping begins to form small clumps.
7. Evenly sprinkle the topping over the peaches without pressing it down.
8. Bake for 35–45 minutes, or until the topping is golden brown and the peaches are bubbling around the edges.
9. Allow the crisp to cool for 10–15 minutes before serving.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 255 | Saturated Fat | 4.5 g | Sodium | 118 mg | Vitamin A | 9% DV |
| Protein | 4.8 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 5.9 g | Potassium | 275 mg | Vitamin C | 12 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 28.9 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.8 g | Calcium | 62 mg | Vitamin K | 5 mcg |
| Fiber | 5.5 g | Omega-3 | 0.5 g | Iron | 1.4 mg | Folate | 15 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 23.4 g | Omega-6 | 2.0 g | Magnesium | 52 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 14.8 g | Cholesterol | 13 mg | Phosphorus | 105 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** Choose peaches that are fragrant and just slightly soft to the touch—they'll have the best flavor once baked. If your peaches are especially juicy, add an extra teaspoon of arrowroot starch to help the filling thicken without becoming gummy. Let the crisp cool for at least 10 minutes before serving so the juices have time to set.

# Blueberry Lemon Crumble

## Ingredients

### Blueberry Filling

- 6 cups fresh blueberries
- 1 tablespoon arrowroot starch
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of kosher salt

### Lemon Streusel Crumble

- ¾ cup almond flour
- ½ cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ¼ cup oat flour
- ¼ cup finely chopped almonds
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 1 tablespoon ground flaxseed
- Zest of 1 lemon
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- 6 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cut into small cubes
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Lightly grease an 8 x 8-inch baking dish or a 2-quart baking dish.
2. In a large bowl, gently toss together the blueberries, arrowroot starch, maple syrup, lemon juice, lemon zest, vanilla, and salt until evenly coated. Transfer the mixture to the prepared baking dish.
3. In a separate bowl, whisk together the almond flour, oats, oat flour, chopped almonds, coconut sugar, flaxseed, lemon zest, and salt.
4. Add the cold butter and use a pastry cutter or your fingertips to work it into the dry ingredients until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs with pea-sized buttery pieces remaining. Stir in the vanilla just until incorporated.
5. Sprinkle the crumble evenly over the blueberries without pressing it down.
6. Bake for 35–40 minutes, or until the topping is lightly golden and the blueberries are bubbling around the edges.
7. Allow the crumble to cool for 10–15 minutes before serving. The filling will continue to thicken as it rests.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 248 | Saturated Fat | 4.7 g | Sodium | 118 mg | Vitamin A | 4% DV |
| Protein | 4.5 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 5.5 g | Potassium | 225 mg | Vitamin C | 15 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 27.9 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.8 g | Calcium | 62 mg | Vitamin K | 19 mcg |
| Fiber | 6.3 g | Omega-3 | 0.5 g | Iron | 1.4 mg | Folate | 15 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 21.6 g | Omega-6 | 2.0 g | Magnesium | 50 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 14.5 g | Cholesterol | 15 mg | Phosphorus | 98 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the best texture, keep the butter as cold as possible before working it into the crumble. Small pieces of cold butter create tender, buttery pockets as the topping bakes, giving the crumble its signature bakery-style texture. If your blueberries are especially sweet, add an extra teaspoon of fresh lemon juice just before baking to brighten the flavor even more.

# Lemon Ricotta with Warm Blueberries

## Ingredients

### Whipped Lemon Ricotta

- 1½ cups whole milk ricotta cheese
- 2 tablespoons plain Greek yogurt (optional, for an extra-light texture)
- 1 tablespoon pure maple syrup
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
- Pinch of kosher salt

### Warm Blueberries

- 2 cups fresh blueberries
- 1 tablespoon pure maple syrup
- 1 teaspoon fresh lemon juice
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Pinch of kosher salt

### Garnish

- 2 tablespoons chopped pistachios
- 1 tablespoon sliced almonds, lightly toasted
- 1 teaspoon lemon zest
- Fresh mint leaves (optional)

## Directions

1. Add the ricotta, Greek yogurt (if using), maple syrup, vanilla, lemon zest, lemon juice, and salt to a food processor.
2. Blend for 1–2 minutes, or until light, silky, and smooth. Transfer to the refrigerator while preparing the blueberries.
3. In a small saucepan over medium heat, combine the blueberries, maple syrup, lemon juice, vanilla, cinnamon, and salt.
4. Cook for 4–6 minutes, stirring occasionally, until some of the berries begin to burst and a light syrup forms while many berries remain whole.
5. Divide the whipped ricotta among four serving bowls.
6. Spoon the warm blueberries and their juices over the ricotta.
7. Finish with the chopped pistachios, toasted almonds, fresh lemon zest, and mint, if desired.
8. Serve immediately while the blueberries are still warm.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 255 | Saturated Fat | 6.2 g | Sodium | 155 mg | Vitamin A | 10% DV |
| Protein | 14.8 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 5.3 g | Potassium | 255 mg | Vitamin C | 9 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 18.6 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.1 g | Calcium | 255 mg | Vitamin K | 16 mcg |
| Fiber | 3.1 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 0.8 mg | Folate | 20 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 15.5 g | Omega-6 | 1.8 g | Magnesium | 42 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 15.4 g | Cholesterol | 38 mg | Phosphorus | 245 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the creamiest texture, blend the ricotta until it's completely smooth rather than simply stirring it. Warming only a portion of the blueberries creates a naturally sweet sauce while leaving plenty of whole berries for fresh bursts of flavor. The contrast of cool, creamy ricotta and warm fruit is what makes this dessert feel truly special.

# Chocolate Ricotta Mousse

## Ingredients

- 1½ cups whole milk ricotta cheese
- 2 ounces dark chocolate (70–85% cacao), melted and slightly cooled
- 3 tablespoons unsweetened cocoa powder
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ½ teaspoon espresso powder (optional)
- Pinch of kosher salt

## Optional Garnishes

- Dark chocolate shavings
- Fresh raspberries
- Cacao nibs
- Toasted hazelnuts or pistachios
- Fresh mint leaves

## Directions

1. Add the ricotta, melted dark chocolate, cocoa powder, maple syrup, vanilla, espresso powder (if using), and salt to a food processor.
2. Blend for 2–3 minutes, stopping to scrape down the sides as needed, until the mixture is completely smooth, light, and creamy.
3. Divide the mousse evenly among four serving glasses or ramekins.
4. Refrigerate for at least 2 hours to allow the mousse to firm up and the flavors to develop.
5. Just before serving, garnish with your choice of dark chocolate shavings, fresh raspberries, cacao nibs, toasted hazelnuts or pistachios, or a few fresh mint leaves.
6. Serve chilled.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 215 | Saturated Fat | 7.4 g | Sodium | 135 mg | Vitamin A | 8% DV |
| Protein | 12.8 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 4.2 g | Potassium | 235 mg | Vitamin C | 0 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 13.4 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 0.8 g | Calcium | 220 mg | Vitamin K | 2 mcg |
| Fiber | 3.2 g | Omega-3 | 0.05 g | Iron | 2.3 mg | Folate | 18 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 10.2 g | Omega-6 | 0.4 g | Magnesium | 52 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 13.8 g | Cholesterol | 36 mg | Phosphorus | 225 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the smoothest, most luxurious texture, blend the ricotta longer than you think you need to—at least 2 to 3 minutes. Chilling the mousse for a few hours allows the chocolate to set and the flavors to deepen, creating a rich, velvety dessert that's every bit as satisfying as traditional chocolate mousse.

# Peanut Butter Breakfast Cookies

## Ingredients

- 2 cups old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1 cup natural peanut butter, well stirred
- 2 ripe bananas, mashed
- ¼ cup pure maple syrup
- 1 large egg
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- 2 tablespoons ground flaxseed
- 2 tablespoons chia seeds
- ¼ cup chopped walnuts
- ¼ cup dark chocolate chips (70% cacao or higher)
- 2 tablespoons unsweetened shredded coconut (optional)

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together the mashed bananas, peanut butter, maple syrup, egg, and vanilla until smooth.
3. Stir in the oats, cinnamon, baking soda, salt, flaxseed, and chia seeds until well combined.
4. Fold in the walnuts, dark chocolate chips, and shredded coconut, if using.
5. Let the mixture rest for 5–10 minutes to allow the oats and chia seeds to absorb some of the moisture.
6. Scoop about 2 tablespoons of dough for each cookie onto the prepared baking sheet. Gently flatten each cookie with the back of a spoon, as they will spread very little while baking.
7. Bake for 12–15 minutes, or until the edges are lightly golden and the centers are set.
8. Allow the cookies to cool on the baking sheet for 5 minutes, then transfer to a wire rack to cool completely.
9. Store in an airtight container for up to 4 days or freeze for up to 3 months.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 165 | Saturated Fat | 2.1 g | Sodium | 105 mg | Vitamin A | 1% DV |
| Protein | 6.2 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 4.7 g | Potassium | 215 mg | Vitamin C | 2 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 15.8 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.0 g | Calcium | 38 mg | Vitamin K | 2 mcg |
| Fiber | 3.4 g | Omega-3 | 0.5 g | Iron | 1.2 mg | Folate | 20 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 12.4 g | Omega-6 | 1.4 g | Magnesium | 48 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 9.6 g | Cholesterol | 12 mg | Phosphorus | 125 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** Use natural peanut butter made with just peanuts (and a little salt, if desired) for the best flavor and texture. Because these cookies contain bananas, they'll stay soft and chewy for several days. They also freeze beautifully—simply thaw one overnight or warm it in the microwave for 10–15 seconds for a quick breakfast or wholesome snack.

# Almond Butter Chocolate Chip Cookies

## Ingredients

- 1 cup natural almond butter, well stirred
- 1 large egg
- ¼ cup pure maple syrup
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1 cup almond flour
- ½ cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ½ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ⅓ cup dark chocolate chips (70% cacao or higher)
- 2 tablespoons chopped toasted almonds
- Flaky sea salt, for garnish (optional)

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line a large baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together the almond butter, egg, maple syrup, and vanilla until smooth and creamy.
3. Add the almond flour, rolled oats, baking soda, salt, and cinnamon. Stir until a soft dough forms.
4. Fold in the dark chocolate chips and chopped toasted almonds.
5. Let the dough rest for 5 minutes to allow the almond flour to hydrate.
6. Scoop about 2 tablespoons of dough for each cookie onto the prepared baking sheet, spacing them about 2 inches apart. Gently flatten each cookie slightly with the back of a spoon.
7. Bake for 10–12 minutes, or until the edges are lightly golden and the centers are just set.
8. Allow the cookies to cool on the baking sheet for 5 minutes, then transfer to a wire rack to cool completely.
9. If desired, sprinkle with a pinch of flaky sea salt while still warm.
10. Store in an airtight container for up to 5 days or freeze for up to 3 months.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 145 | Saturated Fat | 1.7 g | Sodium | 95 mg | Vitamin A | 1% DV |
| Protein | 5.1 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 6.1 g | Potassium | 165 mg | Vitamin C | 0 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 10.8 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.1 g | Calcium | 72 mg | Vitamin K | 1 mcg |
| Fiber | 2.7 g | Omega-3 | 0.02 g | Iron | 1.2 mg | Folate | 18 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 8.1 g | Omega-6 | 2.0 g | Magnesium | 52 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 10.2 g | Cholesterol | 12 mg | Phosphorus | 110 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the best texture, don't overbake these cookies. They may look slightly underdone in the center when you remove them from the oven, but they'll continue to set as they cool. A sprinkle of flaky sea salt over the warm cookies enhances the dark chocolate and brings out the naturally rich flavor of the almond butter.

# Oatmeal Date Cookies

## Ingredients

- 1½ cups old-fashioned rolled oats
- ¾ cup almond flour
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ½ cup unsalted butter, softened
- ¼ cup pure maple syrup
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 1 large egg
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1 cup finely chopped Medjool dates
- ¼ cup chopped walnuts
- 2 tablespoons ground flaxseed

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line two baking sheets with parchment paper.
2. In a medium bowl, whisk together the oats, almond flour, baking soda, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt.
3. In a large bowl, beat the softened butter, maple syrup, and coconut sugar until light and creamy.
4. Beat in the egg and vanilla until well combined.
5. Gradually add the dry ingredients, mixing just until incorporated.
6. Fold in the chopped dates, walnuts, and ground flaxseed until evenly distributed.
7. Let the dough rest for 10 minutes to allow the oats to absorb some of the moisture.
8. Scoop about 2 tablespoons of dough for each cookie onto the prepared baking sheets, spacing them about 2 inches apart. Gently flatten each cookie slightly.
9. Bake for 11–13 minutes, or until the edges are lightly golden and the centers are just set.
10. Cool on the baking sheet for 5 minutes before transferring to a wire rack to cool completely.
11. Store in an airtight container for up to 5 days or freeze for up to 3 months.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 148 | Saturated Fat | 2.8 g | Sodium | 72 mg | Vitamin A | 3% DV |
| Protein | 3.8 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 2.7 g | Potassium | 175 mg | Vitamin C | 0 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 17.6 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 1.4 g | Calcium | 46 mg | Vitamin K | 2 mcg |
| Fiber | 3.3 g | Omega-3 | 0.2 g | Iron | 1.2 mg | Folate | 15 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 14.3 g | Omega-6 | 1.1 g | Magnesium | 36 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 7.6 g | Cholesterol | 18 mg | Phosphorus | 82 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** Finely chopping the dates helps them melt into the dough as the cookies bake, creating little pockets of natural caramel-like sweetness in every bite. If your dates are a little firm, soak them in warm water for 5–10 minutes, then drain and pat them dry before chopping.

# Persian Love Cake

## Ingredients

### Cake

- ¾ cup mild, fruity extra virgin olive oil
- ¾ cup organic cane sugar
- Zest of 1 large orange
- 5 large eggs, room temperature
- 1 cup whole milk Greek yogurt
- 2 tablespoons rose water
- 2 teaspoons ground cardamom
- 1¼ cups finely blanched almond flour
- ½ cup all-purpose flour
- ½ cup fine semolina flour
- 2 teaspoons baking powder
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ⅓ cup sliced almonds
- 2 tablespoons chopped pistachios

### Honey Citrus Saffron Syrup

- ⅓ cup orange blossom honey (or high-quality honey)
- ⅓ cup freshly squeezed orange juice
- Zest of 1 orange
- 1 tablespoon rose water
- Pinch of saffron threads, crushed
- Tiny pinch of kosher salt

### Optional Garnish

- Chopped toasted pistachios
- Dried edible rose petals
- Finely grated orange zest

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Grease a 10-inch springform pan and line the bottom with parchment paper.
2. Spread the sliced almonds and chopped pistachios on a small baking sheet. Toast for 5–7 minutes, stirring once halfway through, until lightly golden and fragrant. Remove from the oven and allow to cool. Set aside. (Leave the oven on.)
3. Place the cane sugar and orange zest in a large mixing bowl. Using your fingertips, rub the zest into the sugar for about 1 minute until fragrant.
4. Whisk in the olive oil until well combined.
5. Add the eggs one at a time, whisking well after each addition until the mixture becomes lighter in color.
6. Whisk in the Greek yogurt, rose water, and ground cardamom until smooth.
7. In a separate bowl, whisk together the almond flour, all-purpose flour, semolina flour, baking powder, and salt.
8. Gently fold the dry ingredients into the wet ingredients just until incorporated. Do not overmix.
9. Pour the batter into the prepared pan and smooth the top.
10. Sprinkle the toasted sliced almonds evenly over the surface of the batter.
11. Bake for 35–40 minutes, or until the cake is golden brown and a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean.
12. While the cake is baking, prepare the syrup by combining the honey, orange juice, orange zest, saffron, and salt in a small saucepan. Bring to a gentle simmer over medium-low heat and cook for about 5 minutes, stirring occasionally. Remove from the heat and stir in the rose water.
13. While the cake is still warm, use a wooden skewer to poke small holes all over the surface. Slowly brush half of the warm syrup over the cake, allowing it to absorb before brushing on the remaining syrup.
14. Sprinkle the toasted chopped pistachios over the warm cake and allow it to rest for at least 2 hours, or preferably overnight, so the syrup can fully absorb and the flavors can develop.
15. Just before serving, garnish with a little fresh orange zest and dried edible rose petals, if desired.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 268 | Saturated Fat | 2.4 g | Sodium | 105 mg | Vitamin A | 4% DV |
| Protein | 6.5 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 10.2 g | Potassium | 165 mg | Vitamin C | 5 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 24.8 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.2 g | Calcium | 88 mg | Vitamin K | 7 mcg |
| Fiber | 2.1 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 1.5 mg | Folate | 28 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 22.7 g | Omega-6 | 1.8 g | Magnesium | 42 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 16.5 g | Cholesterol | 58 mg | Phosphorus | 118 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** This cake is even better the next day. After brushing on the honey citrus saffron syrup, let the cake rest overnight, lightly covered, at room temperature. The semolina absorbs the fragrant syrup while the flavors of orange, cardamom, rose water, and saffron continue to meld, creating an exceptionally moist, tender crumb. Before serving, bring the cake fully to room temperature for the best texture and flavor.

# Flourless Chocolate Cake

## Ingredients

- 8 ounces high-quality dark chocolate (70–72% cacao), finely chopped
- ½ cup unsalted butter, cut into cubes
- ¼ cup extra virgin olive oil
- ½ cup pure maple syrup
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ½ teaspoon espresso powder (optional)
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- 5 large eggs, room temperature
- ¼ cup unsweetened cocoa powder
- ¼ teaspoon baking powder

## Optional Garnishes

- Fresh raspberries
- Lightly whipped cream
- Toasted pistachios
- Dark chocolate shavings
- Light dusting of cocoa powder

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 325°F. Grease an 8-inch round cake pan and line the bottom with parchment paper.
2. In a heatproof bowl set over barely simmering water, melt the dark chocolate, butter, and olive oil together, stirring until smooth. Remove from the heat and allow to cool slightly.
3. Whisk in the maple syrup, vanilla, espresso powder (if using), and kosher salt.
4. Add the eggs one at a time, whisking well after each addition until fully incorporated.
5. Sift the cocoa powder and baking powder over the chocolate mixture and gently whisk until smooth.
6. Pour the batter into the prepared pan and gently tap the pan on the counter to release any air bubbles.
7. Bake for 28–32 minutes, or until the edges are set and the center still has a slight wobble.
8. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes before carefully removing to a wire rack. Allow the cake to cool completely before serving.
9. Garnish with fresh raspberries, whipped cream, toasted pistachios, chocolate shavings, or a light dusting of cocoa powder, if desired.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 248 | Saturated Fat | 8.5 g | Sodium | 115 mg | Vitamin A | 6% DV |
| Protein | 4.6 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 7.1 g | Potassium | 245 mg | Vitamin C | 0 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 15.2 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 1.6 g | Calcium | 35 mg | Vitamin K | 5 mcg |
| Fiber | 3.4 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 2.7 mg | Folate | 20 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 11.8 g | Omega-6 | 1.3 g | Magnesium | 58 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 19.4 g | Cholesterol | 88 mg | Phosphorus | 125 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** The center should still jiggle slightly when you remove the cake from the oven. It will continue to set as it cools, creating the signature silky, fudgy texture that makes flourless chocolate cake so irresistible. For the cleanest slices, refrigerate the cake for at least 2 hours, then let it sit at room temperature for about 20 minutes before serving.

# Healthy Pumpkin Pie

## Ingredients

### Pecan Oat Crust

- 1 cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1 cup toasted pecans
- ¼ cup oat flour
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ¼ cup cold unsalted butter, cubed
- 2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 2–3 tablespoons ice water, as needed

### Pumpkin Filling

- 1 (15-ounce) can pure pumpkin purée
- ¾ cup whole milk Greek yogurt
- 2 large eggs
- 1 egg yolk
- ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- 2 tablespoons honey
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1½ teaspoons ground cinnamon
- 1 teaspoon pumpkin pie spice
- ¼ teaspoon ground ginger
- ⅛ teaspoon freshly grated nutmeg
- Pinch of ground cloves
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- Zest of ½ orange (optional, but highly recommended)

### Optional Garnish

- Lightly whipped cinnamon ricotta
- Toasted pecans
- Freshly grated nutmeg

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F.
2. Spread the pecans on a baking sheet and toast for 6–8 minutes, stirring once, until fragrant. Allow them to cool completely.
3. Add the toasted pecans and rolled oats to a food processor. Pulse until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs with a little texture remaining.
4. Add the oat flour, cinnamon, and salt. Pulse a few more times to combine.
5. Add the cold butter and pulse until the mixture resembles coarse sand with pea-sized pieces of butter remaining.
6. Drizzle in the olive oil and maple syrup. Pulse just until incorporated.
7. Add the ice water, one tablespoon at a time, pulsing just until the dough begins to hold together when pressed between your fingers.
8. Firmly press the mixture into the bottom and up the sides of a 9-inch pie plate, creating an even crust.
9. Refrigerate for 20–30 minutes.
10. Line the crust with parchment paper and pie weights or dried beans.
11. Bake for 12 minutes. Remove the weights and parchment and bake for another 5–7 minutes, or until the crust is lightly golden.
12. Cool slightly before adding the pumpkin filling.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 248 | Saturated Fat | 4.8 g | Sodium | 185 mg | Vitamin A | 170% DV |
| Protein | 8.2 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 7.1 g | Potassium | 265 mg | Vitamin C | 6 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 21.8 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.1 g | Calcium | 118 mg | Vitamin K | 6 mcg |
| Fiber | 4.1 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 1.8 mg | Folate | 32 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 17.7 g | Omega-6 | 1.7 g | Magnesium | 48 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 15.4 g | Cholesterol | 72 mg | Phosphorus | 168 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the smoothest, creamiest pumpkin pie, let all of the refrigerated ingredients come to room temperature before mixing the filling. Avoid overbaking—the center should still have a gentle wobble when you remove it from the oven. As the pie cools, the custard will finish setting into a silky, velvety texture.

# Pecan Pie Bars

## Ingredients

### Shortbread Crust

- 1 cup oat flour
- ¾ cup almond flour
- ½ cup toasted pecans
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ½ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- 5 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cubed
- 1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup

### Pecan Filling

- 2 cups pecan halves, lightly toasted
- ½ cup Medjool dates, packed and pitted (about 5–6 dates)
- ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- 2 tablespoons honey
- 2 tablespoons unsalted butter
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 2 large eggs
- 1 tablespoon heavy cream
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ½ teaspoon ground cinnamon

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Line an 8 x 8-inch baking pan with parchment paper.
2. Spread the pecans for both the crust and filling on a baking sheet and toast for 6–8 minutes, until fragrant. Allow to cool.
3. In a food processor, combine the oat flour, almond flour, toasted pecans, salt, and cinnamon. Pulse until finely ground.
4. Add the butter, olive oil, and maple syrup. Pulse until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs.
5. Firmly press the crust into the prepared pan.
6. Bake for 12–15 minutes, until lightly golden. Let cool slightly.
7. While the crust bakes, place the dates and ¼ cup hot water in a blender or food processor and blend until completely smooth.
8. In a saucepan over medium-low heat, combine the date paste, maple syrup, honey, butter, vanilla, salt, and cinnamon. Cook for 2–3 minutes, stirring frequently, until smooth and glossy. Remove from the heat and cool for 5 minutes.
9. Whisk together the eggs and heavy cream. Slowly whisk them into the cooled maple mixture until fully combined.
10. Fold in the toasted pecan halves.
11. Pour the filling over the warm crust and spread evenly.
12. Bake for 22–26 minutes, or until the filling is just set in the center.
13. Cool completely before refrigerating for at least 2 hours.
14. Lift from the pan and cut into 16 bars.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 218 | Saturated Fat | 3.8 g | Sodium | 88 mg | Vitamin A | 3% DV |
| Protein | 3.9 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 8.6 g | Potassium | 155 mg | Vitamin C | <1 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 17.4 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.4 g | Calcium | 38 mg | Vitamin K | 2 mcg |
| Fiber | 2.8 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 1.0 mg | Folate | 12 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 14.6 g | Omega-6 | 2.2 g | Magnesium | 34 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 15.6 g | Cholesterol | 34 mg | Phosphorus | 72 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** Toast the pecans before using them in both the crust and filling. This simple step intensifies their natural sweetness and creates a richer, more buttery flavor. Allow the bars to chill completely before slicing, then use a sharp knife wiped clean between cuts for beautiful, bakery-style squares.

# Cinnamon Coffee Cake

## Ingredients

### Cake

- 1 cup whole milk Greek yogurt
- ⅓ cup extra virgin olive oil
- ¼ cup unsalted butter, melted and slightly cooled
- ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- ¼ cup organic cane sugar
- 2 large eggs, room temperature
- 2 teaspoons vanilla extract
- 1½ cups oat flour
- ¾ cup almond flour
- 2 teaspoons baking powder
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- ½ teaspoon kosher salt

### Cinnamon Streusel

- 1 cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ⅔ cup chopped toasted pecans
- ⅓ cup almond flour
- 3 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 2½ tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 4 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cubed
- 2½ teaspoons ground cinnamon
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt

### Optional Maple Vanilla Glaze

- 2 tablespoons plain Greek yogurt
- 1 tablespoon pure maple syrup
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1–2 teaspoons milk, as needed

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Grease an 8 x 8-inch baking pan and line it with parchment paper.
2. Spread the pecans on a small baking sheet and toast for 5–7 minutes, stirring once, until fragrant. Allow them to cool before chopping.
3. Prepare the streusel by combining the oats, toasted pecans, almond flour, coconut sugar, cinnamon, and salt in a medium bowl.
4. Add the cold butter and use a pastry cutter or your fingertips to work it into the dry ingredients until coarse crumbs form.
5. Drizzle in the maple syrup and gently toss until large and small crumb clusters form. Refrigerate the streusel while preparing the cake batter.
6. In a large bowl, whisk together the Greek yogurt, olive oil, melted butter, maple syrup, cane sugar, eggs, and vanilla until smooth.
7. In a separate bowl, whisk together the oat flour, almond flour, baking powder, baking soda, and salt.
8. Fold the dry ingredients into the wet ingredients just until combined. Do not overmix.
9. Spread half of the batter into the prepared pan.
10. Sprinkle about one-third of the streusel evenly over the batter.
11. Carefully spread the remaining batter over the streusel.
12. Generously cover the top with the remaining streusel, leaving plenty of larger crumb clusters intact.
13. Bake for 38–42 minutes, or until the center is set and a toothpick inserted into the cake comes out clean.
14. Allow the cake to cool in the pan for 15–20 minutes before lifting it out.
15. If using the glaze, whisk together the Greek yogurt, maple syrup, vanilla, and enough milk to create a smooth, drizzleable consistency. Lightly drizzle over the cooled cake just before serving.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 281 | Saturated Fat | 5.2 g | Sodium | 185 mg | Vitamin A | 5% DV |
| Protein | 7.2 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 8.8 g | Potassium | 190 mg | Vitamin C | 0 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 26.1 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.8 g | Calcium | 112 mg | Vitamin K | 5 mcg |
| Fiber | 3.9 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 1.6 mg | Folate | 30 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 22.2 g | Omega-6 | 2.3 g | Magnesium | 54 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 18.0 g | Cholesterol | 44 mg | Phosphorus | 142 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For those irresistible bakery-style crumb clusters, keep the butter cold and avoid overmixing the streusel. Use your fingertips to gently squeeze some of the mixture into larger clumps before sprinkling it over the cake. As it bakes, those larger clusters become beautifully crisp on the outside while staying tender inside—the hallmark of a truly exceptional coffee cake.

# Banana Bread

## Ingredients

- 4 very ripe medium bananas, mashed (about 1¾ cups)
- ¼ cup unsalted butter
- ¼ cup mild extra virgin olive oil
- ½ cup cultured buttermilk, room temperature
- ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- ¼ cup organic cane sugar
- 2 large eggs, room temperature
- 2 teaspoons vanilla extract
- 1¼ cups oat flour
- ¾ cup almond flour
- 2 tablespoons ground flaxseed
- 1 teaspoon baking soda
- ½ teaspoon baking powder
- 1½ teaspoons ground cinnamon
- ½ teaspoon kosher salt

### Cinnamon Pecan Swirl

- ½ cup toasted pecans, finely chopped
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 1½ teaspoons ground cinnamon

### Bakery Topping

- 1 ripe banana, sliced lengthwise
- ¼ cup toasted pecans, roughly chopped
- 2 tablespoons old-fashioned rolled oats
- Pinch of flaky sea salt

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. Grease a 9 x 5-inch loaf pan and line it with parchment paper.
2. Spread all of the pecans on a baking sheet and toast for 6–8 minutes, stirring once, until fragrant. Allow them to cool before chopping.
3. In a small saucepan over medium heat, melt the butter. Continue cooking, swirling occasionally, until the butter turns deep golden brown and smells nutty, about 3–5 minutes. Remove from the heat and allow it to cool slightly.
4. In a large bowl, whisk together the browned butter, olive oil, mashed bananas, buttermilk, maple syrup, cane sugar, eggs, and vanilla until smooth.
5. In a separate bowl, whisk together the oat flour, almond flour, flaxseed, baking soda, baking powder, cinnamon, and salt.
6. Gently fold the dry ingredients into the wet ingredients just until no dry streaks remain. Do not overmix.
7. In a small bowl, combine the finely chopped toasted pecans, coconut sugar, and cinnamon to make the swirl.
8. Pour half of the batter into the prepared loaf pan. Sprinkle the cinnamon pecan mixture evenly over the batter.
9. Carefully spread the remaining batter over the swirl.
10. Arrange the banana halves lengthwise over the top of the batter. Sprinkle with the remaining toasted pecans, rolled oats, and a tiny pinch of flaky sea salt.
11. Bake at 375°F for 10 minutes.
12. Without opening the oven door, reduce the oven temperature to 325°F and continue baking for 45–55 minutes, or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out with a few moist crumbs attached.
13. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes, then transfer to a wire rack to cool completely before slicing.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 266 | Saturated Fat | 3.8 g | Sodium | 188 mg | Vitamin A | 4% DV |
| Protein | 6.1 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 7.3 g | Potassium | 305 mg | Vitamin C | 6 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 28.5 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.8 g | Calcium | 82 mg | Vitamin K | 4 mcg |
| Fiber | 4.2 g | Omega-3 | 0.2 g | Iron | 1.5 mg | Folate | 28 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 24.3 g | Omega-6 | 2.3 g | Magnesium | 54 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 15.5 g | Cholesterol | 38 mg | Phosphorus | 150 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** Use bananas with deeply speckled or nearly black peels for the richest flavor and natural sweetness. Browning the butter adds a subtle caramel note that pairs beautifully with the bananas, while beginning the bake at a higher temperature helps create the signature domed loaf with a beautiful crack down the center. For the best flavor and texture, wrap the cooled loaf tightly and let it rest overnight before slicing—it becomes even more moist and flavorful the next day.

# Carrot Cake

## Ingredients

### Cake

- 2 cups finely grated carrots (about 4 medium carrots)
- 1 cup oat flour
- ¾ cup almond flour
- ½ cup finely chopped toasted walnuts
- ¼ cup unsweetened shredded coconut
- 2 tablespoons ground flaxseed
- 2 teaspoons baking powder
- ½ teaspoon baking soda
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ½ teaspoon ground ginger
- ¼ teaspoon freshly grated nutmeg
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ⅓ cup mild extra virgin olive oil
- ¼ cup unsalted butter, melted
- ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- ¼ cup organic cane sugar
- 3 large eggs, room temperature
- ½ cup cultured buttermilk
- 2 teaspoons vanilla extract

### Whipped Maple Cream Cheese Frosting

- 8 ounces full-fat cream cheese, softened
- ½ cup whole milk Greek yogurt
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1 teaspoon orange zest

### Garnish

- ¼ cup toasted walnuts, roughly chopped
- Light sprinkle of orange zest

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Grease and line a 9-inch round cake pan with parchment paper.
2. Spread the walnuts on a baking sheet and toast for 6–8 minutes, stirring once, until fragrant. Cool completely.
3. In a large bowl, whisk together the oat flour, almond flour, chopped walnuts, coconut, flaxseed, baking powder, baking soda, cinnamon, ginger, nutmeg, and salt.
4. In another bowl, whisk together the olive oil, melted butter, maple syrup, cane sugar, eggs, buttermilk, and vanilla until smooth.
5. Fold the wet ingredients into the dry ingredients just until combined.
6. Gently fold in the grated carrots.
7. Pour the batter into the prepared pan and smooth the top.
8. Bake for 38–45 minutes, or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean.
9. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes before transferring to a wire rack to cool completely.
10. For the frosting, beat together the cream cheese, Greek yogurt, maple syrup, vanilla, and orange zest until light and smooth.
11. Spread the frosting over the cooled cake.
12. Finish with the toasted walnuts and a little fresh orange zest.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 278 | Saturated Fat | 5.8 g | Sodium | 195 mg | Vitamin A | 78% DV |
| Protein | 7.1 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 8.6 g | Potassium | 210 mg | Vitamin C | 3 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 22.4 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.9 g | Calcium | 128 mg | Vitamin K | 5 mcg |
| Fiber | 3.9 g | Omega-3 | 0.2 g | Iron | 1.6 mg | Folate | 32 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 18.5 g | Omega-6 | 2.4 g | Magnesium | 56 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 18.5 g | Cholesterol | 58 mg | Phosphorus | 162 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** Grate the carrots yourself using the small holes of a box grater rather than buying pre-shredded carrots. Freshly grated carrots release more moisture as they bake, creating a cake that's exceptionally tender and naturally sweet. Toasting the walnuts beforehand deepens their flavor and adds a wonderful contrast to the creamy frosting.

# Pumpkin Bread

## Ingredients

- 1 (15-ounce) can pure pumpkin purée
- ¼ cup unsalted butter
- ¼ cup mild extra virgin olive oil
- ½ cup cultured buttermilk, room temperature
- ⅓ cup pure maple syrup
- ¼ cup organic cane sugar
- 2 large eggs, room temperature
- 2 teaspoons vanilla extract
- 1¼ cups oat flour
- ¾ cup almond flour
- 2 tablespoons ground flaxseed
- 1 teaspoon baking soda
- ½ teaspoon baking powder
- 1½ teaspoons ground cinnamon
- 1 teaspoon ground ginger
- ½ teaspoon freshly grated nutmeg
- ¼ teaspoon ground cloves
- ¼ teaspoon ground allspice
- ½ teaspoon kosher salt

## Maple Pecan Streusel

- ½ cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ½ cup toasted pecans, finely chopped
- ¼ cup almond flour
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 3 tablespoons cold unsalted butter
- 1½ teaspoons ground cinnamon
- Pinch of flaky sea salt

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. Grease and line a 9 x 5-inch loaf pan with parchment paper.
2. Toast the pecans for 6–8 minutes until fragrant. Set aside to cool.
3. Brown the butter in a small saucepan over medium heat until deep golden and nutty. Cool slightly.
4. In a large bowl, whisk together the browned butter, olive oil, pumpkin purée, buttermilk, maple syrup, cane sugar, eggs, and vanilla until smooth.
5. In a separate bowl, whisk together the oat flour, almond flour, flaxseed, baking soda, baking powder, cinnamon, ginger, nutmeg, cloves, allspice, and salt.
6. Fold the dry ingredients into the wet ingredients just until combined.
7. Prepare the streusel by combining the oats, pecans, almond flour, coconut sugar, cinnamon, and salt. Cut in the cold butter until crumbly, then drizzle in the maple syrup and toss until large crumbs form.
8. Pour the batter into the prepared loaf pan and generously sprinkle the streusel over the top.
9. Bake at 375°F for 10 minutes, then reduce the temperature to 325°F without opening the oven door. Continue baking for 45–55 minutes, or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean.
10. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes before transferring to a wire rack.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 274 | Saturated Fat | 4.9 g | Sodium | 192 mg | Vitamin A | 95% DV |
| Protein | 6.3 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 7.8 g | Potassium | 250 mg | Vitamin C | 4 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 28.2 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.8 g | Calcium | 88 mg | Vitamin K | 5 mcg |
| Fiber | 4.2 g | Omega-3 | 0.2 g | Iron | 1.7 mg | Folate | 30 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 24.0 g | Omega-6 | 2.3 g | Magnesium | 52 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 16.4 g | Cholesterol | 42 mg | Phosphorus | 145 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For the richest flavor, make this loaf a day ahead. As it rests overnight, the warm spices continue to bloom and the pumpkin keeps the crumb exceptionally moist. Toasting a slice the next morning and serving it with a little almond butter or whipped cinnamon ricotta turns it into an unforgettable breakfast.

# Cherry Crisp

## Ingredients

### Cherry Filling

- 6 cups fresh sweet cherries, pitted (or frozen, thawed and drained)
- 2 tablespoons arrowroot starch
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 1 tablespoon fresh orange juice
- Zest of 1 orange
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon almond extract
- Pinch of kosher salt

### Almond Oat Crisp Topping

- ¾ cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- ½ cup almond flour
- ½ cup sliced almonds, lightly toasted
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 4 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cubed
- ¼ teaspoon kosher salt
- ½ teaspoon vanilla extract

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F. Lightly grease an 8 x 8-inch baking dish.
2. Spread the sliced almonds on a baking sheet and toast for 5–6 minutes, until lightly golden. Allow them to cool.
3. In a large bowl, combine the cherries, arrowroot starch, maple syrup, orange juice, orange zest, vanilla, almond extract, and salt. Toss gently until evenly coated.
4. Transfer the cherry mixture to the prepared baking dish.
5. In a separate bowl, combine the oats, almond flour, toasted almonds, coconut sugar, and salt.
6. Cut in the cold butter until coarse crumbs form. Stir in the maple syrup and vanilla until the mixture forms small and medium clusters.
7. Sprinkle the topping evenly over the cherries.
8. Bake for 35–40 minutes, or until the topping is lightly golden and the cherry filling is bubbling around the edges.
9. Allow the crisp to cool for 10–15 minutes before serving.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 246 | Saturated Fat | 4.5 g | Sodium | 98 mg | Vitamin A | 4% DV |
| Protein | 4.8 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 5.7 g | Potassium | 265 mg | Vitamin C | 10 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 28.6 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 2.4 g | Calcium | 76 mg | Vitamin K | 4 mcg |
| Fiber | 4.9 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 1.4 mg | Folate | 18 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 23.7 g | Omega-6 | 1.9 g | Magnesium | 54 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 13.8 g | Cholesterol | 15 mg | Phosphorus | 112 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** A small splash of almond extract brings out the natural flavor of the cherries without overpowering them. If using frozen cherries, thaw and drain them well before baking to prevent excess liquid. Let the crisp rest for at least 10 minutes before serving so the filling has time to thicken naturally.

# Peach Cobbler

## Ingredients

### Peach Filling

- 8 cups fresh peaches, peeled and sliced (about 8 medium peaches)
- 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice
- ¼ cup pure maple syrup
- 1 tablespoon honey
- 2 tablespoons arrowroot starch
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ½ teaspoon almond extract
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- ⅛ teaspoon freshly grated nutmeg
- Pinch of kosher salt

### Buttermilk Cobbler Topping

- 1½ cups oat flour
- ½ cup almond flour
- 2 teaspoons baking powder
- ¼ teaspoon baking soda
- ½ teaspoon kosher salt
- 2 tablespoons organic cane sugar
- 6 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cubed
- ¾ cup cultured buttermilk
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

### Finishing

- 1 tablespoon melted butter
- 1 tablespoon honey
- 1 teaspoon turbinado sugar (optional)

## Directions

1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. Lightly butter a 9 x 13-inch baking dish.
2. In a large bowl, gently toss together the peaches, lemon juice, maple syrup, honey, arrowroot starch, vanilla, almond extract, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt until evenly coated.
3. Let the peach mixture rest for 15–20 minutes, allowing the peaches to release their natural juices.
4. Using a slotted spoon, transfer the peaches to the prepared baking dish, leaving the accumulated juices behind.
5. Pour the reserved juices into a small saucepan and bring to a gentle simmer over medium heat. Cook for 2–3 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the juices become slightly thickened and glossy.
6. Pour the thickened juices evenly over the peaches.
7. In a large bowl, whisk together the oat flour, almond flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and cane sugar.
8. Add the cold butter and cut it into the flour mixture using a pastry cutter or your fingertips until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs with pea-sized pieces of butter remaining.
9. Stir together the buttermilk and vanilla. Pour into the flour mixture and gently stir just until a shaggy dough forms. Do not overmix.
10. Using a large spoon or cookie scoop, drop rustic mounds of dough evenly over the peaches, leaving small gaps between each mound so the fruit can bubble through during baking.
11. Stir together the melted butter and honey, then lightly brush the tops of the biscuit dough. Sprinkle with the turbinado sugar, if using.
12. Bake for 35–40 minutes, or until the biscuit topping is deeply golden brown and cooked through and the peaches are bubbling around the edges.
13. Allow the cobbler to rest for 15–20 minutes before serving. This gives the filling time to thicken and makes serving much easier.

## Estimated Nutrition

| Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount | Nutrient | Amount |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calories | 296 | Saturated Fat | 6.1 g | Sodium | 218 mg | Vitamin A | 8% DV |
| Protein | 6.2 g | Monounsaturated Fat | 6.3 g | Potassium | 290 mg | Vitamin C | 12 mg |
| Carbohydrates | 35.1 g | Polyunsaturated Fat | 1.8 g | Calcium | 130 mg | Vitamin K | 5 mcg |
| Fiber | 4.5 g | Omega-3 | 0.1 g | Iron | 1.8 mg | Folate | 29 mcg |
| Net Carbohydrates | 30.6 g | Omega-6 | 1.5 g | Magnesium | 55 mg | | |
| Total Fat | 15.3 g | Cholesterol | 25 mg | Phosphorus | 148 mg | | |

**Chef's Tip:** For a truly exceptional cobbler, let the peaches rest for 15–20 minutes after mixing the filling. As they sit, they'll release their natural juices. Simmering those juices for a few minutes before pouring them back over the peaches concentrates their flavor and creates a rich, glossy filling that clings to every bite instead of running across the plate. Keep the butter cold and handle the biscuit dough gently—those little pockets of butter create the tender, flaky topping that makes a true Southern cobbler unforgettable.

# *Come back to the table.*

To food made from ingredients you recognize.
To meals that nourish without feeling restrictive.
To recipes inspired by the way generations before us cooked—with whole foods, simple techniques, and the understanding that good food should be both deeply satisfying and deeply nourishing.

*The Nourishing Table is an invitation to* slow down, cook again, and rediscover *the pleasure of eating well.*

*Real food. Made with intention. Meant to be enjoyed.*

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